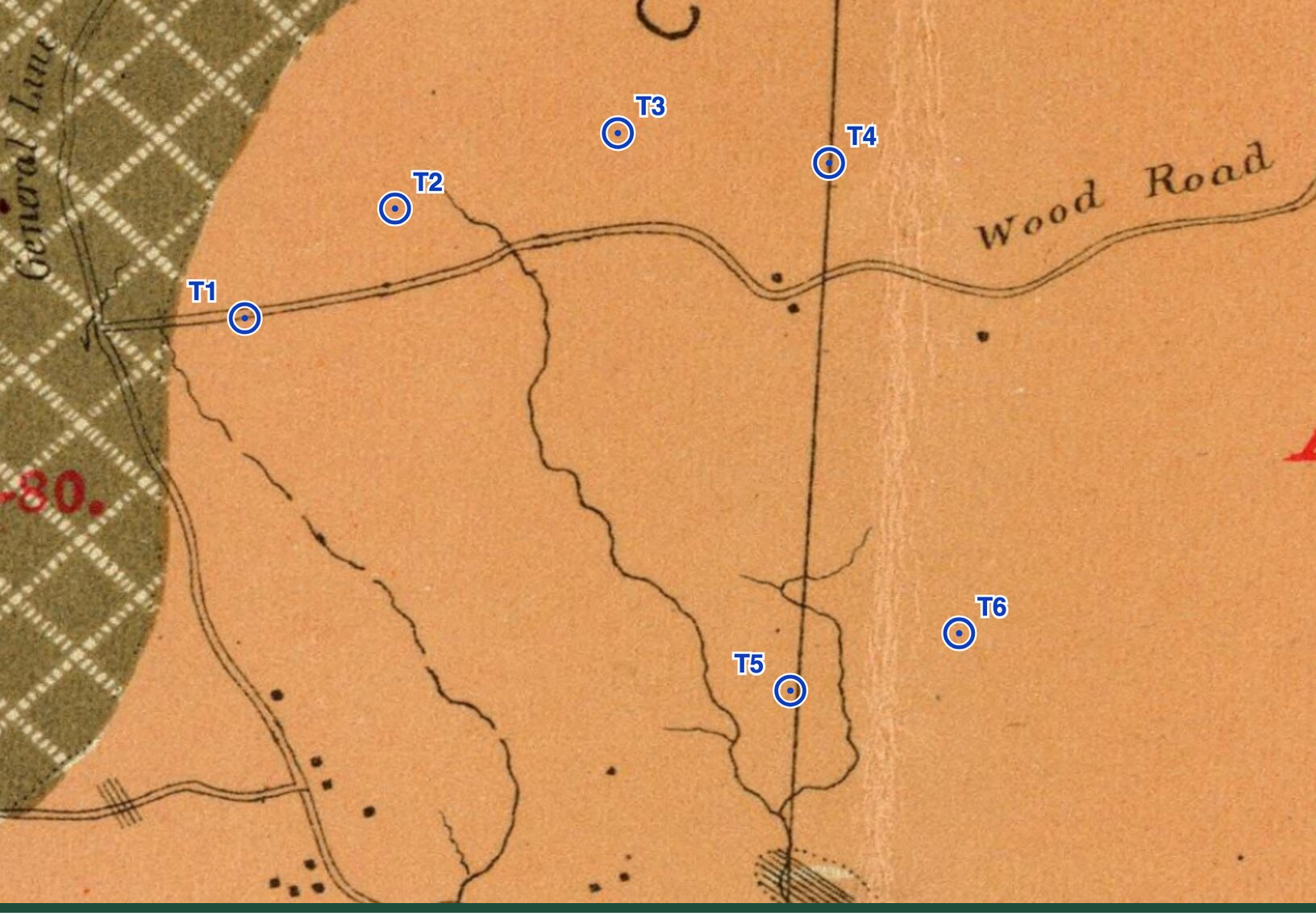


A residents' guide · Creignish–Queensville, Inverness County

Rhodena Wind

What residents can lawfully do to check a wind project, get its commitments in writing and put protections in place

Forty-seven ideas, each with an honest rating of the work it takes, the difference it can make and when to do it. Built from public records, with sources, uncertainties and limits marked.

Public edition · version 2
Facts as of 16 October 2026, revised 21 October.
Free to share.

Cover: a provisional overlay of the developer's 2024 turbine layout on Hugh Fletcher's 1884 map; final positions may change. Map image: David Rumsey Map Collection, David Rumsey Map Center, Stanford University Libraries; Creative Commons Attribution-NonCommercial-ShareAlike 3.0 licence; overlay added.

About this guide

This guide sets out what residents of Creignish, Queensville and the surrounding area can lawfully do about the Rhodena Wind project: check that it follows the rules, get its commitments in writing, and put protections in place if it is built. It is written for neighbours, not lawyers. It is not against wind power. A project done by the book, with its promises on paper, leaves less to argue about later.

What the project is. The project approved in January 2025 was up to six turbines and 42 MW near Creignish and Queensville. A flyer received on 16 October 2026 says ABO recently transferred its interest to Northland Power and gives a proposed range of 42–98 MW. These are new project claims. The transfer documents, current approval holder and review of any larger design have not been verified. ABO's October website notice names Rhodena Wind Inc. as the intended bidder.

The honest summary. No single step in this guide decides whether Rhodena is built. Together, the steps can make the project prove what it claims, put its commitments in writing, and put protections in place if it is built. Each idea says how much it can do, in plain words.

How it was made. The September research plan was checked against primary sources wherever possible and reviewed finding by finding. The guide identifies news reports, desk calculations and map overlays, and labels unconfirmed facts. The approval, registration documents, call for bids, county bylaw and laws are listed in the source notes.

Version 2, 21 October 2026. This replaces the 27 September edition. It adds the October flyer, related records questions and the October 15 procurement documents, and it changes the guide's framing: it is about how the project is done, and its support-letter advice (A1) now asks for written answers first. It does not re-audit every legal rule, rating, map or calculation, and the ratings are still the September judgments. Unchanged technical findings describe the 2024 six-turbine layout. Dates marked "about" are approximate. Get prompt advice on fresh decisions (B14).

Words on this page

MW megawatt: a measure of generating capacity. The assessed baseline is 42 MW; the new flyer proposes a 42–98 MW range. Megawatts alone do not establish turbine count.

ABO ABO Energy, the original project developer. Its Canadian company is named on the posted January 2025 approval. The October flyer reports a transfer of interest to Northland Power; confirm the current legal roles and approval holder.

Northland Power the company named in the new flyer. The flyer received 16 October reports a transfer of interest to it. Legal entities, date, control and current approval holder remain unconfirmed.

Approval a regulator's permission. In this book "the approval" means Rhodena's environmental approval of 6 Jan 2025; other approvals, such as for a wetland, are named.

What changed on 16 October

The flyer is enough to change the questions and priorities. It does not settle the approval or ownership trail.

Evidence	What it supports	What it does not settle
Flyer headed “Proposed Rhodena Wind Project: Update”, received 16 October	A claim that ABO transferred its interest to Northland Power; a 42–98 MW range; further planning of size and layout	Publication or transaction date; legal entities and control; current approval holder; an approved larger design
ABO’s October website notice	Rhodena Wind Inc. is named as the intended January bidder	Registration, final bid size, ownership, financing or selection
Posted January 2025 approval and registration	The baseline is up to six turbines and 42 MW, with conditions on starting, changes and transfer	Whether a later consent, extension or change decision exists but is not posted
Flyer and current website schedule	Conditional construction from 2028, with the website showing 2028–2030 and operation in 2030; flyer targets late 2030	A construction authorization, qualifying commencement or extension

The flyer names Darren Carl, Director of Project Development, at **darren.carl@northlandpower.com**, **1-416-988-9198**, and rhodenawind.ca. The last address still redirects to ABO’s page, which still lists six turbines, 42 MW and Heidi Kirby. Preserve both dated sources and ask who owns the response to outstanding project questions. A new contact does not cancel them.

Words on this page

Baseline a dated record of how things are now: so later changes can be shown.

Condition a rule attached to an approval or permit. Breaking a condition of Rhodena's environmental approval is an offence.

Extension extra time allowed under a particular rule. For the project start, the Minister may grant a written extension on request. Confirm the actual decision and timing. Information-request deadlines have separate rules (D1).

Commencement starting work. Site preparation on any part of the project counts. It needs 30 days' written notice, unless the Department varies the timing in writing.

Also on this page: **ABO** ABO Energy, the original project developer · **MW** megawatt

Ask for written clarification of:

1. The transaction's legal entities and effective date, what interest transferred, and who controls Rhodena Wind Inc.
2. The current environmental approval holder and any written Ministerial transfer consent.
3. What the 42–98 MW range means: alternatives, stages or expansion; proposed turbine numbers, models, heights, positions, roads and grid connection.
4. What design changes were submitted to the assessment branch, and its review or decision.
5. Any qualifying start, start notice, written extension or timing permission. January 6 is not an automatic expiry date.
6. Whether the aviation, radar, noise, flicker, wildlife and water work covers the proposed design, and what must be updated.
7. Actual fall meeting dates, accessible notices, the liaison committee's role and membership, and how survey responses will be used.

Use the assessed layout as a baseline. MW alone establishes neither turbine count, footprint nor Crown-land need. Check existing request scopes and cutoffs before an approved follow-up; open requests do not keep collecting later records.

Procurement documents checked on 16 October. Three questions follow:

- Does the approval cover the primary design, roads and grid connection? Pending addendum work is insufficient; the questionnaire route remains available (**A3**, **B1**).
- Is zoning supported by as-of-right confirmation or an executed development agreement? A support letter is separate (**C2**, **C4**).
- Was a configuration assessed, or deemed "Not Deliverable" without assessment? The label alone does not prove engineering failure (**A5**).

January 14 bids and May 6 award notices remain posted. October 8 questions/comments were not extended. The resident-material route/cutoff is unanswered. The answers are informational; the call for bids, amendments and contract govern. Check later changes.

Words on this page

Shadow flicker the flashing shadow of turning blades. The approval's limits: 30 hours a year and 30 minutes a day at any home or camp.

Addendum a formal change: to the call for bids, issued by the administrator.

As-of-right allowed under the zoning rules: by permit, without a separate discretionary planning decision.

Support letter a letter backing the bid: from a local government, group or community. Each is worth half a point, up to 4 of 100.

Also on this page: MW megawatt

Contents

About this guide 2

What changed on 16 October 3

How to use this book 8

How to read an idea 10

The bottom line 12

The priority plan 14

Key dates 18

A. The bidding round 22

- **A1** Support letters only after written answers 23
- **A2** Keep a dated log of project notices 25
- **A3** A fact-check package for the bid administrator 27
- **A4** Confirm the handover, bidder and financing 31
- **A5** Watch the grid queue and the new grid study 33
- **A6** After selection: records and contract checks 36
- **A7** Check public funding claims, only if relevant 38

B. The environmental approval and its conditions 40

- **B1** The start deadline: about 6 January 2027 42
- **B2** Track each step ABO must take before work starts 46
- **B3** Find out how the wildlife agencies' concerns were settled 50
- **B4** Watch for changes to the turbine design 53
- **B5** An independent ecology review 56
- **B6** Ask for operating rules that reduce bat deaths from day one 58
- **B7** Wetlands and streams 60
- **B8** Roads, lynx, old growth and lichens 63
- **B9** Test your well before any work 65
- **B10** Archaeology and the 1884 settlement map 67

Words on this page

Bid administrator the firm running the bidding. Power Advisory LLC for round 2. It checks and scores bids, and may verify claims with third parties.

Queue a list of items waiting their turn. In this book, usually the grid operator's posted list of connection requests (as of 27 Sept 2026, dated 15 June 2026). D1's queue is the list of planned information requests.

Old growth old forest: stands that have grown for a long time without major disturbance.

LLC limited liability company: as in Power Advisory LLC, the bid administrator.

Also on this page: ABO ABO Energy, the original project developer

B11 Old mine openings and hibernating bats 70
B12 Record species at risk, carefully 73
B13 Use the law's complaint tools, only on documented facts 76
B14 Court review of a fresh decision 78
B15 Federal routes, only on a specific trigger 80

C. The county: permit, bylaw and council 83
C1 Get the county's permit file 84
C2 Get the official zone of each turbine site in writing 86
C3 Check the layout against the county's setbacks 88
C4 Go to council: a delegation and a resolution 91
C5 Ask council to require a clean-up bond 94
C6 Why the Province changed the county's wind rules 97

D. Records and accountability 99
D1 Information requests: the records program 100
D2 Lobbying and political donations 105
D3 Check the company registry every month 107
D4 Look up land records for the turbine lots 109
D5 Conflict of interest, only on documents 111
D6 Check the jobs and benefits claims 112

E. Roads, safety and clean-up 115
E1 Roads, trucks and the haul route 116
E2 Who pays to take it down 118
E3 Fire, ice throw and the snowmobile trail 120

F. Aviation and night lighting 123
F1 Are the aviation letters still current? 124
F2 Make the night-lighting promise binding 126
F3 Show what the lights would look like at night 128

Words on this page

Judicial review asking a judge to review a decision: for reasonableness. The deadline is the earlier of 25 days after you're told (weekends and court-closed days don't count) and 6 months after the decision.

Setback a minimum distance: between a turbine and something else: a home, a property line, a road or a stream.

Clean-up bond proposed financial security for removal: that the county could call if an owner fails to take the turbines down. The current bylaw requires a plan, not a bond.

Information request a request for a public body's records: under the access law (FOIPOP in Nova Scotia): a $5 application fee, and processing fees may follow.

Ice throw ice shed from turning blades. The assessment estimates up to 421.5 m for its modelled turbine.

FOIPOP Freedom of Information and Protection of Privacy. Nova Scotia's access-to-information law. A FOIPOP request asks a public body for records it holds: a $5 application fee, and processing fees may follow.

G. Community, messages and alternatives 130

G1 Take a seat on the community liaison committee 131
G2 Separate the approved baseline from the new range 133
G3 Noise and flicker at the nearest homes 135
G4 Tourism businesses: letters in their own words 137
G5 Offer constructive alternatives 139
G6 First Nations: respect, privately 140
G7 Messages and volunteer jobs 143

H. What won't work 151

What not to say 153

Project facts 156

The 1884 map 160

Glossary and index of abbreviations 161

Sources 167

Words on this page

Also on this page: **Baseline** a dated record of how things are now · **Shadow flicker** the flashing shadow of turning blades

How to use this book

Start with three sections: the bottom line, the priority plan (twenty steps in order) and the key dates. Then read the chapters you can help with. Chapters A to G each hold a group of ideas; every idea has a code, like **B1**, used for cross-references. Chapter H lists what won't work. At the back: what not to say, the project facts, the 1884 map, a glossary and the sources.

Each idea follows the same pattern:

- **What you can do**, in a sentence or two;
- **Why it might help**, and how much, honestly;
- **How to do it**, step by step;
- **When**, and **Who** does it;
- **Where this comes from**: the formal references (sections of laws, conditions of the approval, pages of ABO's documents) kept out of the main text. You'll need these to write a precise information request or letter.

Who's who. Dan, who compiled the research, keeps the records work: information requests, questions to officials, letters, and reading what comes back. "The group" means the residents' group, which does the legwork. "A volunteer" means anyone who takes one of the jobs in chapter G.

Names used for short:

- **ABO:** the developer named in the 2024 assessment and the posted January 2025 approval. Its older documents remain attributed to it. The new flyer says its interest transferred to Northland Power. Confirm the legal entities, effective date and current approval holder before changing those attributions.
- **Northland Power:** the company named in the new flyer. Its current project role, ownership structure and responsibilities need written confirmation.

Words on this page

Also on this page: ABO ABO Energy, the original project developer · **Condition** a rule attached to an approval or permit · **Approval** a regulator's permission · **Information request** a request for a public body's records · **Northland Power** the company named in the new flyer

- **Rhodena Wind Inc.:** the intended bidder named in ABO's October 2026 website notice. An intention to bid does not prove registration, ownership, financing or an award.
- **The approval:** Rhodena's environmental approval of 6 January 2025, and **the conditions** attached to it.
- **The Department:** Nova Scotia's Department of Environment and Climate Change, which issued the approval; **the assessment branch** is its environmental assessment branch.
- **ABO's registration:** the environmental assessment documents ABO filed in 2024.
- **The call for bids:** the Province's Green Choice round 2 call. **The administrator** is the firm running it, Power Advisory. **The contract** is the 25-year power contract a winner signs with NS Power.
- **The planning commission:** the Eastern District Planning Commission, which handles Inverness County's development permits.
- **The final layout:** the final turbine choice and positions ABO must file before building roads. There is no date for it yet.

The footer on every page ("Words on this page") explains each new word the first time it appears in the book, and spells out every abbreviation on the page, every time.

Ratings are judgments, not probabilities. They are the September judgments and have not been re-scored after the flyer. The next page shows how to read them.

Words on this page

Green Choice the Province's renewable-power bidding program. Round 1 selected Rhodena in Jan 2025, but ABO declined to sign; round 2 opened on 10 Sept 2026.

NS Power Nova Scotia Power: the province's electric utility (legally Nova Scotia Power Inc.). Winning bidders sign 25-year contracts with it.

Development permit the county's planning permit for a large turbine: issued by the Development Officer. It lapses if work doesn't start within 12 months.

Also on this page: ABO ABO Energy, the original project developer

How to read an idea

Every idea in chapters A to G opens with this header. The ratings are judgments, not probabilities. Read the words first.

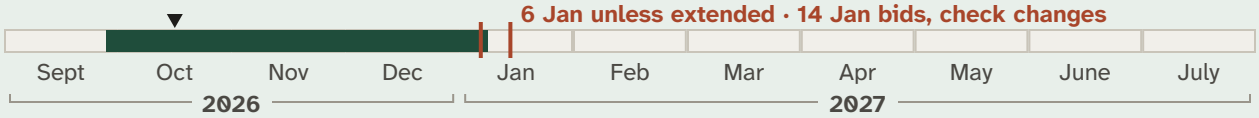
B1 Environment

Suggested action: **Do first**

The start deadline: about 6 January 2027

Work required	Potential difference	Public opinion	Effect on go-ahead
Low	**Medium**	**High**	**Low**
to check			

When Act now; check again about 8 Dec and 7 Jan **Who** Dan; the group



Why this opinion rating: A near-term deadline and a clear request for conditions are easy to explain. Say "start by about 6 January unless extended in writing", never "the approval expires".

Words on this page

Also on this page: Condition a rule attached to an approval or permit · **Approval** a regulator's permission

- **Work required:** how much work it takes. More filled means more work.
- **Potential difference:** how much it could change scrutiny, conditions, design, timing or the bid. A few rate another payoff: information, financial protection or credibility. Protective: it helps if the project is built.
- **Public opinion:** its potential to change understanding or views. Our own judgment; the reason is under each header.
- **Effect on go-ahead:** how likely the idea is, on its own, to change whether the project goes ahead at all, not just when. Almost every idea is low: this guide is about how the project is done, not whether.
- **When and Who:** a suggested window, Sept 2026 to July 2027. Ideas that wait for an undated event say "When triggered · date unknown".

Suggested work window · Carries on after July 2027

When triggered Undated event · ▼ Facts date, 16 Oct 2026

6 Jan start benchmark unless extended; 14 Jan bids subject to current addenda

Suggested action is the plan's own verdict, in plain words.

Meter scale

Very low
Low
Low–medium
Medium
Medium–high
High
Very high
Unknown, uncertain or not rated

Kinds of idea (chapter)

Bidding · A
Environment · B
County · C
Records · D
Roads and site · E
Aviation · F
Community · G

Words on this page

Also on this page: Condition a rule attached to an approval or permit · **Addendum** a formal change

The bottom line

What residents can and can't decide

Councils and residents have little room:

- Home setbacks are capped at 4× the turbine height (more only for noise or flicker), and council policy may not weigh visual impact. In 2025 the Minister cut the county's new setbacks to fit (C5, C6).
- A permit that meets the bylaw must be issued; council has no approval vote (C3; What not to say).
- The provincial board ordered West Hants to approve a wind agreement it had refused (C5), and courts defer to Ministers: a 2024 challenge to another Nova Scotia wind approval failed (B14).
- The 2025 approval has no statutory appeal, and the court-review deadline passed by July 2025; a judge extending it is a long shot (H). Letters against the project cost it no points; support letters earn points (A1).

The open questions that matter most

- **Price and grid.** Price is **50 of 100 points**. Rhodena's 2024 grid study gave a non-binding estimate of **$20.1 million** to connect 42 MW (part refundable), more if lines need upgrading; round 2 needs a new study. ABO pays, so costs can hurt the bid through its price, which the group can't see (A5).
- **Ownership and money.** The flyer changes the lead question to who now owns, bids for and finances Rhodena, and who carries its obligations. ABO's earlier financial difficulties do not establish Northland's position or the project's current financing (A4).
- **Land.** A desk check on the county parcel map shows the 2024 layout needs property-line setback waivers, mostly from the Crown, or a variance (C3). Roads and lines on Crown land need an easement, which is considered only after a contract is signed (E1).

Words on this page

Waiver giving up or excusing a requirement. For setbacks, a neighbour's written agreement to a smaller setback (a wind lease of 19 years or more, or, at the county's discretion, a binding easement). For information requests, a fee waiver excuses processing fees.

Variance a lawful, limited adjustment of a bylaw rule: such as a setback, allowed under the bylaw. Owners nearby get notice and can appeal a granted variance to council.

Crown land land owned by the Province: managed by Natural Resources. Round 2 bars turbines on it.

Easement a right to use someone else's land: for a road or power line, or to allow a smaller setback. Roads and lines on Crown land need one from Natural Resources.

Also on this page: MW megawatt · **ABO** ABO Energy, the original project developer

- **The start deadline.** Work must start by about **6 January 2027** unless the Minister extends in writing. ABO's page estimates construction in 2028–30, so expect an extension request or early site work. Early work counts as a start, but normally needs 30 days' notice (by about **7 December 2026**) and the pre-start plans first (**B1**, **B2**). A missed start doesn't automatically cost ABO the 7 approval points: the call for bids asks whether the design "has received" an approval by the bid deadline (the administrator decides), and a 4.0 questionnaire also earns them (**B1**).

The strategy

1. **Get the decisive records first,** by information request, with a short email the same day where timing matters: the approval's status, the county permit file, any final layout (**B1**, **C1**, **B4**, **D1**).
2. **Ask for commitments in writing:** support letters only once residents' questions are answered in writing (**A1**); documented discrepancies through a confirmed resident-material route and cutoff (still unconfirmed here, **A3**); ask the Minister for new bird and bat surveys, and a six-turbine limit, with any extension (**B1**).
3. **Take any documented problem through the correct process.** Get legal advice fast on any fresh decision; an extension needs no public notice (**B13**, **B14**).
4. **Get protections in place if it's built:** a clean-up bond, bat curtailment, lighting controls, a liaison committee seat, and well baselines (**C5**, **B6**, **F2**, **G1**, **B9**).

Stay credible and safe

- Claim only what documents show (What not to say).
- Never allege a breach before the deadline passes, from an empty website, or without checking written variations (**B2**, **B13**).
- Do not turn the flyer's 42–98 MW range into a turbine count, a confirmed layout or an approved expansion (**G2**). Do not infer insolvency from a transfer, or speak for Mi'kmaw partners (**G6**).
- Don't post exact nest, den, hibernation-site or lichen locations, the heritage department's site records, or lists of likely archaeological sites (**B8**, **B10–B12**).

Words on this page

Curtailment slowing or stopping turbines: at set times, for example on nights in the bat season.

Also on this page: ABO ABO Energy, the original project developer · **MW** megawatt

The priority plan

Twenty steps in priority order. Dan keeps the records work; the group does the legwork. “Idea” points to the full explanation in chapters A to G.

1 Check the actual scope, receipt, cutoff and status of any existing Environment request before filing again. Seek the current holder, transfer/change, commencement and extension records; later records may need an approved dated follow-up.

Who Dan **When** Now; reconcile existing records first **Idea** **B1**, **B14**, **D1**

2 Check separately what has been requested from the planning commission and county. Permit/waiver/design records differ from support letters, council materials and provincial bylaw directions. Avoid duplicate applications.

Who Dan **When** Now; verify each body and existing scope

Idea **C1**, **C2**, **C4**, **C6**, **D1**

3 Confirm the current route and cutoff for resident factual material. Apply the checked October 15 procurement changes and monitor later amendments. Use any written referral correctly. An Energy request about handling procedures does not secure a procurement submission window.

Who Dan **When** Now; October 8 is past and was not a public-objection deadline

Idea **A3**, **D1**

4 Keep dated flyer, web, meeting, committee and survey evidence. Record receipt separately from publication. Ask who now gives notices and answers questions.

Who The group

When Now through bids; recheck calculated benchmarks against current documents

Idea **A2**

5 Revise recruitment and reusable messages for the new flyer evidence, then obtain review before any publication.

Who Dan **When** Before publishing **Idea** **G7**

Words on this page

Also on this page: **Commencement** starting work · **Extension** extra time allowed under a particular rule · **Waiver** giving up or excusing a requirement · **Support letter** a letter backing the bid

6 Ask the new project contact for actual fall meeting dates, the liaison committee terms/membership and how participation and survey answers will be used.

Who The group **When** Now; participation is a separate personal decision **Idea** **G1**

7 Council delegation (10 working days' notice, 10 minutes): no support letter before written answers; asks to the Minister; a status report from the planning commission; a staff report on security for removal and restoration, such as a bond.

Who The group

When Confirm actual council meeting, delegation cutoff and decision timing

Idea **C4**, **C5**

8 Ask council, councillors, the MLA, the MP and local groups to wait on support letters until residents' questions are answered in writing. Explain; don't pressure.

Who The group **When** Oct–Dec (letters can be added until **14 Jan**) **Idea** **A1**

9 Preserve outstanding project questions and identify who owns the response after the claimed handover. Ask for transaction entities/date/control, approval holder/consent, 42–98 MW alternatives/layout/review, commencement/extension and current aviation coverage.

Who Dan and a volunteer **When** Now **Idea** **G2**, **A4**, **F1**

10 Information requests to Energy (the round 1 report), Natural Resources (the Crown easement, setback waivers, the species and wetland data, its comments on the wildlife and adaptive-management plans, bat-site records, the lynx map) and Environment (wetland criteria).

Who Dan **When** Oct **Idea** **D1**

Words on this page

MLA member of the Legislative Assembly: your provincial representative.

MP member of Parliament: your federal representative.

Also on this page: **MW** megawatt

11 Archaeology: an information request for the heritage department's survey reports and acceptance letters. The same day, email the heritage department the location questions and offer the 1884 map comparison privately.

Who Dan **When** Oct **Idea** **B10**, **D1**

12 Bat hibernation sites: ask about the 8 old mine openings the assessment listed (Port Hood about 26 km away, Whiteside about 27.5 km, Little River about 19 km) and 4 plugged ones: Natural Resources' records by information request; emails to researchers, the mine-openings program and the Wildlife Division. No site visits. Also request the 2025 lynx core-habitat map.

Who Dan (requests); a volunteer (emails) **When** Oct–Nov **Idea** **B11**, **B12**, **D1**

13 Ice throw near turbine 1: a letter to the assessment branch (copy Public Works) about General Line Road and snowmobile Trail 104; talk to the snowmobile club and fire departments.

Who Dan (letter); a volunteer (club, fire departments)

When Now; recheck when the final layout is filed **Idea** **E3**

14 Scope an independent ecology desk review; get a capped quote.

Who Dan **When** Before Dec **Idea** **B5**

15 Letter to the Minister: tie any extension to a new year of bird and bat surveys and the six registered turbines; ask for operating rules that reduce bat deaths from the first night of operation (preventive curtailment). Group letters to match.

Who Dan (letter); the group (letters)

When After the first reply or records, whichever comes first; before about **6 Jan**

Idea **B1**, **B6**, **G2**

Words on this page

Hibernaculum a place where bats hibernate: often a cave or old mine (plural: hibernacula). Disturbing one occupied or habitually occupied by endangered bats is an offence.

Core habitat the areas a recovery plan says a species needs most. Identified, not legally designated, for lynx in 2025.

16 Check the named legal entities, current control and transaction records. Preserve ABO financial history as dated background; do not use it to describe Northland or current project financing.

Who Dan and a volunteer

When Now, monthly and before relying on a bid-date claim **Idea** **A4**, **D3**

17 Grid: watch the queue for a new request on line L-6537; compare the new study with the 2024 one (IR713).

Who Dan

When Queue now; study from **26 Nov** ; ask the grid operator if none is posted by mid-Dec

Idea **A5**

18 Dated checks: a short email to the assessment branch and an information request the same day. Has a start notice arrived? Any extension or change? Then request the yearly status tables due 31 Jan.

Who Dan

When Planned checks about 8 Dec and 7 Jan; calculate response dates only from actual receipts and notices

Idea **B1**, **B14**, **D1**

19 Site watch from public roads (dated photos, no trespassing); look for eagle nests once the leaves are down.

Who The group **When** Nov–Jan **Idea** **B1**, **B12**

20 Build a factual comparison table. Submit only through a confirmed route and cutoff after approval; add later approval-status evidence only if that route permits it.

Who Dan

When Prepare Oct–Dec; confirm current cutoff rather than assume bid close

Idea **A3**

Words on this page

IR713 interconnection request 713: NS Power's 31 May 2024 study of connecting “Rhodena Wind” (42 MW) to line L-6537.

Concordance table the approval holder's yearly status report: on each approval condition, due each 31 January until released in writing. Confirm who currently holds the approval.

Leaf-off when the leaves are down: and nests are easiest to see (the plan's nest search is Nov–Jan).

Also on this page: **ABO** ABO Energy, the original project developer · **MW** megawatt · **NS Power** Nova Scotia Power

Key dates

From the September baseline to 2030, reviewed 16 October. The January start benchmark is conditional; the bid date awaits current addenda. Open dots are dates still to be confirmed; grey dots have passed; square marks are observation windows, not deadlines.

Already passed

NAV CANADA's aviation letter lapsed on 7 Apr 2026, and the Department of National Defence's no later than 11 Sept 2026, unless renewed. Registration for the new bidding round closed on 17 Sept 2026; who registered isn't public.

Do: Ask ABO about renewals (**F1**). Watch for a posted list of registered bidders (**A3**).

30 Sept 2026

Deadline for bidders' grid-connection requests.

Do: Watch the next queue posting for a wind request on the line Rhodena would use, of up to 105 MW, not just about 42 MW. The posted queue is still dated 15 June (**A5**).

8 Oct

Passed procurement question/comment date. The October answers say it will not be extended; it is not a general public-objection deadline.

Do: Confirm the resident factual-material route and actual cutoff; check current addenda (**A3**).

9 Oct

September guide's calculated developer notice benchmark, requiring a fresh contract/addendum check.

Do: Preserve dated notices and receipt evidence; the October 16 flyer alone proves neither timeliness nor a failure (**A2**).

15–16 Oct 2026

October 15 addendum/new answers checked October 16; new flyer received October 16 reports a Northland handover and 42–98 MW range.

Do: Apply the checked design-coverage, zoning and deliverability provisions (**A3**, **A5**, **C2**). Obtain ownership/design/approval records; receipt is not publication or transaction date.

Fall 2026, dates unknown
unconfirmed

Flyer promises community meetings, liaison committee and a survey.

Do: Ask for actual dates, notices, terms and use of feedback. Log what happens; do not invent a meeting deadline.

Words on this page

NAV CANADA the company that runs Canada's civil air navigation. It reviews tall structures for effects on flight routes and airport approaches.

Interconnection request an application to connect to the grid. Each gets a study of what the grid needs and what it costs.

Also on this page: **ABO** ABO Energy, the original project developer · **MW** megawatt

26 Oct
target

September guide's calculated public-posting benchmark; not a resident filing deadline.

Do: Check current contract/addendum wording and dated project information before drawing conclusions (**A2**).

29 Oct

Scheduled last day for changes (addenda) to the call for bids; later ones are allowed.

Do: Keep checking for addenda until bids close (**A3**, **C4**).

Nov – Jan
observation window

Observation window: leaves are down.

Do: Look for eagle nests (**B12**). Watch the site from public roads, with dated photos (**B1**).

26 Nov
target

Target date for grid-study results to bidders.

Do: Check NS Power's study-report list from 26 Nov; posting lags (**A5**).

30 Nov
unconfirmed

Historical ABO German-parent standstill date reported in the September guide.

Do: Do not apply it to Northland or current Rhodena financing without current ownership and financing evidence (**A4**).

Dec – Mar
observation window

Observation window: snow.

Do: Look for lynx tracks 1–3 days after 10 cm or more of new snow (**B12**).

About 7 Dec

Last day for ABO's 30-day written notice of a start by 6 Jan, unless the Department agrees otherwise in writing.

Do: Use the planned December status check to verify any notice, commencement, extension or timing permission. A later forecast does not settle them (**B1**, **B2**, **D1**).

15 Dec

Latest date for grid-study results that keeps the 14 Jan bid date.

Do: If nothing is posted by mid-Dec, ask the grid operator when it will be (**A5**).

31 Dec

Bidders must have contacted the provincial departments about their approvals and permits.

Do: None needed; the administrator judges each bidder's approvals plan (**B1**).

Words on this page

Standstill a temporary agreement with financing partners: during a restructuring. The September guide reported an ABO parent-company date of 30 Nov 2026; it does not establish current Northland or project financing.

The Department Nova Scotia Environment and Climate Change: which issued the approval. Its environmental assessment branch handles changes.

Also on this page: NS Power Nova Scotia Power · **ABO** ABO Energy, the original project developer

About 6 Jan 2027

Two-year commencement benchmark in the posted January 2025 approval, unless extended in writing. It is not an automatic expiry date.

Do: Verify qualifying commencement and any written extension or timing permission. Get prompt advice on an actual fresh decision; use the planned January status check (**B1**, **B14**).

14 Jan 2027, 3 pm Atlantic

Bidder deadline retained in the posted timeline checked October 16 and call for bids version 1.4. Addendum 2 does not change it. Rhodena Wind Inc. is named as intended bidder; later amendments or late study results can change the date.

Do: Check later amendments and the separate resident submission cutoff. Intention does not establish registration or an award (**A3**, **A4**).

31 Jan 2027

ABO's yearly status table on each condition, and its monitoring summary, are due each 31 Jan until the Department releases it in writing.

Do: The first information request gets any filed before it is received; request the 2027 ones in February, before 1 April (**D1**; already drafted).

Mar – May
observation window

Observation window: eagle breeding season (Feb–July).

Do: Check whether nests found are in use, from 200 m or more away (**B12**).

1 Apr 2027

The new information-access law takes effect. Requests with no decision by then stay under the old rules.

Do: File now for records that already exist; later records need new, dated requests (**D1**).

1 Apr – 30 Sept, each year

The nesting period ABO said it would clear outside of, “generally from April 1 to September 30”.

Do: Dated photos of any clearing, from public roads. Check the wildlife plan first; report a discrepancy, not a breach (**B13**).

6 May 2027
target

Award-notice target retained in the posted timeline checked October 16; subject to later changes. Flyer says successful projects in May.

Do: Recheck actual selection and notice dates before scheduling later report requests (**A6**).

June 2027
observation window

Observation window: Canada warbler season.

Do: Dawn recordings in wet, shrubby woods; keep the audio (**B12**).

Words on this page

Also on this page: ABO ABO Energy, the original project developer · **Commencement** starting work · **Approval** a regulator's permission · **Extension** extra time allowed under a particular rule · **Addendum** a formal change · **Concordance table** the approval holder's yearly status report · **Condition** a rule attached to an approval or permit · **The Department** Nova Scotia Environment and Climate Change · **Information request** a request for a public body's records

About 5 July 2027

The administrator's final report to the Minister is due, 60 days after the written decision if that goes out on 6 May.

Do: Request it from the Energy department under the new law (**A6**).

31 Dec 2030

Latest scheduled start of commercial operation allowed by the call for bids; ABO targets 2030.

Do: Does the grid build still fit? (**A3**, **A5**)

After any fresh decision (an extension, amendment, permit or variance): Court review: the earlier of 25 days after you're told (weekends and court-closed days don't count, so about 5 weeks) and 6 months after the decision. An appeal by a person "aggrieved" runs 30 days from the decision: for some provincial approvals, such as a wetland approval, to the Minister; possibly for an extension or change, to a Supreme Court judge. A granted variance: notified owners have 14 days from receiving the notice to appeal to council. **Do:** Get legal advice at once. Ask the assessment branch in writing to tell you of any extension or change. An information request doesn't stop these clocks (**B14**).

Words on this page

Also on this page: **ABO** ABO Energy, the original project developer · **Extension** extra time allowed under a particular rule · **Variance** a lawful, limited adjustment of a bylaw rule · **Judicial review** asking a judge to review a decision · **Approval** a regulator's permission · **Information request** a request for a public body's records

A

Chapter A · 7 ideas

The bidding round

The October notice names Rhodena Wind Inc. as the intended bidder. The new flyer names Northland Power and a 42–98 MW range. Confirm the bidder, owner and actual design. The October 15 addendum and new answers are checked below. The posted schedule retains January 14 bids and May 6 award notices, subject to later changes. The resident factual-material route is still unconfirmed.

	Idea	Work	Difference	Opinion	Go-ahead	Page
A1	Support letters only after written answers	**Low**	**Low–medium**	**Medium**	**Low**	23
A2	Keep a dated log of project notices	**Low**	**Low–medium**	**Low**	**Low**	25
A3	A fact-check package for the bid administrator	**Medium**	**Medium** if a real discrepancy exists	**Low**	**Low**	27
A4	Confirm the handover, bidder and financing	**Low** to monitor	**Medium**	**Medium–high**	**Low–unknown**	31
A5	Watch the grid queue and the new grid study	**Low**	**Unknown**	**Low**	**Unknown**	33
A6	After selection: records and contract checks	**Low**	**Low–medium**	**Low**	**Low**	36
A7	Check public funding claims, only if relevant	**Medium**	**Low** unless a defect is proved	**Low**	**Low**	38

Words on this page

Also on this page: **MW** megawatt · **Northland Power** the company named in the new flyer · **Addendum** a formal change · **Support letter** a letter backing the bid · **Bid administrator** the firm running the bidding · **Queue** a list of items waiting their turn

A1 Bidding

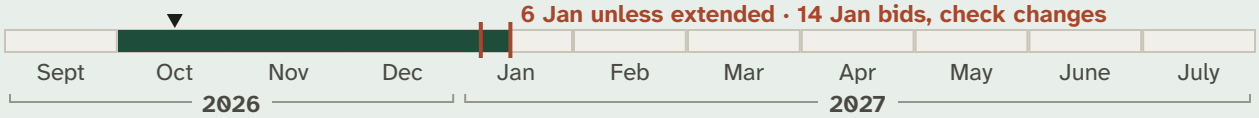
Suggested action

Do

Support letters only after written answers

Work required	Potential difference	Public opinion	Effect on go-ahead
Low	Low–medium	Medium	Low

When **Oct–Dec; letters count until 14 Jan** Who **The group**



Why this opinion rating: Asking councils and community groups to wait for written answers is a visible local conversation, but the ask itself is quiet and technical.

What you can do

Ask local councils, representatives and community groups to wait on any letter supporting ABO's bid until residents' questions are answered in writing.

Why it might help

- Each **support letter** is worth half a point, up to **4 points out of 100**. Letters count from "local governments and/or local groups or communities". "Local" isn't defined, and the administrator's published answers left open whether individual councillors, the MLA or the MP count, so treat them as possible.
- **Letters against the project don't cost ABO points.** Round 1 gave 3 points for no "substantial local opposition"; round 2 dropped that. Support letters are what count: they are worth points to the bid, which is why it is fair to ask for answers first.
- **The limit:** waiting lowers ABO's score only if it ends up with fewer than **8** qualifying letters, and ABO can look beyond the group's reach (Mi'kmaw support counts).

How much it can do: low to medium.

How to do it

1. Ask council, your councillor, the MLA and MP, community associations, the rec centre, fire departments, churches and tourism businesses to wait until residents' questions are answered in writing before giving a letter.

Words on this page

Also on this page: ABO ABO Energy, the original project developer · **MLA** member of the Legislative Assembly · **MP** member of Parliament · **Support letter** a letter backing the bid · **Bid administrator** the firm running the bidding

2. **Explain; don't pressure.** A group can clarify or withdraw its own letter; don't try to "withdraw" someone else's.
3. **Watch council agendas.** Council has authorized support letters by recorded motion before (Horton Solar, May 2022). A letter can also follow a direction to staff, with no motion recorded (July 2026). Posted minutes to 30 July 2026 show none for Rhodena.
4. **Know what may already exist.** The Strait Area Chamber of Commerce's letter was "in the final review stage" on 24 June 2024. Whether it was sent, or still stands, is open. The call for bids sets no date limit, so old letters can be reused.
5. **Leave two things alone:** First Nations (their decision; see G6), and the county's zoning confirmation, which is a separate factual letter, not a support letter.

When

October to December. Letters can be added until bids close on **14 January 2027**.

Who

The group.

Where this comes from

Green Choice RFP II s.4.3(f) (support letters, 0.5 each to a maximum of 4) and s.4.3(e) (zoning letter); FAQ v.02 item 16; round 1 scoring ("substantial local opposition"); EARD Table 6.2 (Chamber letter); council minutes of 5 May 2022 (Horton Solar) and 16 July 2026, item 11.

Words on this page

RFP request for proposals: the Province's call for bids; here, Green Choice round 2 (RFP II, 10 Sept 2026).

FAQ frequently asked questions: the administrator's published answers (FAQ v.02, 16 Sept 2026); it doesn't change the RFP.

EARD Environmental Assessment Registration Document: ABO's 2024 filing that registered Rhodena for assessment: the project description, studies and appendices.

Also on this page: ABO ABO Energy, the original project developer

A2 Bidding

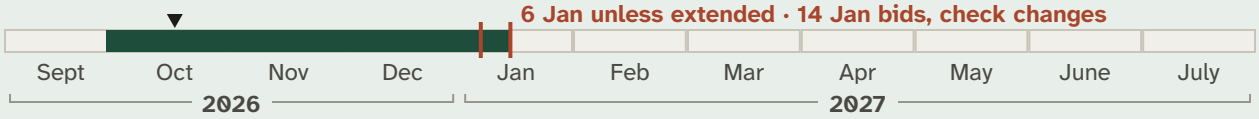
Suggested action

Do

Keep a dated log of project notices

Work required	Potential difference	Public opinion	Effect on go-ahead
Low	Low–medium	Low	Low

When **Now; verify engagement benchmarks against current documents** Who **The group**



Why this opinion rating: A dated log is evidence for the bid administrator, not a public message; it matters only if it shows a real, documented gap.

What you can do

Keep a dated, factual log of how ABO tells nearby communities about its bid, so that any real gap can be shown with evidence.

Why it might help

16 October update. The new flyer is engagement evidence received on 16 October, not evidence of when it was published or first delivered elsewhere. Save a dated, cropped copy without postal material in the background. Log the promised fall meetings, liaison committee and survey, and ask for actual dates. The older 9 and 26 October calculations below are monitoring benchmarks requiring a fresh contract/addendum check; the flyer alone establishes neither compliance nor a failure.

The call for bids requires ABO's proposal to show, with dated evidence, that it:

1. told communities in "close proximity" (not defined) that it intends to bid, **by 9 October**;
2. publicly posted contact information and project details, **by 26 October**;
3. named a lead contact;
4. offered an in-person open house or public meeting before bids close. With the approval in hand, the April 2024 open houses

Words on this page

Also on this page: ABO ABO Energy, the original project developer · **Bid administrator** the firm running the bidding · **Addendum** a formal change · **Approval** a regulator's permission

may count if the design and layout haven't changed significantly;

5. kept public information accurate, current and available through several channels, including one that isn't on the internet.

- These are pass/fail requirements, but the administrator can waive irregularities, ask ABO for more information, or accept a bid anyway. **Rejection isn't automatic.**
- ABO's page already names a lead contact, gives project details and says it will bid (since October 2025). Expect the posting and the lead contact to be met; focus on the notice and on accuracy. In May–June the page promised "Summer 2026" mailouts and an open house; now it says "future open houses, mailouts", with no dates.

How much it can do: low to medium. A failure matters only if it's real, documented and material.

How to do it

1. **Photograph any ABO mail** with the date it arrived. Record the community, not your address.
2. **Log ABO's usual channels too:** Neighbourhood Mail, the *Oran* and the *Reporter*, the Strait Area Chamber e-newsletter and the Creignish Recreation Centre's Facebook page.
3. **Save ABO's page** to the Wayback Machine every week. Note stale statements: its Q&A still says "an environmental assessment will be undertaken".
4. **One empty mailbox proves nothing.** Canada Post doesn't deliver company flyers to homes with a "no flyers" note, and a notice sent before 10 September may count (the rule says "no later than").
5. **Count the days carefully.** The dates are 20 and 30 business days after 10 September. The contract filed with the Energy Board counts only days banks are open, so 30 September and

Words on this page

Neighbourhood Mail Canada Post's unaddressed flyer service: not delivered to homes with a "no flyers" sign.

Wayback Machine a free web archive: (web.archive.org) that saves dated copies of web pages.

Q&A questions and answers: the question-and-answer section on ABO's page.

Business days days banks are open: under the filed contract, so weekends and holidays don't count.

Also on this page: ABO ABO Energy, the original project developer

Thanksgiving are skipped. Recheck the final contract and any addendum (scheduled by 29 October; later ones are allowed) before saying anything is late.

6. **Don't allege a failure** before the date passes, or from the website alone. Send a documented gap through the fact-check package (A3).

When

Now to 26 October for the notice and the posting; to 14 January for the open house and accuracy.

Who

The group.

Where this comes from

RFP II s.2.7(a)(i)–(v) (engagement), s.4.2(a)(viii) and (b) (pass/fail), s.5.3(b) and s.5.7 (waivers, clarification), s.3.5(c) (later addenda); Engagement form, Exhibit A; FAQ v.02 items 10 and 11; EARD s.6.2.4 (ABO's channels); ABO project page (read 27 Sept 2026).

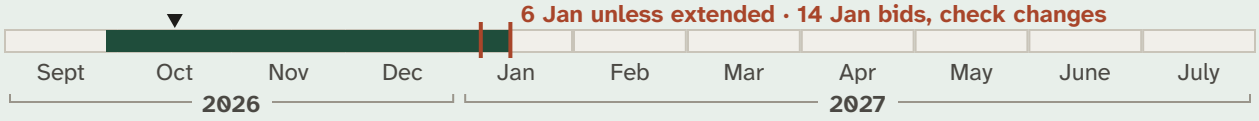
A3 Bidding

Suggested action: Do, narrowly

A fact-check package for the bid administrator

Work required	Potential difference	Public opinion	Effect on go-ahead
Medium	Medium	Low	Low
	if a real discrepancy exists		

When Prepare now; confirm the resident route and actual cutoff **Who** Dan



Why this opinion rating: It goes to the administrator, may be shown to ABO, and must say "please verify", never accuse.

What you can do

Build one careful, factual table comparing ABO's public claims with the public record, and send it to the bid administrator, if and how the administrator will take it.

Why it might help

16 October update. The October 15 addendum and new answers have now been checked. They clarify design coverage, zoning and

Words on this page

Also on this page: RFP request for proposals · **FAQ** frequently asked questions · **EARD** Environmental Assessment Registration Document · **ABO** ABO Energy, the original project developer · **Addendum** a formal change · **Waiver** giving up or excusing a requirement · **Bid administrator** the firm running the bidding

grid assessment below. They do not confirm a resident factual-material route. Ask for that route and cutoff; neither the bidder deadline nor the passed October 8 question/comment date is a general public submission deadline. The new answers say the October 8 date will not be extended; they are informational and do not amend the call for bids or contract.

- The administrator may verify bid information "with any third party", and may re-evaluate or disqualify a bid for incorrect or misleading information. But it judges the bid on the proposal, sets no process for outside material, and may let ABO clarify. **The package can only prompt a check.**
- **No resident route is confirmed yet.** In round 1 the administrator took project comments until the bid deadline; that does not establish the current route. After 17 September only registered bidders may ask *questions*, but "interested parties" may still report errors or ambiguities by **8 October**.

How much it can do: medium, but only if a real discrepancy exists.

How to do it

1. **Confirm the current process.** Ask how residents can provide factual material, which address takes it, what subjects are accepted, and the cutoff with its time zone. Keep any answer. A request to join a mailing list is not confirmation of subscription. A records request to Energy can seek handling instructions, but cannot guarantee a timely answer for a procurement cutoff.
2. **Build one table.** Columns: the rule; ABO's dated public claim; the primary record; the discrepancy, if any; what to check; what's still unknown.
3. **Add a row only if the record supports it:**
    - **The approval** (up to 7 points): compare the actual primary bid design with the approval, including its roads and grid-connection facilities. Keeping turbines inside the assessed

Words on this page

Also on this page: ABO ABO Energy, the original project developer · **Bid administrator** the firm running the bidding · **Approval** a regulator's permission

area is not enough. Any assessment addendum relied on must be approved; consultant work or regulator correspondence pursuing one does not count as approval. Otherwise the bidder must complete the environmental questionnaire and may use the old approval as supporting evidence where it applies. A 4.0 questionnaire earns 7 points; lower scores can earn fewer. Separately obtain the Department's commencement, extension and change-review records. These scoring routes do not approve a larger design.

- **Zoning** (2 points): the original municipal as-of-right confirmation for turbine and connection lots now has an alternative: an executed development agreement with the applicable municipality for the project. An ordinary support letter is not that agreement. Ask which route and records cover the actual design. The old desk overlay remains a boundary question for the planning commission (C2), not proof that either route fails.
- **Access:** turbine lots need title records, plus the owner's letter where ABO isn't the owner (mandatory). The 2 site points need every road and line on private land with rights secured, or on existing public roads. The 2024 registration put roads and lines on "a mix of Crown land and private land", and Crown easements are considered only after a contract is signed. Ask whether any stretch still crosses Crown land off an existing public road, and how the plan still reaches operation by 31 December 2030 (mandatory). ABO's timeline targets 2030.
- **The liaison committee** (1 point): the point needs a *formed* committee of nearby community members, with terms of reference. ABO's spring 2026 update still welcomes volunteers and says it will meet "once up and running again". How long a committee has existed, and efforts to form one,

Words on this page

Also on this page: ABO ABO Energy, the original project developer · **Addendum** a formal change · **Approval** a regulator's permission · **The Department** Nova Scotia Environment and Climate Change · **Commencement** starting work · **Extension** extra time allowed under a particular rule · **As-of-right** allowed under the zoning rules · **Support letter** a letter backing the bid · **Crown land** land owned by the Province · **Easement** a right to use someone else's land

don't score. A gap in meetings is a question for the Department (G1).

- **The bidder and its money:** whether ABO registered by 17 September, which company bids, who backs it, and whether the Minister's consent to a transfer is needed (A4).
- **Engagement:** A2's log, only if it shows a documented gap.

4. **Keep it safe.** Public records only; parcel numbers, not owners' names; "please verify", never "ABO misrepresented". ABO may see it, and it may be released under FOIPOP.

When

Build October to December. Confirm the current resident submission route and cutoff before sending anything. Apply the October 15 changes and check any later amendments. A January approval-status update is useful only if the confirmed route still accepts it; do not assume a right to submit at bid close.

Who

Dan.

Where this comes from

RFP II s.3.4(a)–(c) (questions; errors and ambiguities by 8 Oct; greenchoice@poweradvisoryllc.com), s.3.2(b)(ii) (mailing list), s.3.12(a) (release), s.4.2(b), s.4.3(b), s.5.5, s.5.7(a), (c), (d), (j); s.4.3(e)(iv) (EA points), (e)(v) (zoning and site points), (f) (CLC point); s.2.2, s.2.3(b)(v)(A), s.2.9, s.2.11, s.4.2(a)(v) and (x); FAQ v.02 items 12, 15, 34, 35; FAQ v.03 items 1–4, 17, 19 and disclaimer; Addendum 2 item 1 (15 Oct 2026); archived round 1 FAQ (Dec 2024); EARD s.2.1; approval conditions 3.2, 3.5, 3.9, 9.3; **D1** #10.

Words on this page

EA environmental assessment: the Province's review of a project's likely effects before it can go ahead. Rhodena's was approved with conditions on 6 Jan 2025.

CLC community liaison committee: a committee of local residents required by the approval; advisory only. Confirm the current convenor, terms and membership.

Also on this page: ABO ABO Energy, the original project developer · **FOIPOP** Freedom of Information and Protection of Privacy · **RFP** request for proposals · **FAQ** frequently asked questions · **EARD** Environmental Assessment Registration Document

A4 Bidding

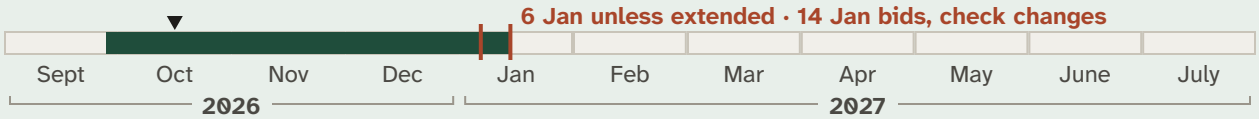
Suggested action

Do

Confirm the handover, bidder and financing

Work required	Potential difference	Public opinion	Effect on go-ahead
Low	Medium	Medium–high	Low–unknown
to monitor			

When **Now; update when ownership and approval records arrive** Who **Dan and a volunteer**



Why this opinion rating: The September rating is retained. Current messages should distinguish the claimed handover, legal roles and financing evidence.

What you can do

Identify the companies that now own, control, bid for and finance Rhodena. Obtain the transaction and approval-consent trail before making a claim about the handover.

Why it might help

The flyer received on 16 October says ABO transferred its interest to Northland Power. ABO's October project notice names Rhodena Wind Inc. as the intended bidder. Neither source supplies the transaction documents or proves the current approval holder, registration, financing or selection.

- **Separate the roles.** A project interest, company shares, the environmental approval and a future power contract are different things. Ask what moved, between which legal entities, when, and who now controls Rhodena Wind Inc.
- **Use the posted approval as the starting record.** It names ABO Energy Canada Ltd. and contains a written-consent rule for a transfer, including a controlling-interest sale. Obtain the actual consent trail and the Department's confirmation rather than conclude from the flyer that consent was required, granted or missing in this transaction.

Words on this page

Also on this page: ABO ABO Energy, the original project developer · **Approval** a regulator's permission · **Northland Power** the company named in the new flyer · **The Department** Nova Scotia Environment and Climate Change

- **Keep the old corporate search as history.** The September 27 search found active ABO Energy Canada Ltd. and Rhodena Wind Inc., with August and September filings. It did not show shareholders. Recheck the filings for the handover.
- **Financing must follow the current bidder and owners.** The earlier discussion of ABO's German restructuring is dated background. It is not evidence about Northland's finances or the current project's funding. Do not infer insolvency, financial failure or a successful rescue from the transfer claim.
- **Keep procurement conditions tied to their source.** The October 15 addendum changes zoning, deliverability, a security-document address and document permissions. It does not amend the financing points, security amount or control-change rules cited below. Recheck later amendments and the final contract when relying on them. The flyer is not proof that a bid is registered, accepted or funded.

This improves the evidence trail. It does not itself establish a reason to reject or stop the project.

How to do it

1. Preserve the flyer with its receipt date and the conflicting website as separate sources.
2. Ask the current project contact and ABO to identify the legal entities, effective date, transferred interest, control of Rhodena Wind Inc., current owner and financing responsibilities.
3. Ask the Department for the current approval holder, any written transfer consent and any related registry-change records. First check what an existing request already covers and its cutoff (**D1**).
4. Re-run the free company search for both existing companies and any named transferee. A director or filing change alone does not establish a shareholder transaction.

Words on this page

Also on this page: **ABO** ABO Energy, the original project developer · **Condition** a rule attached to an approval or permit · **Addendum** a formal change · **The Department** Nova Scotia Environment and Climate Change · **Approval** a regulator's permission

5. Carry unresolved differences into the factual comparison table (A3), with a source and a precise verification question. Keep documents about another project, including West Bay, separate.
6. Do not replace the September questions with the flyer. Establish who will answer each outstanding item after the handover.

When Now for the handover questions; again after new registry, approval or bid evidence. Recheck the actual procurement dates and addenda before relying on the January target.

Who Dan and a volunteer.

Where this comes from Renewable Electricity Regulations s.35C(2)(b); Green Choice Program Regulations s.13(1); ABO ad hoc announcements (to 31 July 2026) and press releases (2 Apr 2026); RJSC free search (27 Sept 2026); approval conditions 3.9 and 3.10; Environment Act s.41B; RFP II s.5.2, s.3.10(a)(iii), s.3.9(d)(ii), s.4.3(e)(ii), s.2.12(a)(iii), s.5.7(l); Financing Form, Exhibits A–D.

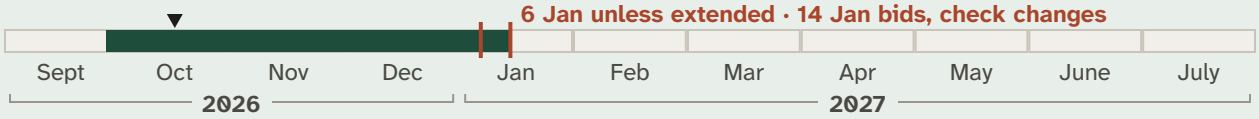
A5 Bidding

Suggested action Watch

Watch the grid queue and the new grid study

Work required	Potential difference	Public opinion	Effect on go-ahead
Low	Unknown	Low	Unknown

When The queue now; study results from 26 Nov **Who** Dan



Why this opinion rating: Technical, and the group can't see ABO's price, so it can't honestly claim grid costs will sink the bid.

What you can do Watch the public list of grid-connection requests and the new grid study for Rhodena, and compare them with the 2024 study.

Why it might help **16 October update.** The 2024 study below is for 42 MW. Do not scale its costs or constraints to 98 MW. Obtain the current connection

Words on this page

RJSC Registry of Joint Stock Companies. Nova Scotia's company registry; a free search shows status, directors and dated filings.

Also on this page: ABO ABO Energy, the original project developer · **RFP** request for proposals · **MW** megawatt

request, proposed capacity and layout, then the study that actually covers them. A larger grid request alone does not establish the turbine count, footprint or approved design. The October 15 changes do not move the schedule; dates remain subject to later amendments and the study-results rule below.

- ABO must file a valid grid-connection request by **30 September 2026**, for as-available service only. A completed study must come with the bid. Results are targeted for **26 November**; if they arrive after 15 December, the 14 January bid date moves.
- **Rhodena's own 2024 study** (NS Power, 31 May 2024) names "Rhodena Wind": 42 MW, six 7 MW turbines. It found:
  - overloads on four lines and on the transformer at Port Hastings. The fixes relied on changes to automatic grid-protection schemes that need a regional reliability body's approval. If those fail, line upgrades add about **$37.8 million** (no contingency);
  - in the one stressed case studied (Wreck Cove at maximum, heavy Cape Breton export, one outage), only **1.7 MW** before the transformer overloads. That isn't a yearly forecast;
  - a preliminary, non-binding estimate of about **$20.1 million** to connect (with a 25% contingency; not counting sales tax, some equipment and stability fixes), paid by the developer, with the network-upgrade share refundable.
- That study isn't in the latest posted list, and it predates this round, so it can't count. Round 2 needs a new one.
- **The grid deliverability assessment comes late.** The grid operator assesses ranked configurations for the 2030 system. The October 15 amendment limits how far down the list assessment proceeds as deliverable energy crosses the portfolio target; the administrator decides whether to include the marginal configuration by increasing the target. Unassessed configurations are deemed "Not Deliverable". If a project's

Words on this page

Also on this page: ABO ABO Energy, the original project developer · **NS Power** Nova Scotia Power · **MW** megawatt · **Interconnection request** an application to connect to the grid · **Approval** a regulator's permission · **Bid administrator** the firm running the bidding

higher-ranked configuration is deliverable, its other listed configuration is not assessed and gets that label too. Ask whether the configuration was assessed and why it received its result. "Not Deliverable" alone is not evidence of an engineering failure. A deliverable result does not guarantee connection, cost or date.

- **Costs act through price.** ABO pays for its own connection. Price is 50 of 100 points, and a price over 1.5 times the weighted average of ranked bids is rejected. Costs can hurt the bid, but the group can't see ABO's price, so **don't claim they will kill it.**

How much it can do: unknown.

How to do it

1. **Watch the next posting** of the connection list for a wind request on line L-6537, as-available service, dated after 15 June. Don't filter on 42 MW: a 42 MW bid can rest on a request of up to 105 MW. Don't search by county: the study index lists the 2024 study under "Cape Breton". The list won't name ABO before a connection agreement; confirm who it is from the study report. The posted list is still dated 15 June, so it proves nothing yet about a September filing.
2. **From 26 November, check NS Power's study-report index.** Reports are posted after the results meeting and can name the project (the 2024 one did). Posting lags: the index was last updated 31 March 2026. If nothing is up by mid-December, ask the grid operator (interconnect@ieso-ns.ca) when it will be.
3. **Keep the configuration and assessment records distinct.** For any published deliverability result, seek the configuration, whether it was assessed, and the recorded reason; do not treat a deemed result as a failed grid study.
4. **Compare the new study with the 2024 one.** Is the Port Hastings transformer still the limit? Were the protection-scheme changes approved? Does the 2024 study's 24–36-month grid build (after funding and a cleared right-of-way) still fit the 31 December 2030 operation deadline? Put real discrepancies in the fact-check package (A3).

Words on this page

Also on this page: **ABO** ABO Energy, the original project developer · **MW** megawatt · **NS Power** Nova Scotia Power

5. Pay an engineer only if the new study shows a constraint the bid may misstate, and the administrator accepts outside material.

When The list now; the study from 26 November.

Who Dan.

Where this comes from RFP II s.2.8(a)–(b), s.3.3(a) and (c), s.4.2(a)(ix) and (v), s.4.3(c)–(d), s.4.5(b) and (d), s.2.3(b)(ii)(A); FAQ 56; IR713 feasibility study (31 May 2024) s.6, s.6.2, s.11; IESO-NS transmission queue (15 June 2026); GIP s.3.4; deliverability methodology s.2 and s.4.3; Addendum 2 item 2, amending RFP s.4.5(a)(i)–(iii) and terminology (15 Oct 2026); 2026 10-Year System Outlook, Table 9; older study IR644.

A6 Bidding

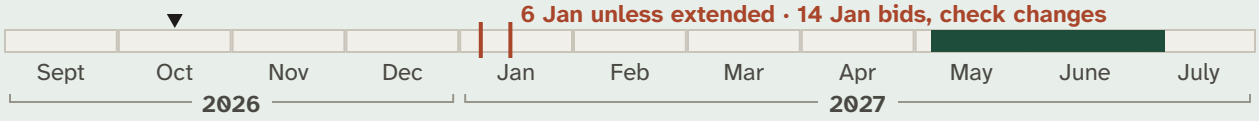
Suggested action Later

After selection: records and contract checks

Work required	Potential difference	Public opinion	Effect on go-ahead
Low	Low–medium	Low	Low

When **After the actual selection decision: request the report; check signing and security**

Who **Not assigned yet (records: Dan)**



Why this opinion rating: Mostly records and watching after a decision; little to show the public until then.

What you can do After the selection decision, get the administrator's final report, whoever wins. If ABO is selected, also watch its signing deadline and security.

Why it might help

- The administrator must give the Minister of Energy a final report within **60 days** after its written decision, which is due within 7

Words on this page

IESO-NS Independent Energy System Operator (Nova Scotia): the province's independent grid operator. It keeps the connection queue and tests whether bids' power can be delivered.

GIP Generator Interconnection Procedures: the published rules for connecting generators to the grid.

IR644 interconnection request 644: an older 2022 study of 102.6 MW on L-6537; it names no developer.

Also on this page: RFP request for proposals · **FAQ** frequently asked questions · **IR713** interconnection request 713 · **ABO** ABO Energy, the original project developer · **MW** megawatt

days of selection. It covers a comparison of the bids' economics, the reasons for the selection, and contract prices and sizes, including averages. If notice goes out on the **6 May 2027** target, the report is due by about **5 July 2027**. Individual prices may be withheld as third-party business information. No published round 1 report was found.

- A selected bidder must sign the contract and post performance security ($35,000 per MW in the filed contract, like the proposal security) within **20 business days** after the administrator sends it the contract. If it doesn't, it may be disqualified and its proposal security drawn. In round 1, only two of six selected projects signed (ABO's Rhodena page).
- After signing, transfers of the contract, including indirect ones, generally need NS Power's consent; transfers to an affiliate or a lender are excepted.
- NS Power must tell the Minister and the Energy Board of a contract termination within **30 business days**, and report transfers, assignments and terminations by **31 January** each year. The Minister may ask the supplier for progress, local-benefit and technical reports: good targets for information requests.
- Only NS Power or a bidder can appeal a selection, to the Energy Board, within **30 days after receiving** the written decision, for errors of law, jurisdiction or natural justice. **Residents have no appeal there.**

How much it can do: low to medium.

How to do it

1. Ask for the round 1 report now, in the Energy information request (**D1**).
2. Request the round 2 report from the Energy department under the new access law (in force 1 April 2027).

Words on this page

Proposal security financial security posted with a bid: $35,000 per MW, about $1.47M at 42 MW; it can be drawn if a winner doesn't sign.

Also on this page: MW megawatt · **ABO** ABO Energy, the original project developer · **NS Power** Nova Scotia Power

3. Watch the administrator's announcements and ABO's page for signing.

When After the selection decision (target 6 May 2027). The report is due 60 days after the written decision: about 5 July 2027 if the decision goes out on 6 May.

Who Not assigned yet. It is records work, which Dan keeps.

Where this comes from Renewable Electricity Regulations s.35C–35D; RFP II s.3.10(a) and s.3.3; filed PPA s.16.2–16.3; Green Choice Program Regulations s.15, s.22, s.23; Electricity Act s.28(4); new FOIPOP Act (Bill 150, in force 1 Apr 2027).

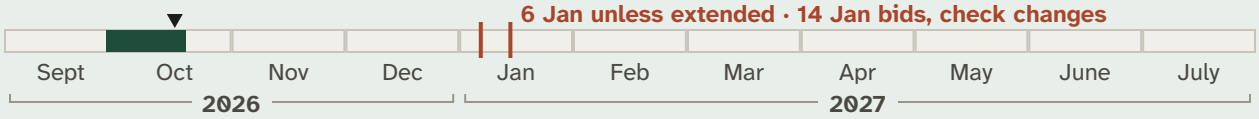
A7 Bidding

Suggested action: Only if relevant

Check public funding claims, only if relevant

Work required	Potential difference	Public opinion	Effect on go-ahead
Medium	Low	Low	Low
	unless a defect is proved		

When **Ask the current project team; check disclosures after any award** Who **Dan and a volunteer**



Why this opinion rating: Relevant only if a documented misstatement turns up; opposition alone is no funding veto.

What you can do

16 October update. Direct current funding questions to the identified bidder and project owners. Older searches for ABO do not establish whether Northland or a different legal entity has applied for or received financing.

Ask whether ABO's bid relies on federal financing or grants, and act only if you find a documented misstatement.

Words on this page

PPA power purchase agreement: the 25-year contract under which a winning bidder sells electricity to NS Power.

Also on this page: ABO ABO Energy, the original project developer · **RFP** request for proposals · **FOIPOP** Freedom of Information and Protection of Privacy · **NS Power** Nova Scotia Power

Why it might help

- The call for bids encourages bidders to use Canada Infrastructure Bank financing, tax credits and a federal clean-power fund (SREPs); bidders can ask the bank about its products now. The bank's standard offers are for bidders *awarded* a contract. The fund's money is for selected projects, after due diligence, and is owed only under a signed agreement.
- The bid must list expected government funding, but bids aren't public. The bank must withhold information it gets about proponents, so a federal information request to it would likely return little.
- The federal grants and contributions disclosure shows nothing for Rhodena, ABO or Community Wind Farms (27 September 2026), but it lists awards only, not applications or bank loans.
- The contract filed for the Energy Board's approval has no exit if the bank's or the fund's money falls through; the June draft's exit clause was removed.
- **Opposition alone is no funding veto.**

How much it can do: low, unless a defect is proved.

How to do it

1. Ask ABO whether the bid relies on the bank or the fund, with the ownership question (A4).
2. After an award, check the federal disclosure and the bank's announcements.
3. Check the final contract once the Board rules.
4. Send a funder only a *documented* misstatement (for example, on the approval's status).

When

Ask ABO now; check the disclosures after an award.

Who

Dan and a volunteer, with the email to ABO.

Where this comes from

RFP II s.1.5; Financing Form s.4; Canada Infrastructure Bank Act s.28; Access to Information Act s.24 and Sch. II; federal grants and contributions disclosure (27 Sept 2026); Energy Board matter M13042 (filed PPA) and the June draft PPA.

Words on this page

SREPs Smart Renewables and Electrification Pathways Program. Natural Resources Canada funding for clean-power projects.

NRCan Natural Resources Canada: the federal natural resources department.

Also on this page: ABO ABO Energy, the original project developer · **RFP** request for proposals · **PPA** power purchase agreement

B

Chapter B · 15 ideas

The environmental approval and its conditions

The posted January 2025 approval describes the registered six-turbine project. The flyer changes the questions about ownership, design and timing. Obtain the written transfer, change-review, commencement and extension records. This guide makes no finding of expiry or non-compliance.

	Idea	Work	Difference	Opinion	Go-ahead	Page
B1	The start deadline: about 6 January 2027	**Low** to check	**Medium**	**High**	**Low**	42
B2	Track each step ABO must take before work starts	**Low**	**Medium**	**Low**	**Low**	46
B3	Find out how the wildlife agencies' concerns were settled	**Low–medium**	**Medium**	**Medium**	**Low**	50
B4	Watch for changes to the turbine design	**Low** to compare	**Medium** if a real change	**Low–medium**	**Low**	53
B5	An independent ecology review	**Medium** it costs money	**Medium–high** for operating rules; low–medium for siting	**Low**	**Low**	56
B6	Ask for operating rules that reduce bat deaths from day one	**Low** to ask	**Medium**	**Medium**	**Low**	58

Words on this page

Also on this page: **ABO** ABO Energy, the original project developer · **Approval** a regulator's permission · **Condition** a rule attached to an approval or permit · **Commencement** starting work · **Extension** extra time allowed under a particular rule

	Idea	Work	Difference	Opinion	Go-ahead	Page
B7	Wetlands and streams	**Low** for records; medium for the technical check	**Medium** high leverage on local design	**Low–medium**	**Low**	60
B8	Roads, lynx, old growth and lichens	**Medium**	**Medium–high** for design	**Medium**	**Low**	63
B9	Test your well before any work	**Low**	**Protective**	**Low**	**Low**	65
B10	Archaeology and the 1884 settlement map	**Low** desk check done	**Low–medium** local avoidance, testing, or moving a pad or road segment	**Medium**	**Very low**	67
B11	Old mine openings and hibernating bats	**Very low** a few inquiries	**Low–medium** none confirmed; already top risk category	**Low**	**Low**	70
B12	Record species at risk, carefully	**Medium**	**Medium** only if new, verified and near the footprint	**Low–medium**	**Low**	73
B13	Use the law's complaint tools, only on documented facts	**Low** if facts exist	**Medium**	**Low**	**Low**	76
B14	Court review of a fresh decision	**High**	**High** potentially	**Low–medium**	**Low**	78
B15	Federal routes, only on a specific trigger	**High**	**Low** in general	**Low**	**Low**	80

Words on this page

Also on this page: **Approval** a regulator's permission · **Condition** a rule attached to an approval or permit · **Old growth** old forest · **Judicial review** asking a judge to review a decision

B1 Environment

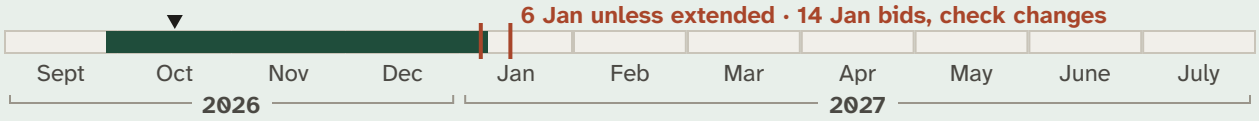
Suggested action

Do first

The start deadline: about 6 January 2027

Work required	Potential difference	Public opinion	Effect on go-ahead
Low	Medium	High	Low
to check			

When **Act now; check again about 8 Dec and 7 Jan** Who **Dan; the group**



Why this opinion rating: A near-term deadline and a clear request for conditions are easy to explain. Say "start by about 6 January unless extended in writing", never "the approval expires".

What you can do

16 October update. The flyer makes the written record more urgent. Confirm the current approval holder, any qualifying commencement, written extension and review of the 42–98 MW alternatives. Keep the January 2025 six-turbine approval separate from the flyer. The 2028–2030 forecast is not evidence of a start, an extension or a breach.

Find out where the start deadline stands, get the records that show it, and ask the Minister to attach conditions to any extension: new bird and bat studies, and a limit to the registered project (up to six turbines and 42 MW), with any change reviewed first.

Why it might help

The approval says ABO must **start work within two years** of 6 January 2025, so by about **6 January 2027**, unless the Minister extends that in writing. ABO has to ask in writing, and the Minister must find the request "valid and reasonable"; no published criteria were found. ABO's own web page estimates engineering and construction in 2028–30, so expect either a request for an extension or some early site work before the deadline.

Words on this page

Also on this page: MW megawatt · **ABO** ABO Energy, the original project developer · **Approval** a regulator's permission · **Condition** a rule attached to an approval or permit · **Commencement** starting work · **Extension** extra time allowed under a particular rule

- **It is not an expiry date.** Neither the rule nor the approval says the approval lapses. But the provincial environment law calls this the period "during which a proponent can act upon the approval", and an older Department guide, since replaced, said missing the time frames without an extension made the project "null". Missing the date without an extension would break a condition of the approval. How the Department would then treat the approval is an open question, worth asking.
- **Early site work counts as a start**, on any part of the project. But before starting, ABO must give 30 days' written notice (by about 7 December 2026 for a 6 January start) and meet the requirements for plans, species information and a complaints contact; some plans must be in place rather than filed. Road work has more requirements, including the final turbine layout and updated noise and flicker modelling. The Department can change the timing in writing, or consent to plans in phases; work may then go only as far as the completed phases (B2).
- **An extension needs no public notice or comment period.** So letters have to arrive before any decision. The Department has posted an extension on a project's web page before (a spaceport project at Canso, 2021), so keep watching Rhodena's page too.
- **The link to the bidding is weaker than it looks.** The bid scoring gives 7 points to a primary design whose approval, received by the bid deadline, is wholly representative; the administrator decides applicability. The new answers include roads and grid connection, and require any assessment addendum relied on to be approved. Pending addendum work is insufficient; the questionnaire route remains available (A3). Rhodena's approval dates from January 2025, and a questionnaire score of 4.0 also earns the 7 points. The administrator also judges each bidder's "viable path" to its approvals, which bidders with no approval yet can pass. So a missed start doesn't automatically cost ABO points.

Words on this page

Also on this page: ABO ABO Energy, the original project developer · **Approval** a regulator's permission · **Condition** a rule attached to an approval or permit · **Extension** extra time allowed under a particular rule · **The Department** Nova Scotia Environment and Climate Change · **Shadow flicker** the flashing shadow of turning blades · **Bid administrator** the firm running the bidding · **Addendum** a formal change

How much it can do: a medium effect; on its own, it is unlikely to change whether the project goes ahead. The real value is in the conditions an extension could carry.

How to do it

1. **Ask and request on the same day.** Dan emails a short status question to the Department's environmental assessment branch and its Port Hawkesbury office (the office the approval names as its contact), and files an information request (FOIPOP) the same day. The email can offer to narrow or withdraw the request if the records are simply sent. It also asks how the Department would treat the approval if the date passed with no work and no extension, whether it would accept a late request, and to be told of any extension or change.
2. **What the request asks for:** any extension request, decision and reasons; ABO's start notice, and what the Department counts as a start; ABO's yearly status tables on each condition, due each 31 January; and any written permission to change the timing or file plans in phases.
3. **Check again on set days.** About 8 December (has a start notice arrived?) and about 7 January, Dan sends a dated email and files a dated request the same day, each for records created or received since the previous request. Do not forecast their response dates before actual complete-request and fee receipts, holds and extensions are known. For the January checkpoints, also use the direct status reply, the Province's project page and the site watch; a records request does not stop a separate decision clock.
4. **Write to the Minister** after the first reply or the first records, whichever comes first. Ask that any extension come with a new year of bird and bat baseline studies before construction (the approval already lets the Department require them). Ask also that it state that it covers only the registered project, up to six

Words on this page

Also on this page: FOIPOP Freedom of Information and Protection of Privacy · **ABO** ABO Energy, the original project developer · **Approval** a regulator's permission · **Condition** a rule attached to an approval or permit · **Extension** extra time allowed under a particular rule · **The Department** Nova Scotia Environment and Climate Change · **Information request** a request for a public body's records · **Commencement** starting work · **Concordance table** the approval holder's yearly status report · **Baseline** a dated record of how things are now

turbines and 42 MW, with any change going to the assessment branch first. The points to make:

- Natural Resources found bird-survey coverage "poor, particularly near Turbine 5 and Turbine 6", and asked for breeding-bird surveys "prior to turbine construction". The federal environment department found no point-count station (a fixed bird-counting spot) at any turbine location.
- The bird counts are from 2022 only; the radar and bat recordings from 2022–23. They would be 5–8 years old if construction follows ABO's 2028–30 estimate.
- Over 70% of the bat calls recorded were from migratory species. In May 2023 the national committee that assesses wildlife (COSEWIC) assessed all three migratory bats as Endangered. That assessment doesn't put them on the federal or provincial legal lists.
- Recent approvals require "an additional year of baseline" bird and bat studies before operation (Kmtnuk 2023, Clydesdale Ridge 2024, Eigg Mountain and Ocean Lake 2026). Rhodena's does not.

Group members send their own letters, in their own words, to match.

5. **Watch the site from public roads**, November to January: dated photos, no trespassing. If work starts, check the start rules and any written permission before saying anything is wrong. Clearing now and building in 2028 is the gap the federal fisheries and environment departments and Natural Resources warned about; the fisheries department said site preparation "too far in advance" may harm fish habitat.

When

Now. The email and request right away; dated checks about 8 December and about 7 January; the letter to the Minister as soon as

Words on this page

COSEWIC Committee on the Status of Endangered Wildlife in Canada: the national scientific committee that assesses species. Its assessment alone doesn't make a species legally protected.

Migratory bats hoary, eastern red and silver-haired bats: COSEWIC assessed them Endangered in May 2023. As of Sept 2026 they are not on the federal or Nova Scotia legal lists.

Also on this page: MW megawatt · **ABO** ABO Energy, the original project developer

the first reply or records arrive, before any extension is decided (don't wait for January); the site watch November to January.

Who

Dan does the records and the letter to the Minister. The group writes letters and watches the site.

Where this comes from

Environmental Assessment Regulations s.27 (start within 2 years; extension) and s.2(2) ("commence" includes site preparation); approval conditions 1.2, 3.2, 3.3, 3.4, 3.5, 3.12–3.13, 3.19, and the before-work and before-road-work items (4.1, 5.2–5.3, 6.1–6.2, 8.2, 9.1–9.2, 10.1, 11.1); Environment Act s.49(1)(o); superseded 2017 Department guide; Green Choice RFP II s.4.3(e)(iv) (7 EA points; 4.0 questionnaire); FAQ v.03 items 1–4 and disclaimer; s.2.6(a) and s.4.2(a)(vii) (viable path); Comments Part 1 (Natural Resources, 11 Dec 2024; ECCC, 28 Nov 2024; DFO); EARD ss.7.4.4–7.4.5 (survey years; bat calls); Kmtnuk, Clydesdale Ridge, Eigg Mountain and Ocean Lake approvals; Canso Spaceport extension (2021).

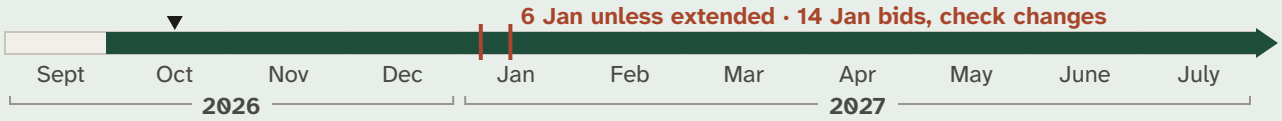
B2 Environment

Suggested action Do

Track each step ABO must take before work starts

Work required	Potential difference	Public opinion	Effect on go-ahead
Low	Medium	Low	Low

When Now; dated checks Dec and Jan; then at each step **Who** Dan; the group



Why this opinion rating: Careful records work; it can't be used to allege a breach until a documented step is missed.

What you can do

16 October update. The flyer makes the written record more urgent. Confirm the current approval holder, any qualifying commencement, written extension and review of the 42–98 MW alternatives. Keep the January 2025 six-turbine approval separate from the flyer. The 2028–2030 forecast is not evidence of a start, an extension or a breach.

Words on this page

ECCC Environment and Climate Change Canada: the federal environment department. Its Canadian Wildlife Service advises on birds and species at risk.

DFO Fisheries and Oceans Canada: the federal fisheries department; it decides whether work near fish habitat needs a federal authorization.

Also on this page: RFP request for proposals · **EA** environmental assessment · **FAQ** frequently asked questions · **EARD** Environmental Assessment Registration Document · **ABO** ABO Energy, the original project developer · **MW** megawatt

Build a dated table of every step the approval requires ABO to take before work starts, before road work, before turbines go up and before operation, and when each step was met.

Why it might help

Before any work (construction or site preparation):

- 30 days' written notice; for a start on 6 January 2027, that's by about **7 December 2026**;
- a sediment and erosion control plan;
- species and wetland data (to Natural Resources only) and a wildlife plan (to the Department, Natural Resources and the federal environment department);
- a complaint plan and a Mi'kmaq communication plan, developed and in place, and a complaint contact named to the Department;
- a contingency plan.

Before building or upgrading roads:

- the final turbine choice and positions, with updated noise (including baseline) and flicker modelling that must "demonstrate compliance" with the 40 dBA and 30-hour / 30-minute limits (**G3**). A change from the registered design goes to the assessment branch first (**B4**);
- a surface-water plan;
- archaeology testing completed for the areas of higher potential that can't be avoided (also before related ground disturbance). The results go to the heritage department and the Department before construction.

Before altering a wetland: a wetland alteration approval. Any project work or vegetation removal within **30 m** of a stream or wetland needs written authorization.

Before turbine construction (not necessarily before clearing): an adaptive management plan.

Words on this page

dBA A-weighted decibels: the usual measure of sound as the human ear hears it. The approval's limit at homes is 40 dBA.

Also on this page: ABO ABO Energy, the original project developer

Before operation: a bird and bat mortality program (to Natural Resources and the federal environment department only). Monitoring runs at least **2 years** from operation.

Each 31 January, until released in writing: ABO's yearly status table on each condition, and a monitoring summary.

- **"Submit" is not "get approved".** Only the wetland approval and the 30 m authorization need the Department's permission; other permits still apply. A filing must still meet its condition (the final-turbine filing must show compliance; archaeology testing must be complete). The complaint and Mi'kmaq plans must be in place before work, but go to the Department only on request, so it may not hold them. The Department can vary a timeline in writing, or consent in writing to a plan in phases; work may then go only as far as the completed phases. **Check all of this before alleging a breach.**
- **Where the dates come from.** Nothing is posted on Rhodena's project page after the approval (checked 27 September 2026); that is not evidence of a breach. Across about 70 Nova Scotia wind project pages, none shows a start notice, a yearly status table, or a wildlife, water, erosion, complaint or contingency plan filed after approval. Later postings are rare: two extension notes (2009, 2010) and two layout changes (Digby, 2010; Mersey River, 2023). So recheck Rhodena's page if the layout changes, and get the dates from records.
- **The link to the start deadline (B1).** If ABO starts work by about 6 January 2027 to meet the deadline, the notice and the seven before-work items must come first. If that work is road building or upgrading, the final turbine choice is needed too. ABO's project page (undated Q&A, read 27 September 2026) says the model is not finalized.
- **If a step is missed** (dated work before the required step, with no written variation): breaking a condition is an offence, and doing

Words on this page

Also on this page: ABO ABO Energy, the original project developer · **Q&A** questions and answers · **Approval** a regulator's permission · **Condition** a rule attached to an approval or permit · **Concordance table** the approval holder's yearly status report · **The Department** Nova Scotia Environment and Climate Change · **Commencement** starting work · **Extension** extra time allowed under a particular rule

the step late doesn't erase it, so use **B13**. The law's main tools are charges and orders, which can stop a specific activity. A missed step alone is unlikely to end the project.

How much it can do: medium.

How to do it

1. **Build the table:** each step's trigger, who receives it, the date it was met (and the record that shows it), and when the work it must come before began.
2. **Get the dates from records.** The first information request to the Department and the dated follow-ups in December and January (**D1**); add non-compliance notices, monitoring summaries, written releases, archaeology results and inspection records, and cover the Port Hawkesbury office. Natural Resources for the species data and, nearer operation, the mortality program. The federal environment department for the wildlife, adaptive and mortality plans (a federal information request).
3. **Get the dates of work** from the site watch (**B1**).

When

Now; dated checks about 8 December and 7 January; then at each step.

Who

Dan does the records; the group records the site-watch dates.

Where this comes from

Approval conditions 1.2, 3.3, 3.4, 3.5, 3.6, 3.7, 3.12–3.14, 3.20, 4.1, 5.1–5.3, 6.1–6.4, 7.1, 7.3, 8.2, 9.1–9.2, 10.1, 11.1; EA Regulations s.2(2); Environment Act s.158(f) and s.125(1)(a); Nova Scotia EA registry (about 70 wind project pages, checked 27 Sept 2026); **D1** #1, #4, #11–#12.

Words on this page

Also on this page: EA environmental assessment · **Approval** a regulator's permission · **Condition** a rule attached to an approval or permit · **Information request** a request for a public body's records · **The Department** Nova Scotia Environment and Climate Change

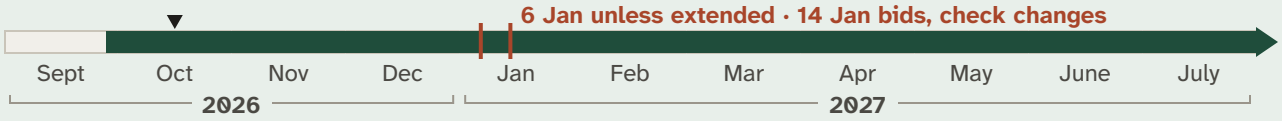
B3 Environment

Suggested action: Do

Find out how the wildlife agencies' concerns were settled

Work required	Potential difference	Public opinion	Effect on go-ahead
Low–medium	Medium	Medium	Low

When **Now; again after any start date passes** Who **Dan**



Why this opinion rating: The Province's own words, coverage "poor, particularly near Turbine 5 and Turbine 6", are quotable; the rest is technical.

What you can do

Get the records that show how the provincial and federal wildlife agencies' concerns about birds and bats were dealt with, and ask the Department to require bird surveys covering the final layout.

Why it might help

The concerns (agency comments, posted on the project page):

- The federal environment department: the Alberta bat-risk benchmark ABO used is "inappropriate for this project"; the rate should have used August to early-September nights, not the whole season.
- Federal: radar showed considerable night activity in the zone the blades sweep, especially in fall. It urged advance commitments to feathering, higher cut-in speeds and shutdowns at peak migration.
- Natural Resources: migration paths "cannot be inferred by diurnal counts alone". It wanted the wildlife plan to include measures such as shutdowns or higher cut-in speeds.

Words on this page

Feathering turning the blades edge-on: so they barely spin in low wind.

Cut-in speed the wind speed at which a turbine starts producing power. Below it, the blades can be feathered so they barely turn.

Also on this page: ABO ABO Energy, the original project developer

- Natural Resources: survey coverage is “poor, particularly near Turbine 5 and Turbine 6”. Do breeding-bird surveys before turbine construction, focused on modelled species-at-risk habitat. Federal: no bird-count station at any turbine site, or on the road east of turbines 5 and 6.
- Federal: map bat maternity-roost habitat and keep turbines and roads out of it.
- Natural Resources: bat detectors missed early May (they started on 13 May 2022 and 24 May 2023). Minimize work during the bat-active period, from early May to the end of October, rather than ABO’s proposed 1 April to 30 September window.
- Natural Resources: assess connectivity and cumulative habitat loss, especially for lynx (4.75 km of new road).

Where they stand on paper:

- No approval condition names these concerns. ABO must follow what it filed before the approval, but no ABO response is posted. Otherwise they fall to the plans due before work starts, chiefly the wildlife plan, and before turbines (adaptive management). Mortality monitoring runs at least 2 years from the start of operation. The Department can require more at any time.
- ABO’s registration offered no preventive curtailment. Its monitoring “may include” bat adaptive management if significant mortality is found, and breeding-bird surveys after construction. Its bird field surveys are from **2022** only (incidental sightings continued to 2024). Radar, night flight-call recorders and bat detectors ran **2022–23**.
- The Department’s 2025 wind checklist says projects “should conduct two years of bird and bat surveys covering the entire project area before starting operation”. **Five of the six** wind approvals since November 2025 require an extra year of bird and bat studies before operation. Rhodena’s January 2025 approval has no such condition.

Words on this page

Also on this page: ABO ABO Energy, the original project developer · **Approval** a regulator's permission · **Condition** a rule attached to an approval or permit · **Curtailment** slowing or stopping turbines

- The comments were advice. The federal department left sufficiency to the Province, and says bats fall under provincial authority. **A gap supports a request, not a breach claim.**

How much it can do: medium.

How to do it

1. **Records by information request, with no informal step first;** questions by email.
2. **Ask for:** for each concern, which submission dealt with it, before or after the approval, and what Natural Resources and the federal department said; any bird field surveys near turbines 5 and 6 since 2022; the monitoring summaries; and the agencies' comments on the wildlife and adaptive-management plans. The federal department's own files need a federal request, if needed.
3. **By email** (it asks for a decision, not a record): will the Department require bird surveys covering the final layout, especially turbines 5 and 6, before turbine construction, as Natural Resources advised?
4. **The plans may not exist yet.** A request reaches only records already held. So after any start notice, file a new request once the notified start date has passed, when the before-work plans should all be in (for a 6 January start, about 7 January); the adaptive-management plan needs a later one.

When

Now; again after any start date passes.

Who

Dan.

Where this comes from

Comments Part 1 (ECCC, 28 Nov 2024, PDF pp.52, 55–56, 58, 63; Natural Resources, 11 Dec 2024, PDF pp.34, 36–37); approval conditions 1.7, 2.2, 3.19, 3.20, 6.2–6.4; EARD s.7.4.4.4, 7.4.4.6, 7.4.5.4–7.4.5.6, 7.4.5.9; NSECC 2025 wind checklist; Aulds Cove approval conditions 6.4–6.5; **D1** #1 (request 1, parts 3, 5, 6), #4, #12; federal ATIP.

Words on this page

PDF Portable Document Format: the file format; a "PDF page" is the page number in the file, not the printed one.

NSECC Nova Scotia Environment and Climate Change: the provincial department that issued Rhodena's approval and enforces its conditions.

ATIP access to information and privacy: the federal version of an information request, made to a federal department.

Also on this page: ECCC Environment and Climate Change Canada · **EARD** Environmental Assessment Registration Document

B4 Environment

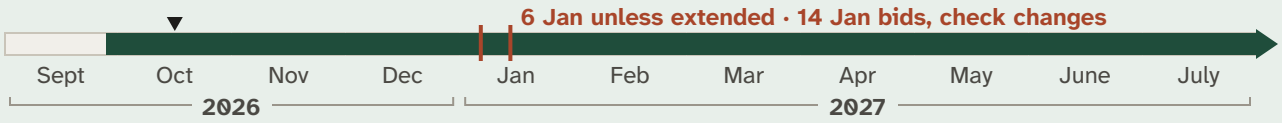
Suggested action

Watch; build the baseline now

Watch for changes to the turbine design

Work required	Potential difference	Public opinion	Effect on go-ahead
Low	Medium	Low–medium	Low
to compare	if a real change		

When **Baseline now; compare at each new disclosure** Who **Dan**



Why this opinion rating: A turbine taller than 200 m would be news if documented; today this is a baseline table.

What you can do

16 October update. The flyer makes the written record more urgent. Confirm the current approval holder, any qualifying commencement, written extension and review of the 42–98 MW alternatives. Keep the January 2025 six-turbine approval separate from the flyer. The 2028–2030 forecast is not evidence of a start, an extension or a breach.

Build a baseline table of the registered design now, and compare every new ABO disclosure against it.

Why it might help

The rules:

- Any proposed "expansion, modification, or relocation of any aspect of the Project" compared with the registration goes to the assessment branch first. It may ask for more information or a new assessment. A new assessment is not automatic.
- Before road work, ABO must submit its final turbine choice and positions, with updated flicker and noise modelling (including baseline noise) that shows compliance. It goes to the Port Hawkesbury office. It's a submission, not an approval.

Words on this page

Also on this page: MW megawatt · **ABO** ABO Energy, the original project developer · **Approval** a regulator's permission · **Condition** a rule attached to an approval or permit · **Baseline** a dated record of how things are now · **Commencement** starting work · **Extension** extra time allowed under a particular rule · **Shadow flicker** the flashing shadow of turning blades

The registered envelope. ABO modelled only one turbine, the Nordex N163 (118 m hub, 163 m rotor, 199.5 m to the blade tip). Its registration also lists alternatives: 4.5–7 MW, 110–140 m hub, 150–180 m rotor. Surveys covered 200 m around each turbine and 25 m either side of roads, "to allow design flexibility". The final-turbine rule expects a final pick, but nothing exempts a pick or a move within these from the change rule. The assessment branch decides.

Where a real change could show:

- **A tip over 200 m.** The public notice says "up to 200 m tall to the tip of the blade", and ABO sized the setbacks for a 200 m turbine. The largest listed hub with the largest rotor would reach about 230 m, though the registration states no tip height for them. The bird radar study set its rotor zone at 200 m "based on the proposed turbine height"; on spring peak nights, a greater share of targets flew higher.
- **Pads, roads or lines outside the surveyed buffers.**
- **The substation.** One drawing puts it just west-south-west of turbine 6; the noise model puts it about 1 km north-north-east. The baseline itself is unclear.
- **Noise.** The one receptor within 2 km models at **39.4 dBA**, including a 35.1 dBA background value, against the **40 dBA** limit. The Department's reviewer warned it "could exceed 40 dBA" if the background is higher. A different turbine can move noise and flicker either way (G3).

Past cases point to conditions, not a stop. Mersey River (2023, a near-identical change condition) moved some turbines, roads and its line corridor. One area of high archaeological potential fell within the new line layout, so the Minister amended its archaeology condition; the registry shows no second registration. Kemptown (2014) moved the whole project 3–4 km and re-registered.

Words on this page

Hub height the height of the rotor's centre: 118 m for the modelled turbine.

Tip height the height to the top of a blade: when it points straight up; up to 200 m registered.

Receptor a home or camp where the noise and flicker limits apply: permanent or seasonal. ABO modelled a list of them; the nearest, receptor A, is about 1.2 km away. The limits apply at any such place, not only those on the list.

Also on this page: ABO ABO Energy, the original project developer · **MW** megawatt · **dBA** A-weighted decibels

How much it can do: medium, if there's a real change.

How to do it

1. **Build the baseline table now** from ABO's registration:
   - turbine model, MW, hub, rotor and tip height;
   - pad coordinates;
   - about 4.75 km of new road, collector lines, the substation and the 138 kV connection;
   - wetlands: 14 or fewer altered (about 1.22 ha); 3 potential wetlands of special significance to avoid, one in a proposed pad (B7);
   - noise and flicker inputs: sound power, operating mode, baseline noise, receptors.
2. **Add to the status email** (B1): has anything been filed under the change rule or the final-turbine rule? Which tip height and substation site apply? The information request filed the same day asks for those filings, and for anything filed before the approval that isn't posted.
3. **Compare each ABO disclosure with the baseline:** the posting for the bid (A2), open houses, the county permit file (C1), the final-turbine submission. ABO must keep its bid confidential until the process ends and the selections are announced, unless the administrator authorizes disclosure in writing; the target for notifying winners is 6 May 2027.
4. **If a documented difference appears,** ask the assessment branch for a written view on whether it's a change, and send the facts through the fact-check package (A3). The administrator decides whether the approval fully represents the bid.

When

Baseline now; compare at each new disclosure.

Who

Dan.

Words on this page

kV kilovolt: a thousand volts. The 2024 Rhodena design proposed a new 138 kV line; recheck any changed design.

Wetland of special significance a wetland with extra protection. Use by a threatened or endangered species can support that classification; the Department decides. Altering one is harder, not impossible.

Also on this page: ABO ABO Energy, the original project developer · **MW** megawatt

Where this comes from

Approval conditions 1.2, 1.7, 3.5, 4.1, 7.1; EA Regulations s.3(2); registration notice; EARD s.3.1, 3.2.1, Tables 3.3–3.4, Drawings 2.3A–H, Appendices K–L, s.7.4.5.5, 7.4.5.9; Comments Part 1, item 8; Mersey River amendment (Environment Act s.41A); Kemptown (2014); RFP II s.3.12(d), s.3.3, s.4.3(e)(iv); Environmental Risk form s.3; **D1** #1 (request 1, parts 4–6).

B5 Environment

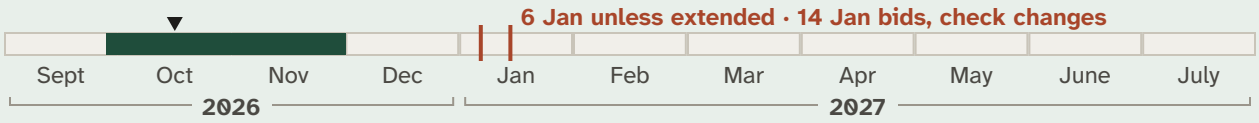
Suggested action

Scope it before December

An independent ecology review

Work required	Potential difference	Public opinion	Effect on go-ahead
Medium	**Medium–high**	**Low**	**Low**
it costs money	for operating rules; low–medium for siting		

When Scope and quote before December **Who** Dan



Why this opinion rating: An expert memo written for regulators; its value lies in what they do with it.

What you can do

Hire an independent specialist for a short desk review of ABO's bird and bat studies, and send the memo to the regulators.

Why it might help

The written brief for the specialist should cover:

- the agencies' concerns (B3), and whether later plans answered them;
- **a table in ABO's 2022 bat report** where migratory passes exceed total passes, for 13–31 May (**7 vs 6**) and 15–31 October (**2 vs 1**). Its rows also leave out 1–14 August, so they don't add up to the 139 total. Ask for a corrected table. The 2023 table adds up;
- **no bat detector at rotor height.** The microphones sat 4.6–10 m up. The 2023 report gives their range as up to 30 m for low-frequency calls and 10 m for high-frequency calls. The rotor zone is about 36–200 m, and no detector was in it. At best, the 10 m detector could hear low-frequency calls from the lowest few

Words on this page

Also on this page: EA environmental assessment · **EARD** Environmental Assessment Registration Document · **RFP** request for proposals · **ABO** ABO Energy, the original project developer · **Approval** a regulator's permission · **Condition** a rule attached to an approval or permit

metres of it. Radar showed "considerable" night activity in the rotor zone, but it was analysed as birds and can't tell bats apart;

- **coverage near turbines 5 and 6.** Natural Resources called bird-survey coverage "poor" there; the federal department found no point counts at any turbine site. By our calculation, the nearest bat detector was about **0.8 km from turbine 6** and **1.1–1.2 km from turbine 5** in both years. ABO says the sites stayed representative after review "in consultation with" the Province's Environment and Natural Resources departments, but quotes neither;
- **the data's age:** the bat and radar data are from 2022–23, and ABO targets operation in 2030;
- the old mine openings (**B11**).

Keep it honest. Recorded activity was low (**0.14 and 0.18** passes per detector-night), so frame the table as a quality issue, not proof of high risk. The stronger points: the federal department said low activity is "insufficient to conclude" the risk to at-risk bats is low, and no bat detector was placed in the rotor zone.

How much it can do: medium to high for operating rules; low to medium for where turbines go.

How to do it

1. Get a capped quote from an independent specialist with no current work for ABO, its consultant Strum, or Ausenco.
2. Ask for a short memo: which conclusions still stand, which gaps would change siting or operating rules, and an operating-rules package for **B6**. No field season until the expert says which decision it would change.
3. Send the memo to the assessment branch, Natural Resources' Wildlife Division and the federal department. Ask the Department to use its powers: updated plans, more studies or mitigation, and a third-party review at ABO's cost. Residents can't trigger that review, or bill ABO for their own expert.

When

Scope it and get a quote before December.

Words on this page

Also on this page: ABO ABO Energy, the original project developer · **Approval** a regulator's permission · **Condition** a rule attached to an approval or permit · **The Department** Nova Scotia Environment and Climate Change

Who

Dan.

Where this comes from

EARD Appendix H (2022 bat report p.8, Table 3.3; 2023 report pp.6, 14), Appendix K, s.7.4.4.4, pp.208–209; Comments Part 1 (ECCC comment 15; PDF pp.34, 55, 63); approval conditions 3.18, 3.19, 4.2.

B6 Environment

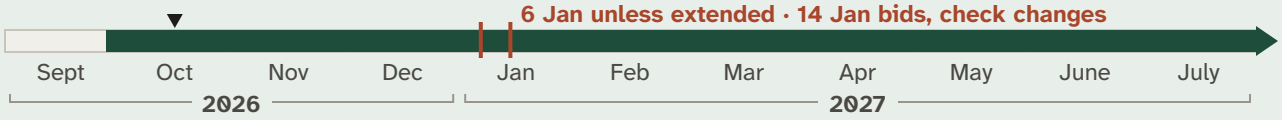
Suggested action

Ask

Ask for operating rules that reduce bat deaths from day one

Work required	Potential difference	Public opinion	Effect on go-ahead
Low	Medium	Medium	Low
to ask			

When Now, before the wildlife plans are filed **Who** Dan; the group



Why this opinion rating: The wildlife agencies already recommended preventive operating rules. That gives residents a concrete request, although the details are technical.

What you can do

Ask the regulators to require bat-safe operating rules (curtailment) from the first night of operation, not only after dead bats are found.

Why it might help

The ask:

- nightly curtailment through the bat season: a raised cut-in wind speed, with the blades feathered below it. Migratory-bat peaks were June–July in 2022 and September–October in 2023, so a late-summer-only window would miss part;
- shutdowns tied to weather, peak migration or bat detection; deterrents where proven;

Words on this page

Also on this page: **EARD** Environmental Assessment Registration Document · **ECCC** Environment and Climate Change Canada · **PDF** Portable Document Format · **Approval** a regulator's permission · **Condition** a rule attached to an approval or permit · **Curtailment** slowing or stopping turbines · **Cut-in speed** the wind speed at which a turbine starts producing power · **Feathering** turning the blades edge-on

- mortality monitoring (at least 2 years), corrected for searcher efficiency, scavenging and unsearched area, with a pre-set rule to tighten or ease the settings, reported in the yearly table;
- independent checks of turbine operating logs (the Department can make ABO pay for a third-party review).

The regulators already recommended this. The federal Canadian Wildlife Service rates the project "Category 4" ("Very High" sensitivity, its level for turbines over 150 m). It advised committing, before impacts occur, to higher cut-in speeds, feathering and shutdowns based on weather and peak migration. Natural Resources' Wildlife Division asked for "seasonal or detection-based shutdown systems" and higher cut-in speeds.

The gap in the published record. The approval names no curtailment; the adaptive-management condition asks only for a "decision-making process". ABO's bat mitigation covers clearing, lighting and habitat; operating changes come only through a contingency plan "if post-construction monitoring identifies significant bat mortality". ABO's consultant would decide "if curtailment is required" after monitoring. No wildlife or adaptive-management plan is posted; ask for the drafts (**B3**, **D1**).

Evidence. A 2024 review of six North American facilities estimated that a 5.0 m/s cut-in cuts bat deaths by about **62%** on average (33–79% expected at one site in one year). For hoary bats, Rhodena's most-recorded species, it was about 48% (Whitby and others, 2024). "About 80%" is a high-end figure. In a Pennsylvania trial over 75 summer and fall nights, a 5.0 m/s cut-in across the facility would have cost about **0.3%** of yearly output (Arnett and others, 2011). A longer season costs more; ask ABO for a Rhodena estimate.

Keep it honest. Activity is low, and ABO's consultant cites about 0.24 bat deaths per turbine per year in Atlantic Canada. The case is the agencies' precautionary advice for bats COSEWIC assessed as Endangered, not a forecast of mass deaths.

Words on this page

Also on this page: ABO ABO Energy, the original project developer · **COSEWIC** Committee on the Status of Endangered Wildlife in Canada · **Approval** a regulator's permission · **Condition** a rule attached to an approval or permit · **The Department** Nova Scotia Environment and Climate Change · **Cut-in speed** the wind speed at which a turbine starts producing power · **Feathering** turning the blades edge-on · **Curtailment** slowing or stopping turbines

How much it can do: medium.

How to do it

1. Send the ask to the assessment branch and Natural Resources' Wildlife Division. Copy the federal Canadian Wildlife Service; in November 2024 it said it had no permits or approvals for the project and that the Province manages bats.
2. Ask before the wildlife plan (due before work starts) and the adaptive-management plan (due before turbine construction).
3. Add it to the letter to the Minister (B1). Group letters can make the same ask.

When Before the wildlife plans are filed; with the letter to the Minister.

Who Dan writes the letter; the group writes letters to match.

Where this comes from Comments Part 1 (PDF pp.36, 52, 55, 58); approval conditions 3.19, 3.20, 4.2, 6.2–6.4; EARD pp.197–198; 2023 bat report p.14; Whitby et al. (2024); Arnett et al. (2011).

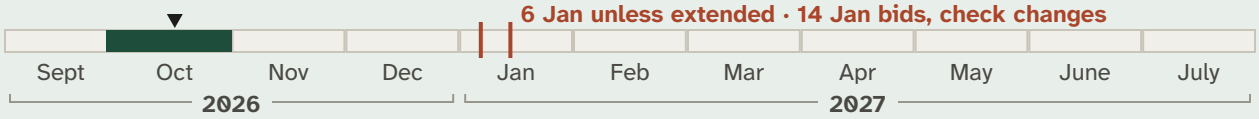
B7 Environment

Suggested action: **Records now; check the final layout**

Wetlands and streams

Work required	Potential difference	Public opinion	Effect on go-ahead
Low	**Medium**	**Low–medium**	**Low**
for records; medium for the technical check	high leverage on local design		

When **Records now; re-measure when the final layout is filed (date unknown)** **Who** **Dan**



Why this opinion rating: Local and specific, but species details must stay off social media.

What you can do Get the wetland and stream permits and decisions, and check the final layout against the streams and the three special wetlands.

Words on this page

Also on this page: **PDF** Portable Document Format · **EARD** Environmental Assessment Registration Document · **Approval** a regulator's permission · **Condition** a rule attached to an approval or permit

Why it might help

- **What the assessment mapped:** 36 wetlands and 26 watercourses. Up to 14 wetlands (about **1.22 ha**, a conservative estimate) and up to **11 watercourses** may be altered: five by new crossings (including Lamey Brook) and six at existing road crossings to be upgraded.
- **Permits needed** (status not public): wetland alteration approvals; an approval, or for qualifying culverts and bridges a notification, for each crossing that alters a watercourse; and written authorization for any work, refuelling or vegetation removal within **30 m** of a stream or wetland.
- **Three potential wetlands of special significance**, all with Canada warbler (endangered in Nova Scotia). ABO says they "can be avoided during detailed design"; the Department decides. ABO puts one "in a proposed turbine pad": a drawing outlines it about **40 m from turbine 4**, yet ABO's table (which assumes 120 m × 120 m pads) shows no alteration. Ask for the turbine 4 pad footprint.
- **Special significance is not an automatic veto.** The policy allows a "necessary public function", which includes electrical supply infrastructure. Since 2023, unpublished Department guidance limits the species-at-risk test to threatened or endangered species (per CBC). Canada warbler qualifies (it is also threatened federally).
- **The county's stream setback is 60 m,** measured from the tower base. It covers turbines; roads fall under the 30 m rule.
  - As modelled, **turbine 5 is about 50 m from Lamey Brook** on ABO's field map (73 m on the provincial stream map), though ABO's table says 60 m was applied. It's a drawing measurement: ask the planning commission to verify it. A compliant layout needs turbine 5 moved, or a lawful variance (C3).

Words on this page

CBC Canadian Broadcasting Corporation: CBC News, the public broadcaster.

Also on this page: ABO ABO Energy, the original project developer

  - Turbine 6 is about **25 m** from a mapped wetland, inside the 30 m buffer. ABO's table already counts about 0.43 ha of loss there.
- **The federal fisheries department** decides, work by work, whether a federal authorization is needed. It said crossing designs, fish passage and fish habitat in wetlands were not yet specified (14 November 2024).

How much it can do: medium, with high leverage on the local design.

How to do it

1. **Records** (in the first information request): wetland and watercourse applications, approvals and notifications; 30 m authorizations; the special-wetland decisions. A separate request asks for the current criteria for special wetlands, including the unpublished 2023 guidance.
2. **Ask the Department** to require current wetland evaluations (its guide expects them within 12 months but may accept older ones) and the micro-siting its Water Branch advised. Press for the avoidance ABO says is possible.
3. **When the final turbine positions are filed,** re-measure turbines 4 to 6, and check the crossings in the surface-water plan and the applications. Raise gaps with the Department and the planning commission (C3).
4. Keep species details off social media (B12).

When

Records now; re-measure at the final layout.

Who

Dan.

Where this comes from

EARD s.7.3.3.5–7.3.3.6, Tables 3.3, 7.20, 7.37, Drawings 7.13A and 7.13C; approval conditions 3.5, 3.7, 4.1, 5.1–5.2; Activities Designation Regulations s.5A–5B; Wetland Conservation Policy pp.12, 18; CBC (29 Sept 2023); Blue Felt Lichen Management Plan (2025) p.26; county wind LUB s.4.4(e) and Part 6; DFO comment (14 Nov 2024); **D1** #1 (request 1, part 7) and #13.

Words on this page

LUB land-use bylaw: a county's zoning rules. Inverness has a separate wind-turbine LUB (2012, amended Sept 2025).

Also on this page: ABO ABO Energy, the original project developer · **EARD** Environmental Assessment Registration Document · **CBC** Canadian Broadcasting Corporation · **DFO** Fisheries and Oceans Canada

B8 Environment

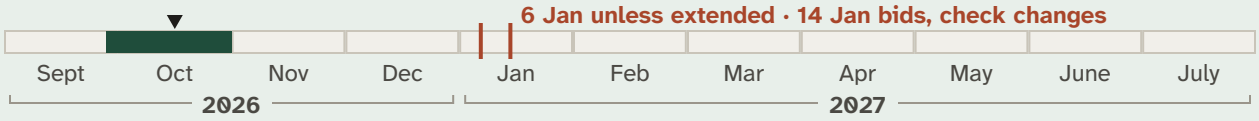
Suggested action

Records now; review before road work

Roads, lynx, old growth and lichens

Work required	Potential difference	Public opinion	Effect on go-ahead
Medium	Medium–high	Medium	Low
	for design		

When **Records now; review before road work (date unknown)** Who **Dan**



Why this opinion rating: Lynx and old forest matter to many people, but exact locations stay private.

What you can do

Get the road and wildlife plans before road work, and check the roads against lynx habitat, the old-growth stand and the lichen buffers.

Why it might help

- **Cumulative effects.** The assessment left land habitat, plants and animals out of its cumulative-effects review, reasoning that much of the clearing would be logged anyway. Natural Resources asked for a connectivity and cumulative analysis, "in particular for Canada Lynx".
- **Roads:** 4.75 km of new road plus about 5 km of existing road, not the "nearly 70%" existing that ABO's website claims.
- **Lynx** (endangered in Nova Scotia):
  - Natural Resources said the new roads allow through-travel that can let coyotes into lynx habitat, and that mitigation is "required". Provincial practice favours dead ends and blocking or decommissioning roads. ABO limits access only "if deemed necessary" after collisions rise.

Words on this page

Decommissioning taking something out of service. Here, usually taking the turbines down and restoring the site at the end of the project's life; for roads, closing and restoring them.

Also on this page: ABO ABO Energy, the original project developer

  - The assessment's winter tracking (12 transects, 2022–23) found no lynx sign, and the older lynx management area (2012 practices) is 2.7–4 km away.
  - **But the 2025 provincial lynx recovery plan, newer than the assessment, maps modelled core habitat about 0.5–1.5 km from the turbines, to the north, west and south** (desk overlay, approximate). It names wind projects as a possible threat. It identifies core habitat but doesn't legally designate it.
- **Old growth:** six stands overlap the assessment area; one surrounds turbines 1, 2, 5 and 6, on private land. The no-clearing commitment covers Crown land only. On private land ABO commits to "clearing only the area necessary".
- **Lichens:** blue felt lichen has two occurrences on private land (to be avoided) and three on Crown land within the Province's 100 m buffer; frosted glass-whiskers has four on private land. Neither is covered by the provincial ban on disturbing endangered and threatened species (which covers lynx, but not these), and since 2023 neither makes a wetland "special". Protection rests on ABO's commitments and the wildlife plan.

How much it can do: medium to high, for the design.

How to do it

1. In the first information request: the plans due before road work (final placement, surface water) and before work starts (erosion, wildlife).
2. Check the roads against through-road links, the 2025 core habitat, the old-growth stand and the lichen buffers.
3. Ask Natural Resources which of its recommendations reached the wildlife plan, and whether it applied the 2025 lynx plan (B3).
4. Don't publish lichen locations.

When

Records now; review before road work.

Who

Dan.

Words on this page

Also on this page: ABO ABO Energy, the original project developer · **Approval** a regulator's permission · **Condition** a rule attached to an approval or permit · **Core habitat** the areas a recovery plan says a species needs most · **Old growth** old forest · **Crown land** land owned by the Province · **Information request** a request for a public body's records

Where this comes from

EARD Table 14.2, s.7.4.1, s.7.4.2.6; Natural Resources comments (11 Dec 2024); 2025 Nova Scotia lynx recovery plan, Figure 4; Endangered Species Act ss.13, 16–17; approval conditions 2.2, 4.1, 5.2–5.3, 6.2; **D1** #1.

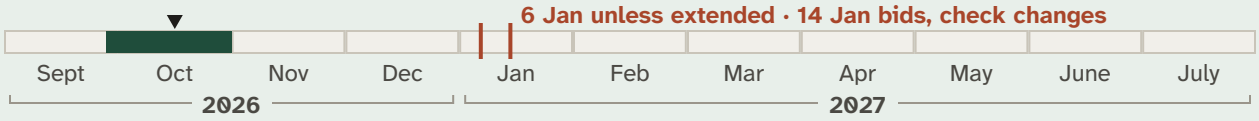
B9 Environment

Suggested action: **Before any work**

Test your well before any work

Work required	Potential difference	Public opinion	Effect on go-ahead
Low	Protective	Low	Low

When Ask now; test before construction (date unknown) **Who** Households near the site



Why this opinion rating: Well testing protects individual households; the results remain private, so it has little direct public reach.

What you can do

If you live near the site or on General Line Road, get your well tested before construction, and ask ABO to offer checks.

Why it might help

- **No automatic tests.** Blasting is "not anticipated". If it's needed, ABO will notify landowners and survey wells within **800 m** of the blast under the Department's pre-blast procedure. The Water Branch asked for field checks of those wells, and no blasting within 800 m of homes where possible.
- **Wells:** the assessment counts 101 drilled wells within 2 km of the study area, only one within 800 m of the assessment area. Its source, the provincial well-log database, holds few dug wells (about 5% of records; the nearest is about 8 km from the turbines) and no springs, so nearby dug wells and springs aren't counted. General Line Road, the planned access route, has homes.
- ABO must replace water supplies "lost or damaged resulting from Project operations, as authorized and required by the

Words on this page

Also on this page: EARD Environmental Assessment Registration Document · **ABO** ABO Energy, the original project developer · **Approval** a regulator's permission · **Condition** a rule attached to an approval or permit · **The Department** Nova Scotia Environment and Climate Change

Department." A dated baseline shows what changed; it doesn't prove the cause on its own.

- An active quarry (Rhodena Quarry) adjoins the study area. A baseline helps separate its effects from the project's.

What it does: protects your household if the project is built.

How to do it

1. **Households nearest the site and on General Line Road:** test before construction. Bacteria plus a metals package through Nova Scotia Health costs about **$155–175** a well; Strait Richmond Hospital in Cleveland takes both. Keep the report, the well log, water-level notes and dated foundation photos. Results stay private.
2. **Ask ABO in writing** to offer baseline quality and quantity checks to those households, and to field-check all water supplies, including dug wells and springs, before any blasting.
3. **Ask the Department** whether the water-replacement condition covers construction as well as operation.

When

Ask now; test before construction.

Who

Households nearest the site and on General Line Road. The written asks aren't assigned yet.

Where this comes from

EARD s.7.2, s.8.2.2, Table 14.1; approval conditions 2.2 and 5.5; Water Branch comment (Comments Part 1).

Words on this page

Also on this page: ABO ABO Energy, the original project developer · **EARD** Environmental Assessment Registration Document · **Approval** a regulator's permission · **Condition** a rule attached to an approval or permit · **The Department** Nova Scotia Environment and Climate Change · **Baseline** a dated record of how things are now

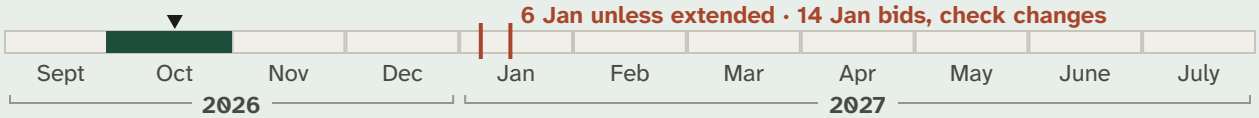
B10 Environment

Suggested action: Do

Archaeology and the 1884 settlement map

Work required	Potential difference	Public opinion	Effect on go-ahead
Low	Low–medium	Medium	Very low
desk check done	local avoidance, testing, or moving a pad or road segment		

When **Ask now; compare at final design (date unknown)** Who **Dan**



Why this opinion rating: The 1884 map with the turbines on it is shareable and striking for people with roots here; lists of likely sites are not.

What you can do

Ask the heritage department what ABO's archaeologists found and tested, share the 1884 map comparison with it privately, and compare the final layout when it's filed.

Why it might help

- **What the assessment found.** ABO's archaeologists assessed the site in 2022, 2023 and 2024. The 2024 fieldwork recorded **2 cellars, 2 possible cellars** and **9 areas** of high or moderate potential. The heritage department counted **8** areas and accepted avoidance, or recording and testing where avoidance isn't feasible. ABO says no sites lie within the new roads, and that sites beside existing roads to be upgraded can be avoided by widening on the other side.
- **The rules.** On any archaeological or fossil find, work stops and the heritage department is called; for a possible Mi'kmaw find, also the Mi'kmaq representatives it advises. Before road work or ground disturbance, any area of higher potential from the 2024 fieldwork that can't be avoided must be tested, with the results

Words on this page

Also on this page: ABO ABO Energy, the original project developer · **Approval** a regulator's permission · **Condition** a rule attached to an approval or permit

going to the heritage department **and** the Department before construction. ABO also promised a new assessment for any disturbance outside the assessed areas, and the approval requires the project to follow its registration.

- **The 1884 map.** On Dan's provisional fit of Hugh Fletcher's 1884 Geological Survey map, which shows roads, buildings and landholders' names, ABO's 2024 turbines and roads sit among roads and building marks of the time.
  - The fit is provisional: checks against modern roads and streams are off by 5 to about 180 m, with no tested error bound.
  - The turbines and roads are ABO's 2024 design, not the final layout.
  - The map was compiled from surveys for reports dated 1879–84, so a mark's date is uncertain. A mark is a map symbol, not a cellar hole, and says nothing about what remains today.
- **Sharing.** The 1884 map with the turbines can be shared (see "Project facts and the map"). The detailed comparison goes privately to the heritage department, never into public posts (looting risk), and so do its site records and maps.

How much it can do: low to medium: local avoidance, testing, or moving a pad or road segment. Effect on whether it goes ahead: very low.

How to do it

1. **Records by information request** (no email first): the reports from all three phases, with sensitive location details removed, and the heritage department's acceptance letters. Expect locations to be withheld.
2. **Questions by email** to the heritage department's Special Places program (SPP@novascotia.ca), the same day: which historic maps were used; 8 areas or 9; and whether any recorded feature

Words on this page

Hugh Fletcher the Geological Survey of Canada geologist: whose 1884 Cape Breton map sheets show roads, streams and buildings.

Also on this page: ABO ABO Energy, the original project developer

or area lies beside the roads to be built, widened or upgraded. Offer the 1884 comparison privately.

3. **At final design,** compare the pads, roads, junctions and any widening with the 1884 map. Before construction, file a new request to the Department for the test results.
4. **If work threatens archaeological remains,** recorded or not, tell the heritage department at once. The Minister may stop the work for 30 days, and Cabinet can extend that for a site survey and salvage.
5. **No digging, metal-detecting or searching for sites.** That needs a heritage research permit, and even a permit needs the landowner's consent. Knowingly altering remains without one is an offence.

When Ask now; compare at final design.

Who Dan.

Where this comes from EARD s.9.1–9.4, p.248, p.262; Heritage Research Permits A2022NS129 and A2024NS150; Comments Part 2, p.21; approval conditions 2.2, 4.1, 8.1–8.2; Special Places Protection Act ss.8, 9, 12, 13; FOIPOP s.19; **D1** #9; Hugh Fletcher, Geological Survey of Canada, Cape Breton sheet 19 (1884).

Words on this page

A2022NS129 heritage research permit (2022): the permit for ABO's earlier archaeology work.

A2024NS150 heritage research permit (2024): the permit for ABO's 2024 archaeology fieldwork.

Also on this page: EARD Environmental Assessment Registration Document · **FOIPOP** Freedom of Information and Protection of Privacy · **ABO** ABO Energy, the original project developer

B11 Environment

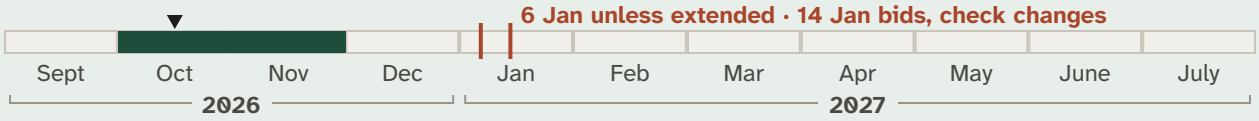
Suggested action

Do, but don't oversell

Old mine openings and hibernating bats

Work required	Potential difference	Public opinion	Effect on go-ahead
Very low	Low–medium	Low	Low
a few inquiries	none confirmed; already top risk category		

When **October–November** Who **Dan; a volunteer**



Why this opinion rating: No hibernation site is confirmed and the plan says don't oversell; if bats are found, the location stays private.

What you can do

Ask whether the old mine openings the assessment listed as possible bat hibernation sites have ever been checked for bats. Don't oversell it.

Why it might help

- **The assessment** says there are no *known* hibernation sites within 25 km of the study area. It relied on a 2007 study, with records up to 2005, before white-nose syndrome, which had no bat records from any Cape Breton cave or mine and said many hibernation sites "must remain to be discovered"; and on Natural Resources' October 2022 word that none were known within 60 km. Hibernation sites have since been identified on the island (the nearest federal critical-habitat square is about 70 km northeast); the assessment's table leaves them out.
- **Of 131 mine openings** within 25 km of the study area, the assessment lists **8** that "could potentially support overwintering habitat" (over 30 m deep, and not recorded as filled, capped, plugged or flooded): two coal adits and three slopes at **Port Hood Mines**, one shaft at Little River Reservoir, and two slopes at Whiteside.

Words on this page

White-nose syndrome a fungal disease of hibernating bats. Bat records from before it may be out of date.

- **Checked on 27 September 2026** against the Province's abandoned-mine database:
  - Distances from the nearest turbine (2024 layout; approximate): Port Hood Mines about 25.9–26.4 km; Whiteside about 27.5 km; Little River Reservoir about 19 km, the only one of the 8 within 25 km of a turbine. So the Port Hood sites are **just outside 25 km** of the turbines, and inside it only from the study-area boundary.
  - No field visit or hazard rating is recorded for the five Port Hood and two Whiteside openings (original depths 35–215 m). Inspectors visited 11 *other* Port Hood openings in October 2023 (all recorded as filled). So the database can't say whether these seven are still open. "No visit recorded" is about mine safety, not proof that no bat survey was done.
  - Seven of the 8 are on private land.
  - The nearest recorded opening is about 7 km from the turbines (a 6 m pit), so the database gives no ground-hazard angle at the site, though it is not a complete record.
- **The same consultant screened differently a year later.** Its December 2025 assessment for Aulds Cove also counts a 30 m coal adit about 12 km from the nearest Rhodena turbine, and three Port Malcolm openings about 23 km away. Rhodena's screen left them out; all four have plug records. Whether such plugs keep bats out is a question for the Wildlife Division.
- **Why the effect is limited.** The 25 km screen came from the 2021 wind guide; the 2025 checklist asks for potential bat habitat "in or near the project site", with no set distance. Rhodena is already in the top risk category, because its turbines exceed 150 m. A confirmed hibernation site would not by itself stop the project. It could support curtailment (**B6**) and more surveys.

How much it can do: low to medium.

Words on this page

Also on this page: Approval a regulator's permission · **Condition** a rule attached to an approval or permit · **Hibernaculum** a place where bats hibernate · **Curtailment** slowing or stopping turbines

How to do it

1. **Information request to Natural Resources** for the records behind its 2022 "none within 60 km" answer, and any bat checks of the 8 since white-nose syndrome. **By email** (it needs a view, not a record): ask the Wildlife Division whether the four plugged openings count.
2. **Ask bat researchers the same,** starting with ACAP Cape Breton, which the 2018 federal recovery strategy says had monitored "known and potential hibernacula" on the island since 2013.
3. **Ask the Province's mine-openings program** whether the seven uninspected openings are still open, and that any closure be checked for bats first.
4. **Nobody enters or visits.** Most are on private land, two on residential lots. Unassessed openings are dangerous, and disturbing a hibernation site used by endangered bats is an offence. If bats are confirmed, keep the location out of public posts.

When

October to November.

Who

Dan (the request); a volunteer (the emails).

Where this comes from

EARD s.7.4.4.3, Table 7.58, pp.185–186, Appendix H; Moseley (2007); 2018 federal recovery strategy; NS abandoned mine openings database, version 9 (June 2024); Strum Consulting, Aulds Cove EARD (Dec 2025), Table 7.62; 2021 NS wind guide; 2025 NSECC wind checklist; EARD s.4.1; Endangered Species Act s.13(1)(c) and s.22; **D1** #4.

Words on this page

ACAP Atlantic Coastal Action Program: ACAP Cape Breton; a 2018 federal recovery strategy says it has monitored known and potential bat hibernation sites since 2013.

NS Nova Scotia: the province.

Also on this page: EARD Environmental Assessment Registration Document · **NSECC** Nova Scotia Environment and Climate Change

B12 Environment

Suggested action

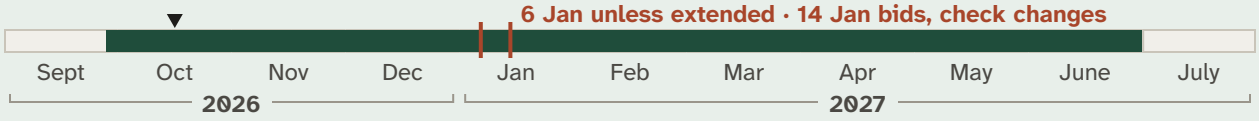
Seasonal; lynx map now

Record species at risk, carefully

Work required	Potential difference	Public opinion	Effect on go-ahead
Medium	Medium	Low–medium	Low
■■■□□	■■■□□	■■□□□	■□□□□
	only if new, verified and near the footprint		

When **Lynx map now; find nests Nov–Jan, check use Mar–May; lynx tracks Dec–Mar; warblers June**

Who **Volunteers; Dan (lynx map)**



Why this opinion rating: Volunteers can take part, but exact locations stay private and repeat sightings add little.

What you can do

Volunteers can record new, verified evidence of species at risk near the turbine sites and roads, and send it privately to the right agencies.

Why it might help

- **Already on record:** Canada warbler in three wetlands (one at a proposed pad; ABO expects the design to avoid all three), other listed birds, and bald eagles. Winter 2022–23 lynx surveys found no tracks or scat. **Repeat sightings add little;** breeding evidence, or use of a spot near the final pads or roads, can still matter.
- **What would matter:**
  - a hibernation site (B11);
  - verified lynx sign on or near the ridge. Lynx is **endangered** under Nova Scotia's endangered-species law (listed 2002), which bans disturbing the animal or its den;
  - listed birds breeding near turbines 5 and 6. Natural Resources called survey coverage there "poor" and asked for pre-construction breeding-bird surveys to inform the wildlife

Words on this page

Also on this page: ABO ABO Energy, the original project developer · **Approval** a regulator's permission · **Condition** a rule attached to an approval or permit · **Hibernaculum** a place where bats hibernate

plan. No condition names them; the records requests should show whether they were required;

- a threatened or endangered species using a wetland near the final pads or roads. That can make it a wetland of special significance: harder, not impossible, to alter. Since 2023, vulnerable or special-concern status alone doesn't count. The Department decides (B7);
- any eagle nest within **400 m** of a pad or road, even one that looks unused. The provincial wildlife law bans disturbing any bird's nest without a permit. Natural Resources' 2012 eagle-nest practices (written for forestry) set zones out to 400 m and a **February–July** breeding season; its comments asked for nest buffers.

- **New since the approval: the 2025 lynx recovery plan.** It names proposed Cape Breton wind projects and roads as threats, and maps lynx "core habitat". A rough desk overlay of that map puts the turbine sites **about 0.5–1.5 km** outside a mapped patch in the Creignish Hills that wraps round them on the north, west and south. At about 200 m per pixel, it can't show whether any pad or road touches core habitat. The plan identifies core habitat but doesn't designate it; that needs a regulation and a Royal Gazette notice, and none was found as of 27 September 2026.

How much it can do: medium, but only if the evidence is new, verified and near the footprint.

How to do it

1. **Now (desk work):** request the core-habitat map layer from Natural Resources (D1). Use it in the letter to the Minister if it arrives in time; the plan's map will do otherwise. Once the final footprint is filed, ask Natural Resources by email whether it meets core habitat.
2. **How to record:** dated GPS photos, tracks with a ruler in the frame, or recordings. Send them to the Atlantic Canada Conservation Data Centre, Natural Resources' regional biologist and, for federally listed species, the Canadian Wildlife Service.

Words on this page

GPS Global Positioning System: satellite positioning, as in a phone's location.

3. **Keep locations private.** iNaturalist and eBird are public. On iNaturalist, set geoprivacy to "Obscured" and keep landmarks out of photos; "Obscured" or "Private" can still leak through photos, notes and nearby open posts. On eBird, log a general location, not the exact spot, or wait until the birds have left. Hiding a checklist hides the species, but its date and location may still show.
4. **Seasons:**
   - eagle nests: find them in leaf-off, November to January; check use in March to May from 200 m or more away;
   - lynx tracks: December to March, 1–3 days after 10 cm or more of new snow. Lynx prints are about 9–12 cm wide in snow, round and blurred by fur; bobcat prints about 5–7 cm and crisper;
   - Canada warbler: June at dawn, in wet, shrubby woods. Keep the audio; the Merlin app only suggests an identification. A bird singing at the same spot a week or more apart counts as probable breeding.
5. **Rules:** public roads, open Crown land, or private land with the owner's permission. No playback, bait or approaching nests or dens. Never enter mine openings. Don't publish exact locations of nests, dens or hibernation sites.

When Eagle nests November to January (use March to May); lynx December to March; warblers in June; the lynx map now.

Who Volunteers; Dan requests the lynx map.

Where this comes from EARD (Canada warbler records; 2022–23 lynx transects); Endangered Species Act ss.13, 16–17; Wildlife Act s.51; Natural Resources eagle-nest practices (2012); 2025 lynx recovery plan, Figure 4; eBird breeding code S7; **D1** #4; the research plan's corrections to the volunteer kit (Task 9).

Words on this page

Also on this page: EARD Environmental Assessment Registration Document · **Approval** a regulator's permission · **Condition** a rule attached to an approval or permit · **Leaf-off** when the leaves are down · **Crown land** land owned by the Province · **Hibernaculum** a place where bats hibernate

B13 Environment

Suggested action

Hold until facts exist

Use the law's complaint tools, only on documented facts

Work required	Potential difference	Public opinion	Effect on go-ahead
Low	Medium	Low	Low
if facts exist			

When **Only when a documented fact exists** Who **Whoever documents the fact**

When triggered · date unknown

Why this opinion rating: Reports go to the regulator and need documented facts. New evidence can support changes even without a breach.

What you can do

If a dated, documented fact shows a condition was broken, or new evidence appears, use the provincial environment law's tools. Not before.

Why it might help

The breach route. Breaking an approval condition is an offence.

- Complain first to the Department's Port Hawkesbury office, as the Department advises. If that fails or the breach continues, **any person** can apply for a formal investigation. It may need a solemn declaration; wilfully false information is an offence.
- The Minister must report on progress within **90 days**, and can drop the investigation only with written reasons.
- On reasonable grounds of a past or expected breach, the Minister can order a specified activity to stop. An order shutting down the whole undertaking needs a likely *irreparable* adverse effect.

The new-evidence route (no breach needed).

- The easiest ask: the approval lets the Department require updated plans, extra studies, monitoring or mitigation at any time.

Words on this page

Also on this page: Approval a regulator's permission · **Condition** a rule attached to an approval or permit · **The Department** Nova Scotia Environment and Climate Change

- A formal amendment of the approval needs an adverse effect that "has occurred or may occur", or must concern monitoring, reporting or a standard. Anyone can ask, with evidence; ABO's own request is a separate ground. An amendment is a fresh decision (B14).

Facts that would qualify (dated, from public roads):

- work before the 30-day notice or a required before-work plan (check phased consents and written variations first; B2);
- clearing in the nesting period ABO said it would avoid, "generally from April 1 to September 30". Check the wildlife plan first, and report it to the Department as a discrepancy, not a breach;
- wetland work without an approval;
- new evidence, such as a hibernation site (B11) or lynx (B12).

Never allege a breach before a deadline passes, or from an empty website (B2).

How much it can do: medium.

How to do it

1. **Document the fact:** dated photos and notes, from public roads.
2. **Check first:** the relevant plan, any phased consent and any written variation.
3. **Complain** to the Port Hawkesbury office.
4. **If that fails or the breach continues,** apply for a formal investigation.
5. **For new evidence,** ask the Department to use its power to require more studies, monitoring or mitigation.

When

Only when there is a documented fact.

Who

Whoever documents the fact.

Where this comes from

Environment Act s.41A, s.115, s.116, s.125(1)(a), s.126, s.158(e)–(f); approval conditions 1.2, 2.2, 3.3, 3.7, 3.12–3.13, 3.18–3.19, 6.2; EARD s.7.4.5.9.

Words on this page

Also on this page: ABO ABO Energy, the original project developer · **EARD** Environmental Assessment Registration Document · **Approval** a regulator's permission · **Condition** a rule attached to an approval or permit · **The Department** Nova Scotia Environment and Climate Change · **Hibernaculum** a place where bats hibernate

B14 Environment

Suggested action

Get legal advice fast

Court review of a fresh decision

Work required	Potential difference	Public opinion	Effect on go-ahead
High	High	Low–medium	Low
■■■■□	■■■■□	■■◧□□	■■□□□
	potentially		

When **Within days of any extension, change or permit** Who **Dan, with a lawyer**

When triggered · date unknown

Why this opinion rating: A court challenge can attract attention, but success is uncertain and usually means the decision is reconsidered.

What you can do

If the Minister grants an extension or changes the approval, or the county issues a permit or a variance, get legal advice fast: the deadlines are short.

Why it might help

Which decision, which route:

- **A Minister's extension, an amendment of the approval, or the county permit:** court review (judicial review) is the likely route. The approval decisions themselves can't be appealed, and only the applicant can appeal a permit refusal. The provincial environment law's 30-day appeal may also cover an extension or amendment; it runs from the decision date, so plan to the earliest deadline.
- **An approval such as a wetland alteration:** a person "aggrieved" can appeal to the Minister within **30 days of the decision**, then to the Supreme Court within 30 days.
- **A granted county variance:** notified owners have **14 days** from receiving notice to appeal to council.

The court-review deadline is the earlier of **25 days** after you're told of the decision and **6 months** after it's made. The 25 days exclude

Words on this page

Also on this page: **Approval** a regulator's permission · **Condition** a rule attached to an approval or permit · **Judicial review** asking a judge to review a decision · **Extension** extra time allowed under a particular rule · **Variance** a lawful, limited adjustment of a bylaw rule · **Development permit** the county's planning permit for a large turbine

weekends and court-closed days, so about 5 weeks. Extensions are at a judge's discretion; don't rely on one.

The catch: an extension needs no public notice (**B1**), and the 6-month limit runs anyway. Ask the assessment branch in writing, with the first status email, to tell you of any extension or amendment. The later checks are the dated emails and requests of about 8 December and 7 January (**B1**). Those requests are due about 7 January and 6 February, later if extended: possibly after a 30-day appeal period from the decision date has run. **An information request doesn't stop any of these clocks.**

Standing: a genuine local group can get public-interest standing.

The odds. Review asks whether the decision was reasonable, and a 2024 court challenge to another Nova Scotia wind project's approval failed. A win usually means the decision is remade. Filing doesn't stop work. Seek a stay with the motion for directions unless a judge orders other timing; a judge can grant an interim stay until then. Costs normally follow the result.

How much it can do: potentially high. Effect on whether it goes ahead: low.

How to do it

1. **Now:** ask the assessment branch in writing to tell you of any extension or amendment (with the **B1** email).
2. **As soon as a consequential decision is known,** get targeted legal advice. East Coast Environmental Law's free inquiry line gives general information only.

When

Within days of any extension, change or permit.

Who

Dan, with a lawyer.

Words on this page

Standing the right to bring a case: A genuine local group can get public-interest standing.

Stay a court order pausing a decision: while a case is heard. Filing a case doesn't stop work by itself.

Where this comes from

EA Regulations s.27(2); Environment Act s.41A, s.137, s.138(1)(d)–(e), s.138(2); MGA s.236(3) and s.247(3); Civil Procedure Rules 2.03, 7.05, 7.29, 77.03(3), 94.02; *Ecology Action Centre*, 2023 NSCA 12 (standing); *Higgins Mountain*, 2024 NSSC 27.

B15 Environment

Suggested action

Only on a specific trigger

Federal routes, only on a specific trigger

Work required	Potential difference	Public opinion	Effect on go-ahead
High	**Low** in general	**Low**	**Low**

When **Only on a specific trigger** **Who** **Not assigned**

When triggered · date unknown

Why this opinion rating: Onshore wind requests have been refused; only a specific trigger justifies one.

What you can do

Keep the federal options in reserve for a specific trigger; don't lead with them.

Why it might help

- The federal impact assessment agency said on 7 November 2024 that the project, as proposed, is not on its project list. Its wind entries are offshore or boundary-water only, so more onshore turbines wouldn't trigger them.
- **Designation.** The federal Minister can designate a project that "may cause adverse effects within federal jurisdiction" (for example, on migratory birds or fish), or effects tied to a federal approval or funding. Whether other processes can handle them is a factor. A reasoned answer is due in 90 days, but the clock can be paused.
  - Since **27 March 2026**, a Canada–Nova Scotia co-operation agreement has Canada rely on provincial processes for mainly provincial projects, including on these requests. The power to designate remains.

Words on this page

MGA Municipal Government Act: the provincial law that governs councils, planning, permits and municipal records.

NSCA Nova Scotia Court of Appeal: used in case citations.

NSSC Supreme Court of Nova Scotia: the province's main trial court; used in case citations.

Also on this page: EA environmental assessment

  - Onshore wind requests have been refused, including ABO's own Smoky River project in Alberta (September 2024) and Madawaska in Quebec (February 2025). The federal registry shows no Rhodena request (27 September 2026).
  - Designation is barred once work has "substantially begun", or once a federal authority has used a power that could let the project proceed.

- **The federal species law's** bans don't reach listed land species (little brown and northern myotis, tri-colored bat) on non-federal land unless Ottawa orders it. They do reach endangered or threatened migratory birds on any land, such as Canada warbler (threatened). Hoary, eastern red and silver-haired bats are on neither the federal nor the Nova Scotia list.
- **Nova Scotia's endangered-species law is the key law** for little brown and northern myotis, tri-colored bat, lynx and Canada warbler. It protects places "occupied or habitually occupied", including a "hibernaculum or den". Permits are only for conservation science or human health or safety.
- **Migratory bird rules:** no killing or harassing migratory birds, or disturbing their nests. Most nests lose protection once they hold no live bird or viable egg. Empty pileated woodpecker and great blue heron nests need written notice to the federal department 36 and 24 months ahead, and must stay unused. The rules set no clearing dates; ABO's clearing commitment is provincial (B13).

How much it can do: low, in general.

How to do it

1. Use a federal route only on a specific trigger, such as documented effects on migratory birds or fish, or a federal approval or funding.
2. Report suspected harm to migratory birds or their nests to the federal environment department.

When

Only on a specific trigger.

Who

Not assigned.

Words on this page

Also on this page: ABO ABO Energy, the original project developer · **Approval** a regulator's permission · **Condition** a rule attached to an approval or permit · **Hibernaculum** a place where bats hibernate

Where this comes from

Impact Assessment Act s.9(1), (2)(d), (4)–(5), (7); Physical Activities Regulations items 44–45; Impact Assessment Agency letter (7 Nov 2024, Comments Part 1); Canada–Nova Scotia co-operation agreement (27 Mar 2026); Species at Risk Act s.34; NS Endangered Species Act s.13(1)(c) and s.14(1); Migratory Birds Regulations, 2022, s.5(1)–(2) and Sch. 1.

Words on this page

Also on this page: NS Nova Scotia · **Approval** a regulator's permission · **Condition** a rule attached to an approval or permit

C

Chapter C · 6 ideas

The county: permit, bylaw and council

Council has no vote on the turbine permit, and the Province has capped what county rules can require. But the county's permit file is a public record, its setbacks still have to be met or lawfully relaxed, and council can put residents' questions on the record and ask for a clean-up bond.

	Idea	Work	Difference	Opinion	Go-ahead	Page
C1	Get the county's permit file	**Very low**	**High** for information	**Low**	**Low** directly	84
C2	Get the official zone of each turbine site in writing	**Very low** one email	**Low** now; medium if turbines move off these lots	**Low**	**Low**	86
C3	Check the layout against the county's setbacks	**Low** desk check; medium for the file	**Medium**	**Low–medium**	**Low** unless setback relief can't be had	88
C4	Go to council: a delegation and a resolution	**Low–medium**	**Low–medium**	**High**	**Low**	91
C5	Ask council to require a clean-up bond	**Medium**	**Medium** reaches Rhodena only if in force before the permit it is built under	**Medium–high**	**Low**	94
C6	Why the Province changed the county's wind rules	**Low**	**Low**	**Low–medium**	**Low**	97

Words on this page

Also on this page: **Setback** a minimum distance · **Clean-up bond** proposed financial security for removal

C1 County

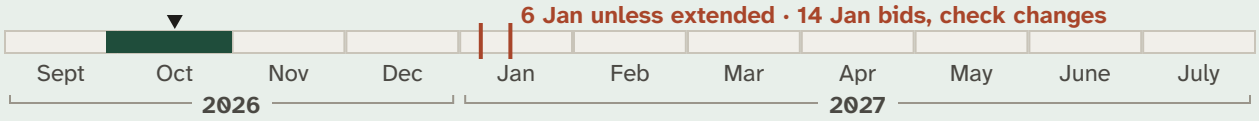
Suggested action

Do now

Get the county's permit file

Work required	Potential difference	Public opinion	Effect on go-ahead
Very low	High	Low	Low
	for information		directly

When **Now** Who **Dan**



Why this opinion rating: A records request; what it finds may matter later.

What you can do

16 October update. The measurements and desk findings below refer to the 2024 six-turbine layout. Obtain any changed turbine positions, models, heights, roads and connection lots before applying them to the flyer's 42–98 MW range. Neither MW nor a new owner identifies a new footprint or a permit decision.

Request the county's development-permit file for Rhodena from the planning commission.

Why it might help

- The Development Officer keeps applications, permits, orders, inspections and their papers as "public records of the County". The Eastern District Planning Commission does this for the county.
- **The status is unknown.** A turbine permit this early is unlikely: ABO plans construction for 2028–30, and a permit lapses if work doesn't start within 12 months. Council minutes from July 2025 to 30 July 2026 have no Rhodena item, but that can't settle it.
- A zoning letter from the planning commission (**$50**) confirming as-of-right zoning earns **2 bid points**, so one may exist before bids close on 14 January 2027.

Words on this page

Development Officer the planning official: at the planning commission who issues development permits. A permit that meets the bylaw must be issued; council has no vote.

Also on this page: MW megawatt · **ABO** ABO Energy, the original project developer

How much it can do: high, for information. On its own it is unlikely to change whether the project goes ahead; the question that could is C3.

How to do it

1. **File an access request with the planning commission** (the county rules mirror FOIPOP), with no informal step first. Ask for:
   - the application and permit status, dates, file number, parcel numbers and the bylaw version applied;
   - any zoning confirmation, certificate or property status report;
   - any notice that the application is incomplete, and any site plan, drawings, conditions, expiry and renewals;
   - variances and setback waivers, with the leases or easements relied on (C3);
   - a document index;
   - any applications or permits for roads, the substation and lines.
2. **Send the zoning email (C2) the same day.** It can offer to withdraw the request if the planning commission simply sends the file. Whether roads, the substation and lines need their own permits is a question for that email.
3. Confidential third-party details may be severed; ask for the rest.

When

Now.

Who

Dan.

Where this comes from

Inverness wind LUB s.2.2, s.2.4–2.5, s.2.9.1; MGA Part XX (s.461, s.465(1), s.481) and s.245(1); RFP II s.4.3(e)(v); Plan Inverness LUB s.4.1.1 and s.4.2.1(f); **D1** #2.

Words on this page

Also on this page: **FOIPOP** Freedom of Information and Protection of Privacy · **LUB** land-use bylaw · **MGA** Municipal Government Act · **RFP** request for proposals · **Condition** a rule attached to an approval or permit · **Variance** a lawful, limited adjustment of a bylaw rule · **Setback** a minimum distance · **Waiver** giving up or excusing a requirement · **Easement** a right to use someone else's land

C2 County

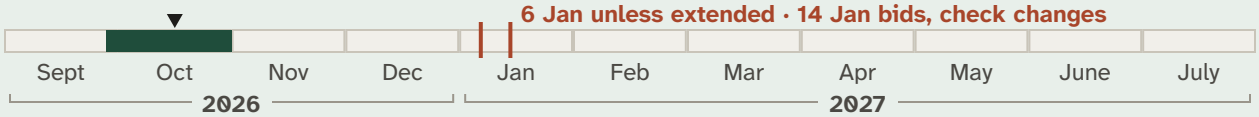
Suggested action

Do now, with the permit request

Get the official zone of each turbine site in writing

Work required	Potential difference	Public opinion	Effect on go-ahead
Very low	Low	Low	Low
one email	now; medium if turbines move off these lots		

When **Now; recheck when the final layout is filed (date unknown)** Who **Dan**



Why this opinion rating: A technical check.

What you can do

16 October update. The measurements and desk findings below refer to the 2024 six-turbine layout. Obtain any changed turbine positions, models, heights, roads and connection lots before applying them to the flyer's 42–98 MW range. Neither MW nor a new owner identifies a new footprint or a permit decision.

Email the planning commission for the official zone of each turbine site and each project lot, in writing.

Why it might help

- **A desk overlay puts all six turbines in the general rural wind zone,** where large turbines need a development permit. Turbine 1 is about **300 m (±50 m)** from the edge of the coastal zone, where only small domestic turbines are allowed; the others are 780 m or more away. The lot holding turbines 1–4 stays about 100 m or more from the coastal zone; a detached piece of the lot holding turbines 5–6 touches its edge (within map error). Only the planning commission can confirm the boundary.

Words on this page

Also on this page: MW megawatt · **Development permit** the county's planning permit for a large turbine

- The planning commission's public map has no Inverness wind-zone layer. Get each turbine's and each lot's zone in writing, and recheck at the final layout.
- **Check which route supports the 2 bid points.** The as-of-right confirmation covers grid-connection lots too and excludes other discretionary planning approval; ask how any setback waivers are treated. The October 15 amendment also permits an executed development agreement with the applicable municipality for the project. It concerns the project site, facility and ancillary works. Obtain the actual agreement if that route is claimed; no such Rhodena agreement is established here. This bid-scoring option does not establish a permit or change the county's planning powers.

How much it can do: low now; medium if turbines move off these lots.

How to do it

1. One email, sent the same day as the permit-file request (C1).
2. Recheck when the final layout is filed.

When

Now; recheck at the final layout.

Who

Dan.

Where this comes from

County wind zoning map (Sept 2025); wind LUB s.4.2(b) (GR-1, permit) and s.5.2 (UTE-1, domestic turbines only); RFP II s.4.3(e)(v) and Appendix A ("As-of-Right Zoning"); Addendum 2 item 1 and FAQ v.03 item 19; EDPC public GIS; desk overlay of the county map on provincial road data (27 Sept 2026; well-fitting variants gave 250–320 m).

Words on this page

GR-1 the general rural wind zone: the county wind zone where large turbines are allowed with a development permit. All six 2024 positions plot in it on an unofficial desk overlay; the planning commission must confirm.

UTE-1 the coastal wind zone: the county wind zone along the coast where only small domestic turbines are allowed.

EDPC Eastern District Planning Commission: the regional planning office that does Inverness County's planning; its Development Officer issues development permits.

GIS geographic information system: mapping software and data.

Also on this page: LUB land-use bylaw · **RFP** request for proposals · **FAQ** frequently asked questions

C3 County

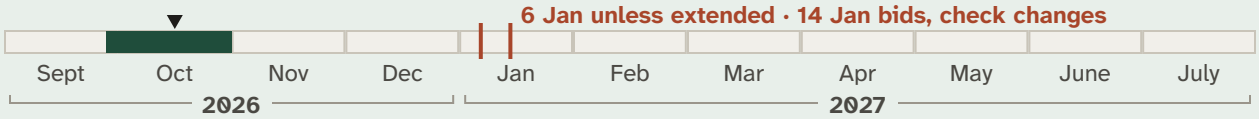
Suggested action

Do

Check the layout against the county's setbacks

Work required	Potential difference	Public opinion	Effect on go-ahead
Low	**Medium**	**Low–medium**	**Low**
desk check; medium for the file			unless setback relief can't be had

When **Now; again when the final layout is filed (date unknown)** **Who** **Dan**



Why this opinion rating: The desk map suggests setback relief is needed. The official file may show lawful waivers or a variance, so this is a question to verify.

What you can do

16 October update. The measurements and desk findings below refer to the 2024 six-turbine layout. Obtain any changed turbine positions, models, heights, roads and connection lots before applying them to the flyer's 42–98 MW range. Neither MW nor a new owner identifies a new footprint or a permit decision.

Check the turbine layout against the county's property-line and stream setbacks, and ask the planning commission how any relief would be granted.

Why it might help

Property lines are the main constraint. Since **11 September 2025** the setback from property lines is 10 m plus the turbine height (ground to the tip of an upright blade), measured from the tower base: about **209.5 m** for the modelled turbine. ABO's assessment used **128 m** (10 m plus the 118 m hub height). Even the old "rotor height" rule gave about 173 m.

A desk check of the 2024 layout (county parcel map, not a survey):

- Turbines 1–4 stand on one private lot, turbines 5–6 on another. **Turbines 2–6 are about 72–75 m from Crown land lines**, inside

Words on this page

Also on this page: **MW** megawatt · **ABO** ABO Energy, the original project developer · **Setback** a minimum distance · **Waiver** giving up or excusing a requirement · **Variance** a lawful, limited adjustment of a bylaw rule · **Hub height** the height of the rotor's centre · **Crown land** land owned by the Province

even 128 m. Turbine 1 is about 176–202 m from the road allowance, a private lot and Crown land: also short.

- No point on the turbine 5–6 lot is more than about 100 m from its edges; on the turbine 1–4 lot only one spot, near turbine 1, reaches about 210 m. So any layout of more than one such turbine on these lots needs setback relief: waivers or a variance. (ABO's page says its planning is "within regulated setbacks": a question for the fact-check package.)

Waivers: a wind lease of the neighbouring land for 19 years or more, or an easement binding future owners (discretionary since 2025, and never over an owner who hasn't agreed in writing). Waivers carry no public notice.

- For Crown land, that means Natural Resources. ABO already needs a Crown easement for roads and lines, and the call for bids says easement applications are considered only after a contract is signed. Whether setback waivers wait too is unclear.
- At 72–75 m, an 81.5 m blade could swing over Crown land. Ask how that fits the call for bids' bar on any part of the generating facility being on Crown land (A3).

A variance: the bylaw contemplates setback variances. Ask the planning commission whether one could apply here. It can't if it "violates the intent" of the bylaw, and the county's planning strategy permits wind farms "provided that all of the turbines meet the setback requirements", with waivers for "consenting landowners". Unlike a waiver, a granted variance needs notice to owners within at least 30 m of the lot, who have **14 days from receiving it** to appeal to council.

Streams (60 m): ABO's own field map puts Lamey Brook about **50 m from turbine 5**, apparently inside the setback, and a stream about 65 m from turbine 6. The site plan must show watercourses and setbacks; check it, and the final layout.

Words on this page

Also on this page: ABO ABO Energy, the original project developer · **Crown land** land owned by the Province · **Setback** a minimum distance · **Waiver** giving up or excusing a requirement · **Variance** a lawful, limited adjustment of a bylaw rule · **Easement** a right to use someone else's land

Other setbacks look met: homes at 4× height, about 800 m, more if noise needs it (the closest home is 1.2 km away); spacing (closest pair 466 m); coastline (2.3 km); highways (60 m). **But** turbine 1 is about 190 m from General Line Road, which is listed as a provincial road, while ABO's assessment says the closest public road is 2.9 km away and gives a 421.5 m ice-throw distance. Raise it through the fact-check package (**A3**) and **E3**.

A complete application needs a signed application; a site plan; specifications and CSA certification; a map of noise over 40 dBA; Transport Canada and NAV CANADA authorizations (**F1**); the environmental assessment; a habitat statement (compare **B12**); and a decommissioning plan. A survey can be required.

Process: a permit that meets the bylaw must be issued. Only the applicant can appeal, and only a refusal, so, variances aside, other people's route is court review (**B14**). A permit lapses if work doesn't start within 12 months; any deviation needs a new permit; and a permit issued on false or mistaken premises can be revoked.

How much it can do: medium. Effect on whether it goes ahead: low, unless the needed setback relief can't be had.

How to do it

1. The desk check is done (above). Keep it as a question, not a charge: relief can be granted lawfully.
2. Request the waiver documents from the planning commission (in the **C1** request), and any request to Natural Resources for waivers over Crown land (**D1**).
3. Ask the planning commission whether a variance could apply, and to verify the turbine 5 stream distance.
4. At the final layout, check the site plan's streams and setbacks.

When

Now; again at the final layout.

Who

Dan.

Words on this page

CSA Canadian Standards Association: CSA Group, which certifies equipment.

Also on this page: ABO ABO Energy, the original project developer · **dBA** A-weighted decibels · **NAV CANADA** the company that runs Canada's civil air navigation

Where this comes from

County wind LUB s.2.7–2.12, s.4.4(a), (c)–(e), (g), s.4.5.2 (it cites 4.4(d), apparently an old number), s.4.5.6, Part 6; MPS s.2.5, Policy R-6; MGA s.235(1)(b), s.236, s.246(1), s.247(3); EARD Tables 3.1 and 3.3, s.2.1, s.10.1.2, s.13.4, Drawing 7.13C; RFP II s.2.3(b)(v) and (v)(A); county parcel map (desk check, 27 Sept 2026); **D1** #2, #4.

C4 County

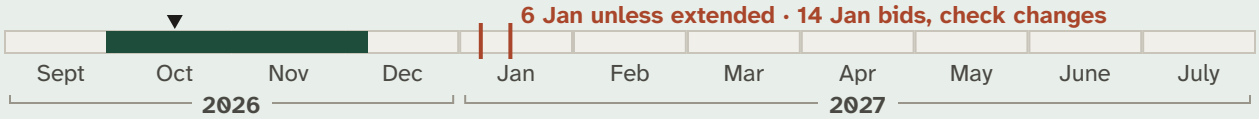
Suggested action

Do

Go to council: a delegation and a resolution

Work required	Potential difference	Public opinion	Effect on go-ahead
Low–medium	Low–medium	High	Low

When **Request now; aim for a decision about 3 Dec; meeting dates unconfirmed** **Who** **The group**



Why this opinion rating: A delegation can bring residents' questions into a public meeting and attract local coverage. Council may refuse or defer it.

What you can do

16 October update. Reconfirm the actual council meeting and delegation cutoff. The September plan's meeting estimates are historical. Ask council to address the current owner, proposed design range and records gaps, without claiming a larger project is already approved.

Ask to present to council as a delegation, and ask council to pass a resolution of requests and records. Not a judgment on the permit.

Why it might help

What to ask for. Requests and records only; council hears variance appeals, so it shouldn't prejudge the permit.

1. No municipal support letter for the bid, and any request for one decided by recorded motion.
2. Ask the Minister, before any extension, for refreshed surveys, and to hold the project to the six registered turbines.

Words on this page

MPS municipal planning strategy: a council's planning policy; bylaws must carry it out.

Also on this page: **LUB** land-use bylaw · **MGA** Municipal Government Act · **EARD** Environmental Assessment Registration Document · **RFP** request for proposals

3. Ask that any expansion beyond six turbines get a new environmental assessment. The Department decides; the approval says it "may require" one.
4. A public status report from the planning commission: the application, the bylaw version, completeness, and any zoning confirmation for the bid (C1, C2).
5. A staff report on a decommissioning bond (C5, E2).

The limits of the first ask. It covers only the optional support letter (**0.5 points** each, up to **4**). Keep the distinct **2-point** zoning criterion separate: it now permits as-of-right confirmation or an executed development agreement (C2). An ordinary support letter does not satisfy the new agreement option.

- Councillors' own letters may or may not count; the administrator's answers left it open (not verified). Ask each councillor too (A1). ABO's assessment records one councillor's support in May 2024; the same six councillors sit now.
- Keep checking for addenda until bids close (**14 January**, unless moved); 29 October is only the scheduled deadline for them. The October 15 amendment is now checked: it adds an executed development agreement, not an ordinary support letter, as the zoning alternative (C2).

The process:

- The county's online form says **14 days** ahead and **10 minutes**; its 2011 policy says **10 working days** and 15 minutes. Go by 10 working days and 10 minutes, with a written presentation to the Council Administrator (the chief administrative officer). Council may refuse or defer.
- No resolution comes at the meeting where the delegation speaks unless two-thirds vote it urgent; it may come at the next council meeting. Formally, the Committee of the Whole only recommends.

Words on this page

Also on this page: ABO ABO Energy, the original project developer · **Approval** a regulator's permission · **Decommissioning** taking something out of service · **Clean-up bond** proposed financial security for removal · **Support letter** a letter backing the bid · **As-of-right** allowed under the zoning rules · **Bid administrator** the firm running the bidding · **Addendum** a formal change

- A councillor can also move it, or give notice of motion.

The timing (not confirmed: only 1 October is posted; these dates follow the first- and third-Thursday pattern; confirm with the Council Administrator):

- For a decision about **3 December**, present in November: request by **22 October** (for 5 November) or about **4 November** (for 19 November).
- A 3 December presentation pushes the resolution to about 7 January, after the start deadline of about 6 January.
- Sooner is better: 15 October needs the request by about **29 September**.

The record. Community Wind presented on 3 March 2022 (about 18 turbines); ABO on 20 July 2023 (15) and 2 May 2024 (6). Posted minutes (2021 to July 2026) show no Rhodena support letter, but letters can issue by "direction to staff" (16 July 2026).

How much it can do: low to medium.

How to do it

1. Confirm the meeting dates and the deadline with the Council Administrator now.
2. Send the request, 10 working days ahead, with a written presentation.
3. Present for 10 minutes, covering the five asks.
4. Ask a councillor to move the resolution at the next meeting, or to give notice of motion.
5. Dan's county request asks for any support letters, resolutions and past presentations (D1), with no informal step first.

When

Request now; aim for a decision by about 3 December.

Who

The group.

Where this comes from

Addendum 2 item 1 and FAQ v.03 item 19 (15 Oct 2026); MGA s.236–237; EA Regulations s.27(2) and s.11(3); approval condition 3.5; RFP II s.4.3(e)–(f), s.3.5(c); FAQ v.02 items 16 and

Words on this page

Also on this page: ABO ABO Energy, the original project developer · **FAQ** frequently asked questions · **MGA** Municipal Government Act · **EA** environmental assessment · **RFP** request for proposals · **Support letter** a letter backing the bid · **Addendum** a formal change · **Approval** a regulator's permission · **Condition** a rule attached to an approval or permit

34; EARD Table 6.1; county delegation form; 2011 delegation policy; Bylaw 31 s.6; Proceedings Policy s.19 and s.32; council minutes (2021 to July 2026; 16 July 2026, item 11); **D1** #2.

C5 County

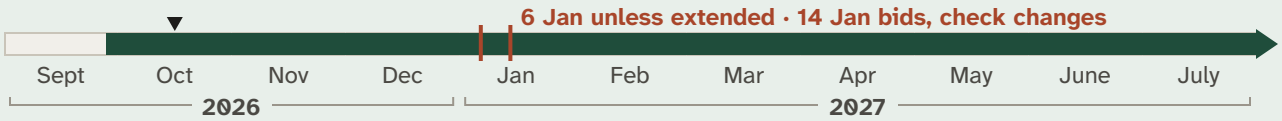
Suggested action

Ask council to require a clean-up bond

Do, through the council delegation

Work required	Potential difference	Public opinion	Effect on go-ahead
Medium	**Medium**	**Medium–high**	**Low**
	reaches Rhodena only if in force before the permit it is built under		

When **Start now; a change takes months** Who **The group (with the delegation)**



Why this opinion rating: "Who pays for removal?" is easy to understand. A new security rule could protect future large wind projects; whether it reaches Rhodena depends on timing.

What you can do

Ask council to change its wind rules so that a clean-up bond (financial security the county can call on to pay for removal) is required before any permit, for all future large wind projects.

Why it might help

Council has already pointed staff this way. On **6 July 2023** it directed them to use Cumberland County's wind bylaw "for future changes (e.g. decommissioning of turbines …)". No security followed: the 2025 bylaw requires a decommissioning plan and removal after a year idle, but no bond. Ask council to finish the job.

Two working models:

- **A bond before the permit** (Colchester County, in force since **12 June 2025**): at least **125%** of the estimated removal cost, less scrap value, estimated by an engineer or other qualified person.

Words on this page

Also on this page: EARD Environmental Assessment Registration Document · **Clean-up bond** proposed financial security for removal · **Decommissioning** taking something out of service

The county can call it. Wind turbines stay allowed as-of-right: by permit, without a separate discretionary planning decision.

- **A development agreement** (Cumberland County): the same **125%** bond, plus failure notices, a complaints process and a compliance report. A development agreement may include security, is registered, and binds later owners, which matters if Rhodena is sold (A4). Don't copy Cumberland's 1,000 m home setback, which can exceed the 2025 cap.
- Either way, ask for the security **before the permit**, with cost updates, clear terms for calling it and a stated scope. ABO's assessment leaves site roads and turbine foundations to the landowner leases (E2).

The route is for the planning commission and the county solicitor. A bylaw can set conditions before a permit only where the planning strategy provides for them. The wind strategy covers site plans and removal, but not security, so it may need amending. A strategy change goes to the Province, which can amend or refuse it; a bylaw-only change made under the existing strategy does not.

The regulations allow it. A plan may use development agreements; West Hants still requires them for wind farms. The 2025 limits: for projects of 2 MW or more, the home setback can't exceed the greater of 4× the height or the distance needed for the 40 dBA and flicker limits, and visual impact can't be a factor.

A development agreement is not a veto. It brings a public hearing and a council vote. The developer or an "aggrieved person" can appeal to the provincial board within **14 days** of the notice, only on whether council reasonably carried out its planning strategy. In May 2026 the board ordered West Hants to approve a wind development agreement it had refused. The protection is in the terms.

Words on this page

Also on this page: ABO ABO Energy, the original project developer · **MW** megawatt · **dBA** A-weighted decibels · **As-of-right** allowed under the zoning rules · **Clean-up bond** proposed financial security for removal · **Setback** a minimum distance · **Condition** a rule attached to an approval or permit · **Shadow flicker** the flashing shadow of turning blades

Timing for Rhodena:

- The permit status is unconfirmed; ask first (C1). A permit issued before the first hearing notice is protected if work starts within 12 months and is finished as permitted within a reasonable time.
- After that notice, a permit that conflicts with the change can't issue for **150 days**; then it must issue under the existing bylaw if the change isn't in force. The 2025 wind amendments took about **eight months**, from the January 2025 notice to taking effect on 11 September. Start early.
- A county permit lapses unless work starts within 12 months. ABO's estimates put a possible award in spring 2027 and construction in **2028–2030**. So a change in force in 2027 could still reach Rhodena, unless ABO already holds a permit it keeps alive.

Frame it as fiscal protection for all future large wind projects: who pays for removal and restoration if an owner fails. The Province struck 2025 county setbacks that lacked "a clear rationale" (C6), so base each term on cost evidence. Keep it to what the county controls: General Line Road and Rhodena Road are provincial, so work in their rights-of-way needs a Public Works permit (E1), and aviation lighting is federal (F2).

How much it can do: medium, and it reaches Rhodena only if it is in force before the permit Rhodena is built under.

How to do it

1. Ask through the council delegation (C4, the fifth ask): a staff report on decommissioning security.
2. Point to the two models, and base each term on cost evidence.
3. Ask for the security before the permit, with cost updates, clear terms for calling it and a stated scope.

When Start now; a change takes months.

Who The group, with the council delegation.

Words on this page

Also on this page: **ABO** ABO Energy, the original project developer · **Development permit** the county's planning permit for a large turbine · **Setback** a minimum distance · **Decommissioning** taking something out of service

Where this comes from

Council minutes, 6 July 2023; county wind LUB s.2.7.3(d), s.4.5.4; Colchester LUB s.8.9.1 and s.8.9.3; Cumberland MPS Policies 4-56A–B; county wind MPS Policy R-12 and s.2.7; MGA s.208, s.210(1), s.220(5)(j), s.227(1)(h), s.228(4), s.230, s.234, s.238(2)(b), s.246(3)–(4), s.247(2), s.249(1), s.250(1)(b); Minimum Planning Requirements Regulations s.6(b), s.14, s.15 (added by N.S. Reg. 51/2025); *Bear Lake Wind*, 2026 NSRAB 76 (26 May 2026, para 55 on West Hants).

C6 County

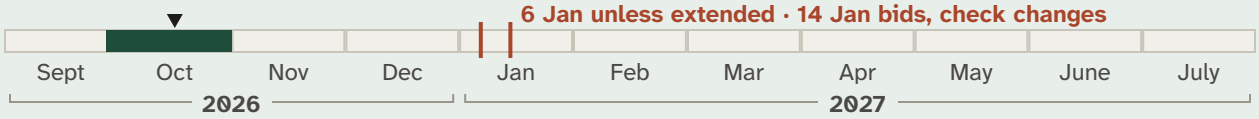
Suggested action

Optional

Why the Province changed the county's wind rules

Work required	Potential difference	Public opinion	Effect on go-ahead
Low	**Low**	**Low–medium**	**Low**

When **Now, with the permit-file request** **Who** **Dan**



Why this opinion rating: "The Province overrode the county" resonates locally, but it won't reopen the 2025 decision.

What you can do

Get the Province's reasons for cutting the county's 2025 wind setbacks.

Why it might help

- **The outline is public.** On **29 July 2025** the Minister approved the county's May 2025 wind amendments with changes. The home setback went from the greater of 1,500 m or 5× the height to **4× the height**; increases to **50 m** plus height (property lines and highways) and **2,000 m** (coast) were refused. The cover letter says the home setback broke the regulations' maximum, and that the other changes lacked "a clear rationale" or appeared to rest on "visual impact".

Words on this page

N.S. Nova Scotia: used in regulation and case citations (N.S. Reg. 51/2025 is a Nova Scotia regulation).

NSRAB Nova Scotia Regulatory and Appeals Board: the provincial board that hears planning appeals (cases are cited as NSRAB).

Also on this page: **LUB** land-use bylaw · **MPS** municipal planning strategy · **MGA** Municipal Government Act

- The Provincial Director of Planning's earlier notice must give reasons, and it isn't in the posted package.
- **Use:** it shows what evidence the Province wants before it accepts local rules, which the bond ask (C5) needs. **It won't reopen the 2025 decision.**

How much it can do: low.

How to do it

1. Ask the county, in a separate request filed the same day as C1, for the Provincial Director of Planning's earlier notice, and the Municipal Affairs correspondence council logged on 3 July 2025.
2. Only if that is thin: an information request to Municipal Affairs for the staff review and its evidence. Advice can be withheld, but background information can't be withheld as advice.

When

Now, with the permit-file request.

Who

Dan.

Where this comes from

MGA s.208(4)(b) and s.208(6); Municipal Affairs approval letter (30 July 2025); council minutes, 3 July 2025; Municipal Affairs file 09-11-0016; FOIPOP s.14(1)–(2); **D1** #2 and #7.

Words on this page

Also on this page: MGA Municipal Government Act · **FOIPOP** Freedom of Information and Protection of Privacy · **Clean-up bond** proposed financial security for removal · **Information request** a request for a public body's records · **Approval** a regulator's permission

D

Chapter D · 6 ideas

Records and accountability

Most of the other ideas depend on records. This chapter is the plan for information requests, and for other public records (companies, land, donations and conflicts of interest), with the access rules for each.

	Idea	Work	Difference	Opinion	Go-ahead	Page
D1	Information requests: the records program	**Low**	**Medium** as an enabler	**Low**	**Low** directly	100
D2	Lobbying and political donations	**Low** mostly done	**Low**	**Very low**	**Low**	105
D3	Check the company registry every month	**Low**	**Low–medium**	**Low**	**Low**	107
D4	Look up land records for the turbine lots	**Low–medium** about $7 a half-day in person	**Low–medium** medium if setback rights are missing	**Low**	**Low**	109
D5	Conflict of interest, only on documents	**High**	**High** only if a real interest exists	**Low**	**Low**	111
D6	Check the jobs and benefits claims	**Low**	**Medium** accountability	**Medium**	**Low**	112

Words on this page

Also on this page: Information request a request for a public body's records · **Setback** a minimum distance

D1 Records

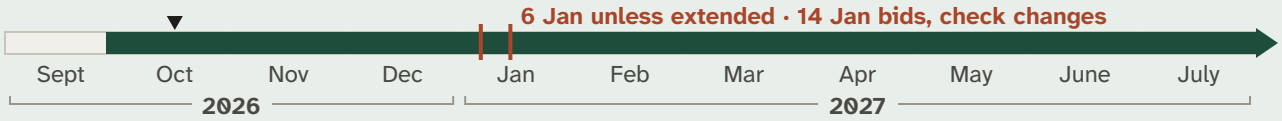
Information requests: the records program

Suggested action

Check existing scopes and status first

Work required	Potential difference	Public opinion	Effect on go-ahead
Low	**Medium**	**Low**	**Low**
	as an enabler		directly

When **Now; later records need date and scope checks** **Who** **Dan**



Why this opinion rating: Requests themselves aren't news; what they turn up can feed the other messages.

What you can do

16 October update. The list below is a scope map, not a current filing ledger. Check each person's exact application, receipt, fee status, cutoff, transfer and later notices before filing again. An open request does not automatically include later records. Add the newly named companies to a proposed follow-up only after checking the existing scope and obtaining approval.

File a planned set of information requests for records that already exist, and dated follow-ups for records that will exist later.

Why it might help

The rules. The provincial access law is FOIPOP; the county and the planning commission follow a mirror set of rules in the municipal law.

- **$5 per request.** The first **2 hours of search** are free. After that, and for preparing records and removing protected information, up to **$15 per half-hour**; photocopies up to 20¢ a page. A fee estimate comes first.
- Ask the Province to waive the search and preparation fees because the records concern the environment, a public-interest

Words on this page

Also on this page: **FOIPOP** Freedom of Information and Protection of Privacy · **Information request** a request for a public body's records · **Approval** a regulator's permission

matter. The waiver doesn't cover the $5. The municipal rules have no public-interest ground, so ask the county and the planning commission on fairness.

- **30 calendar days** to respond, counted once the request has enough detail and the fee is paid. The body can add 30 days, or more with the Commissioner's permission. With notice to a third party (for example ABO), release takes **up to 51 days** before any extension, and longer if the third party asks for a review. No answer in time counts as a refusal.
- **A review** by the Information and Privacy Commissioner: ask within **60 days of receiving the decision** (decision letters count from their own date, so use that to be safe). For a missed response, check the Commissioner's current review instructions promptly. Do not wait indefinitely or assume a review has no deadline. The September turnaround statistics are historical and are not a promise of delivery before January 2027.
- **A new access law takes effect on 1 April 2027** and replaces both sets of rules. Requests with no decision by then, and reviews already started, stay under the old rules. The new law allows **30 business days** instead of calendar days and closes Cabinet records for 15 years, but gives **3 free hours** for all work, not just search. The old deadline is shorter, so file now for records that exist.
- A request reaches only records the body holds or controls, and the first request's date range ends on the day it's received. Later records need new, dated requests: two this winter, then at later steps (B2), to whichever body holds them.

How to file:

- **Information requests first, for records.** Where the thing wanted is an existing record held or controlled by a public body and the legal timeline suits, file. Don't email first and request only if refused.

Words on this page

Also on this page: ABO ABO Energy, the original project developer · **Waiver** giving up or excusing a requirement · **Extension** extra time allowed under a particular rule · **Business days** days banks are open · **Information request** a request for a public body's records

- **An email or letter stays first** for questions that need an answer or a view; for bodies outside the law (ABO, the bid administrator, NAV CANADA); for requests to act; for submissions; and for records already public or routinely released on request.
- **Where timing matters and records are also wanted,** send the short email and file the request the same day, offering to narrow or withdraw the request if the records are simply sent. Where a later check is needed, plan a dated request or email, not "ask again".
- **Check first:** the Province's disclosure log (openinformation.novascotia.ca), Rhodena's project page and posted council minutes. On 27 September 2026 the log's published titles and descriptions showed nothing on Rhodena, Creignish or Green Choice; the only ABO entry is a 2021 Crown-land file at Jordan Bay. The log shows only released requests picked for posting, not pending ones.
- **Give details** (subject, dates, places, file numbers) so staff can find the records. Since March 2025 a request without them can be disregarded, but the body must help and let you add detail.
- **Ask for** a fee estimate, electronic records, removal of only the exempt parts, and phased release. Precise species and archaeological site locations may be withheld; ask for the rest.
- **Search terms:** Rhodena / ABO Energy Canada Ltd. / ABO Wind Canada Ltd. / Community Wind Farms Inc. / 40100-30-350 (the Province's file number).

How much it can do: medium, as the tool that feeds the other ideas. On its own it is unlikely to change whether the project goes ahead.

How to do it

The request list. The private edition describes it in more detail; some requests are drafted and others still need wording.

Words on this page

Also on this page: ABO ABO Energy, the original project developer · **NAV CANADA** the company that runs Canada's civil air navigation · **Bid administrator** the firm running the bidding · **Green Choice** the Province's renewable-power bidding program

#	To	For	When
1	Environment	The eight-part approval-record scope: any extension or amendment; the start; the yearly tables, monitoring summaries, timing permissions, non-compliance notices and inspections; changes, transfer consent and registry changes; the required plans and archaeology results; how the agency comments were resolved, plus unposted filings from before the approval and the date the knowledge study arrived; wetland and stream approvals, special-wetland decisions and 30 m authorizations; liaison committee records	**Now**, the same day as the status email
2	Planning commission and county (separate bodies, $5 each)	The permit file and any setback waivers; support letters and resolutions; Rhodena, ABO and Community Wind agendas and presentations since 2021; the Province's 2025 wind-bylaw notice	**Now**, with the zoning email
3	Energy	Round 1: the administrator's final report, and records of ABO not signing; the payment record for an $8,160 grant to ABO in 2024–25 (Energy paid the same sum to four other firms in 2025–26, so it looks routine)	October; round 2 later
4	Natural Resources	The Crown easement file; any request to waive the county setback over Crown land; the species data; the records behind its 2022 bat hibernation answer; the 2025 lynx core-habitat layer; its comments on the wildlife plans	October
5	L'nu Affairs	Consultation milestones and non-confidential summaries (respectful, factual)	Low priority
6	Public Works	Road permits; haul-route and bridge reviews	Once the route is known
7	Municipal Affairs	Records behind the July 2025 bylaw changes	Optional
8	Federal defence and transport departments	Renewed aviation letters and the final lighting decision	After the final layout

Words on this page

Also on this page: ABO ABO Energy, the original project developer · **Approval** a regulator's permission · **Extension** extra time allowed under a particular rule · **Setback** a minimum distance · **Waiver** giving up or excusing a requirement · **Support letter** a letter backing the bid · **Bid administrator** the firm running the bidding · **Easement** a right to use someone else's land · **Crown land** land owned by the Province · **Core habitat** the areas a recovery plan says a species needs most

#	To	For	When
9	Heritage department	Archaeology reports from 2022–24 and its acceptance letters	October, with the email
10	Energy	How the bid administrator handles outside information	**Now**
11	Environment	Dated follow-up (already drafted): records since request 1, with a short email the same day	About **8 December**
12	Environment	Dated follow-up: records since request 11, with a short email; in February, the 31 January tables	About **7 January**; February
13	Environment	The current criteria for special wetlands	October

Timing against the decisions. Use the actual complete-request and required-fee receipt, followed by the body's notices. Record any fee hold, transfer, extension or third-party process before calculating a date. The September hypothetical response forecasts are withdrawn from this review; they do not describe a live request.

- **Before a new request:** compare its proposed subjects and date range with what was actually submitted. Ask whether the search covered the correct dates; preserve the answer.
- **A fee letter:** record its response-by date and clock effect, check the arithmetic, and seek a written waiver decision or narrower scope before deciding on costs. Do not treat a fee estimate as a waiver refusal unless it says so.
- **Later transfer or design records:** identify what was held before the existing cutoff and what arrived afterward. A separately approved dated follow-up may be needed.
- **For January planning:** use the Department's actual status reply and public records as well as access requests. A request does not guarantee disclosure before a project or procurement decision, and does not stop a separate review clock.

When File 1, 2 and 10 now; 3, 4, 9 and 13 this fall; 11 and 12 on their dates.

Who Dan.

Words on this page

Also on this page: Bid administrator the firm running the bidding · **Extension** extra time allowed under a particular rule · **Waiver** giving up or excusing a requirement · **The Department** Nova Scotia Environment and Climate Change

Where this comes from

FOIPOP Act s.5(1), s.6A, s.7(1)(a), s.7(2)–(3), s.9, s.11 and s.11(7)(b), s.12, s.14, s.19, s.22–23, s.34, s.39–40; FOIPOP Regulations s.3(2) and s.6; MGA Part XX s.465(1), s.466A–467, s.471(7); Bill 150 s.20, s.26, s.32, s.146; OIPC guidance and 2024–25 annual report; disclosure log (checked 27 Sept 2026); 2024–25 Public Accounts; file 2021-01835-DNRR.

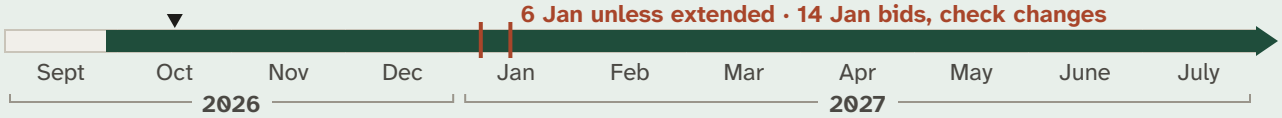
D2 Records

Suggested action: **Background only**

Lobbying and political donations

Work required	Potential difference	Public opinion	Effect on go-ahead
Low	**Low**	**Very low**	**Low**
mostly done			

When Any time; no deadline **Who** Not assigned (records: Dan)



Why this opinion rating: Background only: the searches so far found no document supporting wrongdoing. Donations or lobbying alone do not establish it.

What you can do

Know what has already been checked, and don't make claims without documents.

Why it might help

- **Lobbyist registries,** searched 27 September 2026: no provincial entries for ABO, ABO Energy, ABO Wind, Community Wind, Rhodena or Power Advisory (other wind developers appear, so the search works). No federal registrations or communication reports for the first five names (from Codex's earlier review; not re-checked).
- **An empty result proves little.** The provincial law covers lobbying provincial officials on laws, policies, programs and grants. It doesn't cover council, or submissions on how a law applies to the company, such as its environmental assessment.

Words on this page

OIPC Office of the Information and Privacy Commissioner: the office that reviews information-request decisions in Nova Scotia; under the law in force on 27 Sept 2026 it recommends, it can't order.

DNRR Department of Natural Resources and Renewables: the provincial department's name on its 2021 file.

Also on this page: FOIPOP Freedom of Information and Protection of Privacy · **MGA** Municipal Government Act · **ABO** ABO Energy, the original project developer

In-house staff register only if their lobbying, counting colleagues', adds up to 20% of one person's time.

- **Provincial donations:** only Nova Scotia residents may give, not companies, and party and riding-association reports name only those who gave that party or association $200 or more in total in a calendar year. The 2024–25 reports of all four parties and their riding associations show no gift reliably tied to the project's named contacts (one small name match is unconfirmed). Earlier years, and the 2024 candidate returns, weren't searched.
- **Municipal candidates** each file with the county clerk within 60 days of polling day, naming every contributor of more than $50 in total. Company donations aren't barred, so look for ABO and Community Wind too.
- **"Corrupt" or "bribe" talk:** no supporting document has been found in the searches so far. Donations or lobbying alone don't show wrongdoing. **Act only on documents.**

How much it can do: low. This is background.

How to do it

1. Anyone may inspect municipal candidates' disclosures in office hours and get copies at cost. **No information request needed.** Ask for 2020, the two 2022 special elections (Districts 1 and 2) and 2024.
2. Keep donors' home addresses out of anything you post.
3. Don't allege anything without a document.

When

Any time; no deadline.

Who

Not assigned. Records work is Dan's.

Where this comes from

Lobbyists' Registration Act s.2(1)(c) and (f), s.3(2)(b), s.6; Lobbyists' Registration Regulations s.5; Elections Act s.236 and s.240; Municipal Elections Act s.49A(8)–(8A), s.49B, Form 40; party and riding-association reports 2024–25; federal lobbyist registry (Codex).

Words on this page

Also on this page: ABO ABO Energy, the original project developer · **Information request** a request for a public body's records

D3 Records

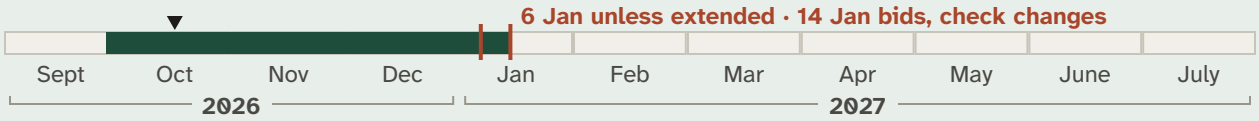
Suggested action

Repeat monthly

Check the company registry every month

Work required	Potential difference	Public opinion	Effect on go-ahead
Low	Low–medium	Low	Low

When **Monthly, and before 14 Jan** Who **A volunteer**



Why this opinion rating: Evidence behind the "who will own it" message, not a message by itself.

What you can do

16 October update. Check the legal entities and Rhodena Wind Inc. control named in the handover evidence. Keep September registry findings dated; they are not a current ownership certificate.

Re-run the free company-registry search every month and note any change.

Why it might help

- The free Registry of Joint Stock Companies search shows status, directors, the agent and dated filings, not shareholders. Most filings cost $12.45 to copy.
- **ABO Energy Canada Ltd.** (registry number 3342069; ABO Wind Canada Ltd. until May 2024) holds the approval. It filed a change of directors and officers on **20 August 2026**.
- **Rhodena Wind Inc.** (registry number 4627811), incorporated in June 2024, shares a director with ABO Energy Canada. On **24 September 2026** it filed a change in share structure and an increase in share capital.
- The 2022 Rhodena Wind Limited Partnership was dissolved in December 2024; its general partner was surrendered in January 2025.

Words on this page

Also on this page: **ABO** ABO Energy, the original project developer · **Approval** a regulator's permission

- The bidder must be one "Person" (a company or partnership, not an unincorporated joint venture), registered with the Registry, controlling the project at the bid and at contract signing. **Rhodena Wind Inc. is the intended bidder named in the October notice; registration and the actual bid are not established** (A4). Use all these names in the land-title search (D4).

How much it can do: low to medium.

How to do it

1. Each month, search "ABO Energy Canada", "Rhodena" and any new name. Note status, directors, the agent and dated filings, and take screenshots.
2. Search once more before 14 January.
3. Send any change to Dan.

When Monthly, and before 14 January.

Who A volunteer.

Where this comes from RJSC free search (27 Sept 2026); RFP II s.2.2.

Words on this page

Also on this page: ABO ABO Energy, the original project developer · **RJSC** Registry of Joint Stock Companies · **RFP** request for proposals

D4 Records

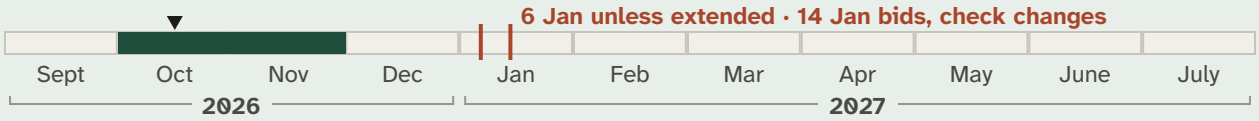
Look up land records for the turbine lots

Suggested action

Do: the two turbine lots first

Work required	Potential difference	Public opinion	Effect on go-ahead
Low–medium	**Low–medium**	**Low**	**Low**
about $7 a half-day in person	medium if setback rights are missing		

When **This fall** Who **A volunteer**



Why this opinion rating: Registry work; private landowners' names never go public.

What you can do

Search the land registry for leases, options and easements on the two turbine lots, then on the other private lots.

Why it might help

- On the provincial parcel map, all six proposed turbine sites fall on **two private lots**: one for turbines 1–4, one for turbines 5–6. ABO's registration lists **80** study-area parcels: **62 Crown, 18 private**.
- **Cost: $6.59** per half-day at a land registration office, plus $1.24 a page. Property Online is **$99.65 a month** plus tax.
- **Look for leases, options and easements** in favour of any company name in D3, or Community Wind (ABO's 2021 partner):
  - on the two turbine lots;
  - on the other 16 private lots. ABO ties project size partly to "available lands under contract". Extra rights may serve roads and lines (which can earn bid points; A3), setbacks or layout changes. On their own, they don't prove expansion (G2);
  - on the neighbouring lots, mostly Crown. County setback waivers need a lease of 19 years or more, or a binding easement (C3). Crown rights are in D1 and E1.

Words on this page

Also on this page: ABO ABO Energy, the original project developer · **Setback** a minimum distance · **Easement** a right to use someone else's land · **Waiver** giving up or excusing a requirement

- **A blank register isn't proof there's no deal.** An unrecorded lease or option still binds the owner who signed it. The parcel map isn't conclusive on boundaries.
- **What the bid needs on title:** registers dated on or after 10 September 2026 for the generating-facility lots, including both turbine lots, and, if the bidder isn't the registered owner, the owner's unqualified letter that the bidder has a contractual right to buy, or to build, operate and maintain the project if selected. Leases aren't reviewed, and all needed land rights are due before construction. So a lease missing from the register isn't non-compliance by itself; raise a documented gap in rights through the fact-check package (A3).

How much it can do: low to medium; medium if setback rights are missing (C3).

How to do it

1. **The two turbine lots first.** Their parcel numbers are in ABO's registration (see "Where this comes from").
2. Then the other private lots, then the neighbours.
3. Record what you find. Never post private landowners' names.

When

This fall.

Who

A volunteer with Property Online access, or near a land registration office.

Where this comes from

Provincial parcel map; EARD Table 3.1 (parcel numbers); ABO project FAQ; Land Registration Act s.21(2) and s.45; land registration fees; RFP II s.2.9; Access Rights form, Exhibit B; draft PPA s.7.1(p); county wind LUB s.4.5.2 and s.4.5.6.

Words on this page

Also on this page: ABO ABO Energy, the original project developer · **EARD** Environmental Assessment Registration Document · **FAQ** frequently asked questions · **RFP** request for proposals · **PPA** power purchase agreement · **LUB** land-use bylaw · **Setback** a minimum distance

D5 Records

Conflict of interest, only on documents

Suggested action: **Only on documents**

Work required	Potential difference	Public opinion	Effect on go-ahead
High	High	Low	Low
	only if a real interest exists		

When **Only if a document shows an interest** Who **Any elector (not assigned)**

When triggered · date unknown

Why this opinion rating: Only on documents; an accusation without one would damage the group.

What you can do

If a document shows a councillor has a money interest in a Rhodena matter before council, use the conflict-of-interest law. Only then.

Why it might help

- A councillor with a money (pecuniary) interest in a Rhodena matter before council, such as a support letter, an agreement or a bylaw change, must disclose it, withdraw (at an open meeting they may sit with the public), and not vote or try to influence it. Council doesn't issue the permit (C1).
- The interest may be their own, through a company, employer or partner, or a spouse's, close relative's or household member's that they know or should know of. Interests shared with electors generally, or too remote to matter, don't count.
- **Free first step:** any elector may inspect the county's central record of disclosures, without fee.
- **Court:** an elector or the Attorney General may apply to a judge within **60 days** of learning the facts, and within 10 years. The remedy is against the councillor; the decision stands unless a judge voids it on the municipality's application within two years.
- **Code of conduct:** since October 2025 only a councillor on the same council can complain, and not on anyone else's behalf, within 6 months of discovery. The county's code names an independent investigator, and bars accepting "support in any form" from anyone with a development proposal before council.

Words on this page

Also on this page: Support letter a letter backing the bid

How much it can do: high, but only if a real interest exists.

How to do it

1. Inspect the county's record of disclosures (free).
2. Act only on documents, such as a recorded lease on an official's or a relative's land (D4).
3. Don't publish private landowners' names.

When Only if a document shows an interest.

Who Any elector; not assigned.

Where this comes from Municipal Conflict of Interest Act ss.3–7 (incl. s.7(3)), s.9, s.10, s.13; N.S. Reg. 219/2024 s.7; county code of conduct s.10.

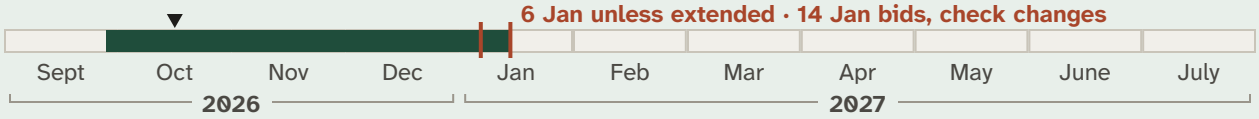
D6 Records

Suggested action: Do

Check the jobs and benefits claims

Work required	Potential difference	Public opinion	Effect on go-ahead
Low	Medium	Medium	Low
	accountability		

When **Ask now, before bids close** Who **Dan and a volunteer**



Why this opinion rating: ABO publishes job and community-fund claims. Asking for amounts, local jobs and enforceable commitments makes those claims easier to assess.

What you can do

Ask ABO to put its community-benefit and job claims in writing, with numbers, and check them against what's scored and what's binding.

Why it might help

- **Scored in the bidding** (16 points): Mi'kmaw ownership (6); social programs (5: a local capacity-building plan, 2; a local benefits agreement *or a "mature plan"* for one, 2; both province-wide, 1); and the weighted local share of spending before operation (5).

Words on this page

Also on this page: **N.S.** Nova Scotia · **ABO** ABO Energy, the original project developer

- **The contract** (the June draft, and the version filed with the Energy Board on 17 August 2026; no final yet):
  - a local-spending shortfall is paid to NS Power, not the community;
  - if ownership points were won, the Mi'kmaw share must be kept about 5 years past commercial operation, subject to lenders' rights;
  - neither version has a community-fund clause, and the contract gives the community no rights. A fund described in the bid may become a representation to NS Power. A breach is a default only if it materially harms, or could reasonably be expected to materially harm, NS Power's rights and interests under the contract or the seller's ability to perform, and isn't cured within 30 days of NS Power's notice (up to 90 if the seller shows it is diligently fixing it).
- **The community fund.** ABO "is committed to continuing sponsorships and donations… during each year of the Project's planning and operation", and says it has created a "significant Community Benefit Fund". No amount, recipient or term is published. The approval requires the project to follow its registration documents: ask the Department whether it treats this as a commitment.
- **Municipal tax is set by law, not voluntary:** $5,500 per MW, indexed to inflation since 2005, then +1% a year. That's about **$350,000 a year** for 42 MW at today's prices, and any project would pay it. ABO's lifetime "$8–10M" (2024 brochure) is about this tax alone over 20–25 years.
- **Jobs:** 75–125 local construction jobs (2023, 15 turbines); 30–50 (2024, 6 turbines); now "approximately 80 jobs during development and construction", not said to be local, plus 1–3 operating roles.

Words on this page

Also on this page: NS Power Nova Scotia Power · **ABO** ABO Energy, the original project developer · **MW** megawatt · **Approval** a regulator's permission · **The Department** Nova Scotia Environment and Climate Change

- ABO has funded the Creignish Recreational Centre, the West Bay and Port Hastings fire departments and the Ceilidh Groomers: context for support letters (A1), not wrongdoing.

How much it can do: medium, for accountability.

How to do it

1. **Ask ABO in writing** (with the A4 email, or at the liaison committee): the fund's counterparty, the amount a year, the term, whether it's signed, and whether it binds a new owner. Ask also who can enforce it: as a rule, only a contract's parties can. A sale generally needs NS Power's and the Minister's consent; neither mentions a fund.
2. Ask for the local share of jobs, and full-time equivalents.
3. Ask the Department whether it treats the fund as a commitment.
4. In messages, use plain numbers: the tax is set by law, whoever builds.

When

Ask now, before bids close.

Who

Dan and a volunteer.

Where this comes from

RFP II s.4.3(g); draft PPA v.01 s.2.8; filed PPA (Energy Board matter M13042, 17 Aug 2026) s.2.7, s.7.1(n), s.10.1(j), s.16.2–16.4, s.16.8(a), Art. 12; EARD s.6.2; approval conditions 2.2 and 3.9; Wind Turbine Facilities Municipal Taxation Act s.5; ABO mailouts (2023, 2024) and 2024 brochure; ABO project page.

Words on this page

Also on this page: ABO ABO Energy, the original project developer · **NS Power** Nova Scotia Power · **RFP** request for proposals · **PPA** power purchase agreement · **EARD** Environmental Assessment Registration Document · **Support letter** a letter backing the bid · **The Department** Nova Scotia Environment and Climate Change · **Approval** a regulator's permission · **Condition** a rule attached to an approval or permit

E

Chapter E · 3 ideas

Roads, safety and clean-up

The roads are provincial and the trucks are many. The environmental approval and the county bylaw require plans for taking the turbines down, but no dedicated financial security; find out whether any exists through other arrangements. These ideas are about keeping costs and risks off the public.

	Idea	Work	Difference	Opinion	Go-ahead	Page
E1	Roads, trucks and the haul route	**Low–medium**	**Medium**	**Medium**	**Low** unless a needed right can't be had	116
E2	Who pays to take it down	**Medium**	**Medium** financial protection	**Medium**	**Low**	118
E3	Fire, ice throw and the snowmobile trail	**Low**	**Medium** for conditions	**Medium**	**Low**	120

Words on this page

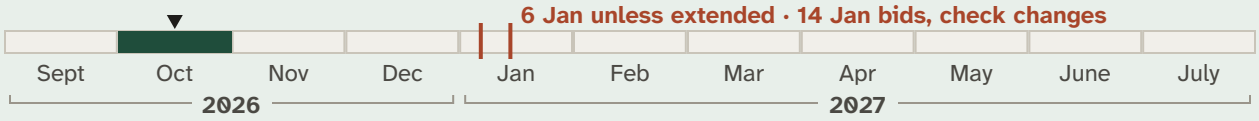
Also on this page: **Approval** a regulator's permission · **Ice throw** ice shed from turning blades · **Condition** a rule attached to an approval or permit

E1 Roads and site

Roads, trucks and the haul route

Work required	Potential difference	Public opinion	Effect on go-ahead
Low–medium	Medium	Medium	Low
			unless a needed right can't be had

When Oct; again after any contract; photos before construction **Who** Dan; the group



Why this opinion rating: The assessment anticipates 25–35 trucks a day, up to 50. The route and who pays for repairs are concrete concerns for nearby residents.

What you can do

16 October update. Confirm who now carries the road, safety and removal obligations, and what design is proposed. The old road lengths, truck estimates, ice-throw screening and security discussion below belong to the documented layout and rules, not a supplied 98 MW design. Recheck them against the new documents.

Get the road permits and route records, take baseline photos of General Line Road before construction, and ask for a written agreement on road use and repair.

Why it might help

- **The roads are provincial.** Public Works calls General Line Road and Rhodena Road "provincially owned roads". Road protection runs through Public Works, not council.
- **Route and load.** General Line Road is the named access route. The provincial road map shows **11.5 km** of unpaved road from Highway 105 to the stretch beside turbine 1: mostly one lane, the last 3 km "dry weather", one bridge. Several homes are on it. Construction brings **25–35 trucks a day**, up to 50. ABO leaves the

Words on this page

Also on this page: MW megawatt · **ABO** ABO Energy, the original project developer · **Ice throw** ice shed from turning blades · **Baseline** a dated record of how things are now

haul route to a logistics study by the turbine supplier; ask for the study and the current route.

- **Permits:** a special-move permit (Access Nova Scotia), access, highway right-of-way and pole-line permits, and a Crown easement. Each structure on a turbine route must be analysed.
- **Existing protections:** changes to the route are the bidder's cost; ABO's promise to reinstate modified roads binds it through the approval; and the mover is liable for highway damage even with a special-move permit. No road-bond rule was found.
- **The right that could fail is the Crown easement.** Some roads and lines cross Crown land, and the approval gives no right to build on land ABO doesn't control. Natural Resources considers easement applications only after a contract is signed.
  - For the fact-check package (A3): the 2 site points need all roads and lines on private land or existing public roads. On the call for bids' wording, a Crown easement doesn't count; a public road through Crown land does. Unless ABO reroutes, it likely can't claim them. **Verify; don't assert.**
- **The goal is to keep road repair costs off the public, not obstruction.**

How much it can do: medium. Effect on whether it goes ahead: low, unless a needed right can't be had.

How to do it

1. An information request to Natural Resources in October for any existing Crown-easement records (D1). File a new request after any contract is signed, since only then is the application considered.
2. Request the Public Works and Access Nova Scotia records once the haul route is known.
3. Before construction, take dated baseline photos of General Line Road, from the road.

Words on this page

Also on this page: ABO ABO Energy, the original project developer · **Easement** a right to use someone else's land · **Approval** a regulator's permission · **Clean-up bond** proposed financial security for removal · **Crown land** land owned by the Province · **Information request** a request for a public body's records · **Baseline** a dated record of how things are now

4. Ask for a written road-use and restoration agreement, and for county consultation on transport.

When October; again after any contract; photos before construction.

Who Dan (the requests); the group (the photos).

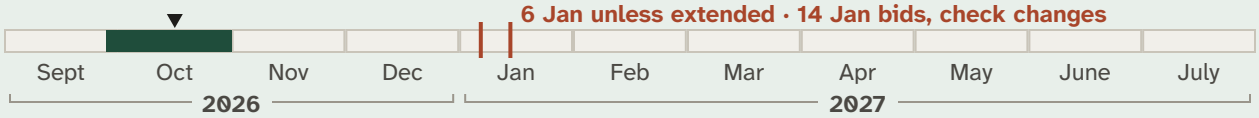
Where this comes from Public Works comment (22 Nov 2024); EARD s.2.1, s.8.2.2, s.8.3.2, s.8.3.4, Table 2.2; Nova Scotia Road Network; RFP II s.2.3(b)(v)(A), s.2.13(a)(iii) and (b)(ii), s.4.3(e)(v), Appendix D; FAQ v.02 items 32 and 35; approval conditions 2.2 and 3.8; Weights and Dimensions of Vehicles Regulations s.11(6); **D1** #4 and #6.

E2 Roads and site

Who pays to take it down

Work required	Potential difference	Public opinion	Effect on go-ahead
Medium	**Medium**	**Medium**	**Low**
■■■□□	■■■□□	■■■□□	■■□□□
	financial protection		

When **Ask now; again at any transfer** **Who** **Dan; the group (with the council ask)**



Why this opinion rating: The same public case as the council ask: who pays for removal if an owner fails.

What you can do

16 October update. Confirm who now carries the road, safety and removal obligations, and what design is proposed. The old road lengths, truck estimates, ice-throw screening and security discussion below belong to the documented layout and rules, not a supplied 98 MW design. Recheck them against the new documents.

Ask what money, if any, is set aside to take the turbines down and restore the site, and push for real security.

Words on this page

Also on this page: **EARD** Environmental Assessment Registration Document · **RFP** request for proposals · **FAQ** frequently asked questions · **MW** megawatt · **Approval** a regulator's permission · **Condition** a rule attached to an approval or permit · **Ice throw** ice shed from turning blades

Why it might help

Plans, not money:

- **The approval:** a reclamation plan two years before operation ends; reclamation to the Department's satisfaction; a repair-or-remove report after two idle years.
- **The county bylaw:** a plan with the permit application; removal after **one year** idle, and the site restored within 18 months.
- **The contract** (the standard form before the Energy Board since August 2026): decommissioning is the seller's "sole responsibility", and that survives termination. Performance security (**$20,000 per MW** after operation starts) is held by NS Power for the seller's contract obligations, and released after the **25-year** term once accrued obligations are met. Decommissioning may come later: ABO expects at least 25–30 years of operation. There's no dedicated county or landowner clean-up fund.
- The approval and the county bylaw require no security, and wind farms are not on the Province's mandatory security list.

Openings:

- Any transfer of the approval needs the Minister's consent, and the Minister may attach terms. Ask that any consent confirm who carries the reclamation conditions, and consider security.
- Push for security through council (C4, C5). Development agreements and site-plan approvals may include it. Whether a new rule could reach Rhodena is covered in C5.

This matters more given the ownership questions (A4). How much it can do: medium, as financial protection.

How to do it

1. **Ask ABO** what security exists: the amount, form, beneficiary, indexing and removal scope (ABO's assessment leaves the

Words on this page

Also on this page: MW megawatt · **NS Power** Nova Scotia Power · **ABO** ABO Energy, the original project developer · **Approval** a regulator's permission · **The Department** Nova Scotia Environment and Climate Change · **Decommissioning** taking something out of service · **Condition** a rule attached to an approval or permit

foundations and roads to the private leases), and what happens on insolvency or assignment.

2. **Check** the county permit file (C1) and the easement file (D1).
3. **If a transfer is sought,** ask the Minister to confirm who carries the reclamation conditions and to consider security.
4. **At council:** the bond ask (C4, C5).

When Ask now; again at any transfer.

Who Dan asks; the group takes it to council with the bond ask.

Where this comes from Approval conditions 3.9 and 12.1–12.3; county wind LUB s.2.7.3(d) and s.4.5.4; filed PPA s.3.1(f) and s.6.1; EARD s.3.3.2–3.3.3; Activities Designation Regulations s.30; Environment Act s.41B(2); MGA s.227(1)(h) and s.231(4)(ka).

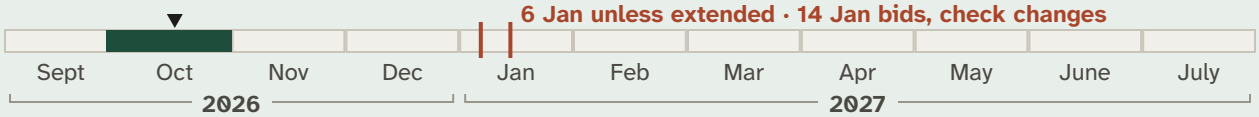
E3 Roads and site

Suggested action: Do

Fire, ice throw and the snowmobile trail

Work required	Potential difference	Public opinion	Effect on go-ahead
Low	Medium	Medium	Low
■■□□□	■■■□□ for conditions	■■■□□	■■□□□

When **Now; recheck when the final layout is filed (date unknown)** Who **Dan; a volunteer**



Why this opinion rating: The mapped road and trail proximity raises a concrete safety question. The present evidence does not establish a breach; check the final placement and the regulator's view.

What you can do

16 October update. Confirm who now carries the road, safety and removal obligations, and what design is proposed. The old road lengths, truck estimates, ice-throw screening and security discussion below belong to the documented layout and rules, not a supplied 98 MW design. Recheck them against the new documents.

Words on this page

Also on this page: LUB land-use bylaw · **PPA** power purchase agreement · **EARD** Environmental Assessment Registration Document · **MGA** Municipal Government Act · **MW** megawatt · **Development permit** the county's planning permit for a large turbine · **Easement** a right to use someone else's land · **Condition** a rule attached to an approval or permit · **Clean-up bond** proposed financial security for removal · **Approval** a regulator's permission · **Ice throw** ice shed from turning blades

Ask the Department to check ice-throw safety at General Line Road and snowmobile Trail 104 against the final turbine positions, and work with the snowmobile club and fire departments.

Why it might help

- **Fire.** Local fire chiefs suggested road changes, which ABO adopted. A draft emergency plan went to the Port Hastings and West Bay Road fire departments in May 2024. Dry hydrants were only "considered". A contingency plan covering fires and vehicle collisions is due before work starts (it's in the first information request).
- **Ice throw near turbine 1:**
  - ABO puts the maximum ice throw at **421.5 m** for its model turbine; a bigger rotor or taller hub throws farther. It lists a **300 m** setback from public roads.
  - It says the nearest public road is 2.9 km away, so road users face "no risk"; elsewhere it says 300 m. Mapped data put General Line Road, a provincial road, and snowmobile **Trail 104** about **190–200 m west of turbine 1**.
  - ABO promises automatic icing shutdown, and warning signs on recreational or logging trails or roads in the danger zone, and says site use may be restricted in icing weather. Those promises were framed for trail users and site workers, with no public road in range. Ask how they will protect General Line Road and Trail 104.
- **Trails.** Snowmobile trails follow General Line, Rhodena and MacIntyre Mountain roads. ABO commits not to restrict public access to roads and trails except at active construction sites, subject to the possible icing restrictions above, and says all roads will be plowed in winter. Ask whether that includes General Line Road, which carries Trail 104, and agree winter arrangements with the snowmobile club.
- **Don't call it a breach** before seeing the final placement, and before the regulator says whether the 300 m applies to this dry-weather stretch. The mapped distance meets the county's 60 m

Words on this page

Also on this page: **ABO** ABO Energy, the original project developer · **The Department** Nova Scotia Environment and Climate Change · **Ice throw** ice shed from turning blades · **Information request** a request for a public body's records · **Hub height** the height of the rotor's centre · **Setback** a minimum distance

highway setback, but that doesn't settle the environmental-approval question.

How much it can do: medium, for conditions.

How to do it

1. **A letter to the assessment branch,** copying Public Works as the road owner: has the final turbine placement been filed? Reconcile the road distances and the 300 m setback with it, and require an updated ice-throw assessment. Options: shutdown and restart rules, signs and a winter trail route agreed with the snowmobile club, or moving turbine 1. Ask whether the dry hydrants will be built.
2. **Request the final emergency plan** (water supply, exits) through the first information request if it's already held; if it's filed later, with a new dated request (D1).
3. **A volunteer talks** to the snowmobile club and the fire departments.

When

Now; recheck when the final placement is filed.

Who

Dan (the letter); a volunteer (the snowmobile club and fire departments).

Where this comes from

EARD Tables 3.3, 6.2 and 6.5, s.3.3.2, s.8.3.4, s.8.4.2, s.10.1.2–10.1.3, s.12.2.2, s.13.4, Drawing 2.3A; Nova Scotia Road Network; Snowmobilers Association map; approval conditions 2.2, 3.19, 4.1, 11.1; county wind LUB s.4.4(e).

Words on this page

Also on this page: EARD Environmental Assessment Registration Document · **LUB** land-use bylaw · **Setback** a minimum distance · **Approval** a regulator's permission · **Condition** a rule attached to an approval or permit · **Ice throw** ice shed from turning blades · **Information request** a request for a public body's records

F

Chapter F · 3 ideas

Aviation and night lighting

The 2024 aviation reviewers didn't object to Rhodena. Check that the letters are still current, and ask for lighting protections: turbines this tall must be lit at night, and nothing yet binds ABO to the systems that keep the lights off or dimmed.

	Idea	Work	Difference	Opinion	Go-ahead	Page
F1	Are the aviation letters still current?	**Low**	**Low–medium**	**Low**	**Low**	124
F2	Make the night-lighting promise binding	**Low**	**Medium** for night impact	**Medium–high**	**Very low**	126
F3	Show what the lights would look like at night	**Medium**	**Low**	**Medium–high**	**Very low**	128

Words on this page

Also on this page: **ABO** ABO Energy, the original project developer

F1 Aviation

Suggested action

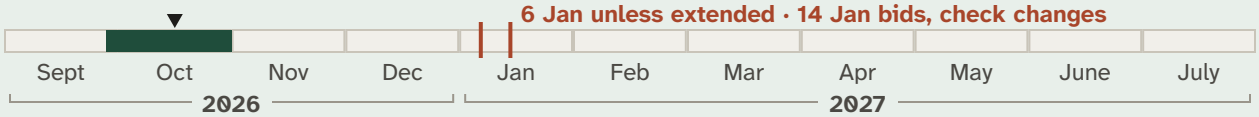
Ask now

Are the aviation letters still current?

Work required	Potential difference	Public opinion	Effect on go-ahead
Low	Low–medium	Low	Low

When **Ask now; request records after the final layout (date unknown), or sooner if a new layout or turbine model is confirmed**

Who **Dan and a volunteer**



Why this opinion rating: Lapsed letters on their own do not establish a breach or a bid defect. This is a check on whether the required letters are current.

What you can do

16 October update. Ask the new project contact which current aviation and radar letters cover each proposed layout, height and turbine model. The flyer supplies no new layout, so it does not prove either that the old assessments cover it or that a particular new clearance is already needed.

Ask ABO whether its aviation clearances were renewed, and whether they cover the final layout.

Why it might help

The 2024 aviation clearances were time-limited. Unless renewed:

- **NAV CANADA's** letter (7 October 2024) was valid for 18 months, so it ran out on **7 April 2026**.
- **National Defence's** was valid for 24 months from its date. The assessment records it as received on **11 September 2024**, so it ran out no later than **11 September 2026**. A changed layout must be resubmitted.
- **Transport Canada:** ABO submitted its assessment and lighting plan in October 2024. A Transport Canada determination lasts 18 months from its assessment; that date isn't public. Any change needs a new submission.

Words on this page

Also on this page: **ABO** ABO Energy, the original project developer · **NAV CANADA** the company that runs Canada's civil air navigation

- **The federal weather-radar letter** lapses if the number, height or placement of turbines changes.

A lapse on its own isn't a breach or a bid defect: the call for bids asks for a workable path to permits, not current letters. It matters at the permit stage: the county needs Transport Canada and NAV CANADA authorizations, and Transport Canada needs notice at least 90 days before construction.

How much it can do: low to medium.

How to do it

1. **Ask ABO** (in the one written email, or at the liaison committee) whether the letters were renewed and cover the final turbine and layout.
2. **Look for them** in the county permit file (C1).
3. **After the final layout,** or sooner if a new layout or turbine model is confirmed: a federal information request to Transport Canada and National Defence (D1). NAV CANADA isn't under the federal access law, but its letter was copied to Transport Canada's Atlantic office, so the Transport Canada request may catch renewals.

When

Ask now; request the records after the final layout, or sooner if a new layout or turbine model is confirmed.

Who

Dan and a volunteer.

Where this comes from

EARD s.8.3.2, Tables 2.1, 6.1 and 10.2, Appendix J (NAV CANADA file 24-2766); RFP II s.2.6(a); county wind LUB s.2.7.3(a); Transport Canada Standard 621 s.2.5; approval condition 4.1; **D1** #8.

Words on this page

Also on this page: **NAV CANADA** the company that runs Canada's civil air navigation · **ABO** ABO Energy, the original project developer · **EARD** Environmental Assessment Registration Document · **RFP** request for proposals · **LUB** land-use bylaw · **Development permit** the county's planning permit for a large turbine · **Information request** a request for a public body's records · **Approval** a regulator's permission · **Condition** a rule attached to an approval or permit

F2 Aviation

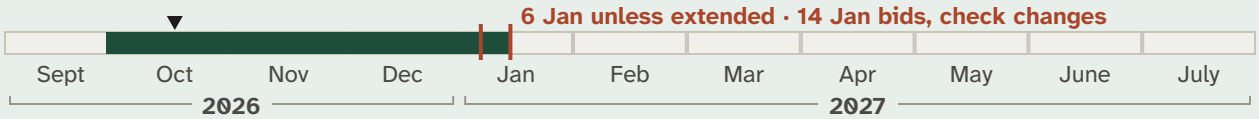
Suggested action

Do

Make the night-lighting promise binding

Work required	Potential difference	Public opinion	Effect on go-ahead
Low	Medium	Medium–high	Very low
■■□□□	■■■□□ for night impact	■■■◧□	■□□□□

When **Now; final lighting after the final layout (date unknown)** Who **Dan and a volunteer**



Why this opinion rating: The lighting requirements, including mid-mast lights, make the request for mitigation easy to picture. The final scheme and mitigation are not confirmed in the available public record.

What you can do

16 October update. Obtain the new project team's written lighting proposal and the determination for the final model/layout. Do not carry an old expectation or promise over to a new owner or design without confirmation.

Ask ABO to commit in writing to aircraft-detection lighting (lights off unless an aircraft is near), and ask the Department to put lighting protection for birds in the wildlife plan.

Why it might help

- **What the rules require.** Anything over 150 m is an obstacle to air navigation. Each lit turbine over 150 m gets two red flashing lights on top (2,000 candela; one is a standby) **and** at least three mid-mast lights at about half that height, flashing at the same rate. Transport Canada's determination sets the final scheme.
- **The assessment understates this.** Its bird section says the turbines will be "un-lit at night" apart from a light on top. The federal environment department asked for detailed lighting

Words on this page

Mid-mast lights red lights halfway up the tower: required on lit turbines over 150 m, as well as the lights on top.

Also on this page: ABO ABO Energy, the original project developer

mitigation for migratory birds in the project's management plans.

- **Two systems can reduce the lights; neither is automatic:**
  - **Aircraft detection:** the lights stay off until a sensor detects an approaching aircraft. If the sensor or its link fails, the lights come on continuously. Transport Canada must accept it, and can refuse if terrain hides aircraft from the radar.
  - **Light intensity reduction:** dims the top lights to as low as 10% when visibility is over 10 km. It doesn't dim the mid-mast lights, or work at twilight.
- **Nothing binds ABO to either system yet.** The approval has no lighting condition (nor do four other recent Nova Scotia wind approvals). The approval holds ABO to its assessment documents, but they promise only that lighting "will be minimized, as allowable by Transport Canada". ABO "expects" a mitigation system, names only dimming, and will decide after choosing the turbine.
- **Don't rely on the county.** Aviation lighting is federal, the wind bylaw has no lighting rule, the Development Officer issues a permit that meets the bylaw, and county wind policy can't include visual impact.

How much it can do: medium, for the night-time impact. Effect on whether it goes ahead: very low.

How to do it

1. **Ask ABO** for a written commitment to aircraft detection, with dimming as the fallback; the final lighting schedule; maintenance, fault logs and what happens on failure; and mid-mast lights in all visuals and open-house material (public information must be "accurate, current").
2. **Ask the Department** to put lighting mitigation in the wildlife plan, as the federal department asked, and to say whether ABO's

Words on this page

Aircraft detection lighting that stays off until an aircraft is near. If the sensor or its link fails, the lights come on. Transport Canada must accept it; acceptance isn't guaranteed.

TC Transport Canada: the federal transport department; it sets the lighting and marking rules for tall structures.

Also on this page: ABO ABO Energy, the original project developer

promise means detection or dimming if Transport Canada accepts them. The Department can require more mitigation.

3. **Ask Transport Canada** for the final determination and any detection or dimming decision, by federal information request after the final layout (**D1**).

When Now; the final lighting after the final layout.

Who Dan and a volunteer.

Where this comes from CARs s.601.23(1)(d) and s.601.24; Transport Canada Standard 621 s.12.3(2), ch.15 (Aircraft Detection Systems), ch.16 (Light Intensity Reduction); AC 601-006; EARD p.240 and p.276; ECCC comment 20; approval conditions 2.2, 3.19, 6.2; RFP II s.2.7(a)(v); Minimum Planning Requirements Regulations s.15; **D1** #8.

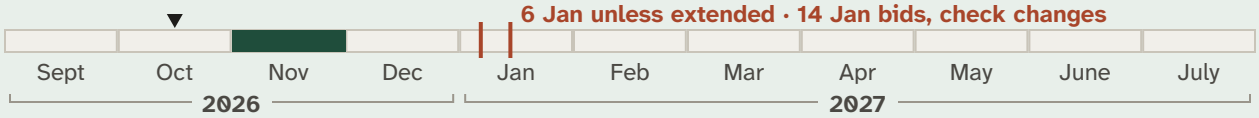
F3 Aviation

Suggested action Optional (volunteer)

Show what the lights would look like at night

Work required	Potential difference	Public opinion	Effect on go-ahead
Medium	Low	Medium–high	Very low

When **November** Who **A volunteer**



Why this opinion rating: A matched day and night pair makes the lighting real for people, if it's labelled honestly as illustrative.

What you can do Make honest day-and-night photo pairs showing where the turbine lights would be, for the lighting ask and the liaison committee.

Why it might help

- The assessment's seven simulations are all daytime (8–9 September 2024, 50 mm lens), including Route 19 near Judique at

Words on this page

CARs Canadian Aviation Regulations: the federal aviation rules; a structure over 150 m is an obstacle to air navigation.

AC advisory circular: a Transport Canada guidance note (AC 601-006 covers aircraft-detection lighting).

Also on this page: EARD Environmental Assessment Registration Document · **ECCC** Environment and Climate Change Canada · **RFP** request for proposals

12.5 km. None shows the lights. ABO says it will update the visuals and ask the community for more viewpoints.

- The images won't count toward the county permit (F2), and the bid has no visual score. But ABO can earn engagement points for showing how its proposal changed after feedback, and a lighting commitment could be one.

How much it can do: low.

How to do it

1. **Run Dan's viewshed tool at the light heights,** not just the 200 m tip: the top of the tower (a 118 m hub in the 2024 model) and the mid-mast lights (about 50–70 m).
2. **Make matched day/night pairs** from the assessment's viewpoints, with the same 50 mm lens and direction. Fix the positions from the photos: several stated coordinates are duplicated. Shoot a few frames either side of 30 minutes after sunset, exposed to look as the eye sees it, from public roads and places only.
3. **Record** the camera, lens, exposure, weather and time.
4. **Label honestly.** The lights must be simulated, so label them illustrative (Scottish guidance calls such images "essentially artist's impressions"). Label them dusk views too: the lights look their brightest only once the sky is fully dark. Note that they flash. Show three versions: full lighting, dimmed (mid-mast lights unchanged), and aircraft detection (dark unless an aircraft is near).
5. Use them for the lighting ask and at the liaison committee.

When

November.

Who

A volunteer comfortable with maps or photography.

Where this comes from

EARD Drawings 10.1B–10.1H; ABO project page; NatureScot (2024), Appendix 4, paras 13 and 28; RFP II s.4.3(f).

Words on this page

Also on this page: ABO ABO Energy, the original project developer · **EARD** Environmental Assessment Registration Document · **RFP** request for proposals · **Development permit** the county's planning permit for a large turbine · **Hub height** the height of the rotor's centre · **Mid-mast lights** red lights halfway up the tower · **Aircraft detection** lighting that stays off until an aircraft is near

G

Chapter G · 7 ideas

Community, messages and alternatives

How the group works in public: a seat at the liaison committee, the lead message about the project's size, honest checks on noise and flicker, tourism letters, constructive alternatives, respect for the Mi'kmaw partners, and the messages and volunteer jobs that carry all of it.

	Idea	Work	Difference	Opinion	Go-ahead	Page
G1	Take a seat on the community liaison committee	**Very low**	**Medium**	**Low–medium**	**Low**	131
G2	Separate the approved baseline from the new range	**Low**	**Low–medium** strong for messages	**High**	**Very low**	133
G3	Noise and flicker at the nearest homes	**Low**	**Low–medium**	**Low**	**Low**	135
G4	Tourism businesses: letters in their own words	**Low**	**Low**	**Medium**	**Low**	137
G5	Offer constructive alternatives	**Low** to propose	**Low** direct; high credibility	**Medium–high**	**Low**	139
G6	First Nations: respect, privately	**Medium**	**Indirect**	**Not applicable**	**Very low**	140
G7	Messages and volunteer jobs	**Not rated**	**Not rated**	**High**	**Not rated**	143

Words on this page

Mi'kmaq the Indigenous people of this region: “Mi'kmaw” is the singular and adjective form.

G1 Community

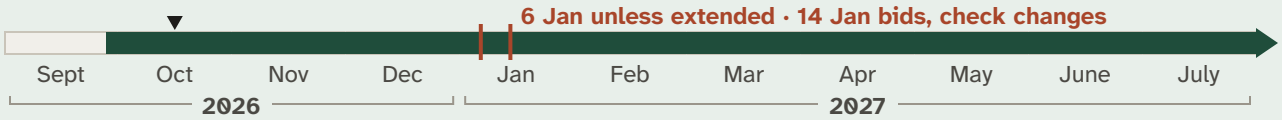
Suggested action

Do

Take a seat on the community liaison committee

Work required	Potential difference	Public opinion	Effect on go-ahead
Very low	Medium	Low–medium	Low

When **Confirm fall meeting dates, terms and feedback use** Who **The group**



Why this opinion rating: A seat gives residents a way to ask for records and for dissent to appear in the minutes. The committee is advisory, and information sharing is not guaranteed.

What you can do

16 October update. The flyer offers fall meetings, a liaison committee and a survey but gives no verified meeting dates here. Ask Darren Carl, the contact it names, who now convenes the committee, its terms and membership, how prior issues carry forward and how survey answers are used. Keep participation, advice and support for the bid distinct.

Put one or two nearby residents forward for ABO's community liaison committee, and ask for its terms of reference, members and minutes.

Why it might help

- The approval requires ABO to "continue to maintain" the committee, following the Department's 2010 guide, "for the duration of the Project or until released in writing by the Department".
- It met from February to May 2024. ABO's page says it will be "up and running again" and welcomes volunteers. The guide expects nearby residents on it. **The committee is advisory only.**
- The guide lists environmental, monitoring and contingency plans among what the committee may review, and says ABO "should" share non-confidential information the committee

Words on this page

Also on this page: ABO ABO Energy, the original project developer · **Approval** a regulator's permission · **The Department** Nova Scotia Environment and Climate Change

requests. Ask for the approval's required plans (**B2**) that way; it isn't guaranteed.

- **The scoring angle.** A formed committee with terms of reference is worth **1 of the 10** engagement points in the bidding. How long it has existed earns nothing extra, and mere efforts to form one earn nothing. Joining may help ABO claim the point; the payoff for residents is information and a record. Check that it was really formed (**A3**).
- The May 2024 agenda sought ideas for community support for the Green Choice bid, so ask that the minutes record dissent, and that membership is not counted as support.
- The guide recommends **at least two meetings a year**; none is on record since May 2024. Ask ABO for the dates, and the Department for any written release. **Don't allege a breach.**

How much it can do: medium.

How to do it

1. Volunteer now: ABO's page already invites volunteers. Choose one or two calm, detail-minded residents who live nearby.
2. Ask ABO for the terms of reference, the member list, the minutes and an issue log.
3. Ask that the minutes record dissent, and state that membership is not support.
4. Take notes at each meeting and share them, with the minutes, with the group.
5. Ask for the required plans through the committee.

When

Now, and at each meeting.

Who

The group: one or two nearby residents.

Where this comes from

Approval condition 9.3; NSECC Community Liaison Committee Guide (2010); EARD Tables 6.3–6.4; ABO project page (spring 2026); RFP II s.4.3(f); FAQ v.02 items 12 and 15; **D1** #1 (request 1, part 8).

Words on this page

Also on this page: ABO ABO Energy, the original project developer · **NSECC** Nova Scotia Environment and Climate Change · **EARD** Environmental Assessment Registration Document · **RFP** request for proposals · **FAQ** frequently asked questions · **Approval** a regulator's permission · **Green Choice** the Province's renewable-power bidding program · **The Department** Nova Scotia Environment and Climate Change · **Condition** a rule attached to an approval or permit

G2 Community

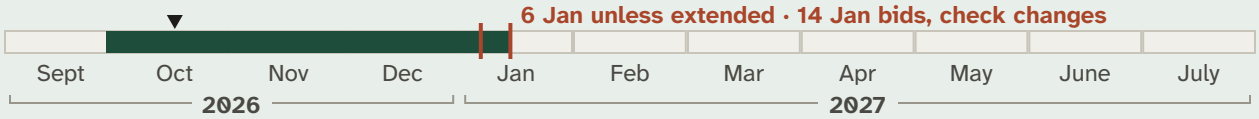
Suggested action

Lead message

Separate the approved baseline from the new range

Work required	Potential difference	Public opinion	Effect on go-ahead
Low	Low–medium	High	Very low
■■□□□	■■◧□□	■■■■□	■□□□□
	strong for messages		

When **Now; revise messages before publication** Who **Dan and a volunteer; the group**



Why this opinion rating: The September rating is retained. The current message distinguishes the six-turbine approval from the proposed 42–98 MW range.

What you can do

Use a current public message: the posted approval describes up to six turbines and 42 MW; the flyer gives a proposed 42–98 MW range. Ask for the alternatives, layout and approval-review trail in writing.

Why it might help

The assessed design was reduced from the earlier 15–18-turbine concepts to up to six turbines and 42 MW in February 2024. The new flyer gives a 42–98 MW range. That is enough to revisit the September message that no larger proposal had been found, but it does not supply a final design or approval.

- **Separate the scenarios.** Ask whether the range describes alternative designs for the next bid, separate phases, or a later expansion. Do not assume it refers to an expansion of an operating plant or that the older contract's expansion category answers the question.
- **Ask for the design and review trail.** Obtain turbine models, counts, heights and locations; roads and collector/transmission lines; the proposed project boundary; and what was submitted to the assessment branch for review.

Words on this page

Also on this page: MW megawatt · **Baseline** a dated record of how things are now · **Approval** a regulator's permission

- **Recheck each technical comparison.** The six-turbine map, setbacks, wildlife work, noise/flicker modelling and grid study remain baseline evidence. They are not findings about a 98 MW project.
- **Land and grid needs are unknown.** The MW range alone does not establish Crown-land use, spare connection capacity or a particular footprint. Obtain the land-rights and grid documents rather than infer them.
- **An approval-change question is not a new legal conclusion.** The posted approval has a review rule for proposed changes. Obtain the Department's actual review and any decision; do not claim the flyer itself amended the approval or proved a breach.

The practical value is a current, accurate public message and a document checklist. It does not establish whether the larger end of the range will proceed.

How to do it

1. **The message:** "The posted approval is for up to six turbines and 42 MW. The new flyer gives a 42–98 MW range. Please show the proposed alternatives, layout and approval review." Do not convert megawatts into a turbine count or claim an approved expansion.
2. **Ask the current project team and ABO** who owns the response, what the range means, which legal entity is responsible, and what land rights and grid request support each alternative. Preserve the old unanswered questions.
3. **Council:** put on record that added turbines should get a new environmental assessment (C4).
4. **The Minister:** ask that any extension state that it covers only the registered six-turbine project (B1).
5. **Evidence to watch:** land title (D4); whether the Crown easement sought goes beyond the registered roads and lines (D1); and a 42 MW bid can rest on a grid request of up to 105 MW (A5).

Words on this page

Also on this page: MW megawatt · **ABO** ABO Energy, the original project developer · **Setback** a minimum distance · **Shadow flicker** the flashing shadow of turning blades · **Baseline** a dated record of how things are now · **Approval** a regulator's permission · **The Department** Nova Scotia Environment and Climate Change · **Interconnection request** an application to connect to the grid · **Extension** extra time allowed under a particular rule · **Easement** a right to use someone else's land

When Now, before bids close.

Who Dan and a volunteer (the email to ABO); the group (council).

Where this comes from ABO mailouts (EARD Appendix A; March 2022 mailout); EARD s.3.1.1; wind LUB s.4.2; approval condition 3.5; EA Regulations s.11(3) and Schedule A; Ellershouse EA (2017); RFP II Appendix A, s.3.3(a), s.2.3(b)(v) and (ii)(A); proposed PPA s.2.1(b) and s.7.1(m) (M13042); GIP s.4.4.1(c).

G3 Community

Suggested action: Recheck at the final layout

Noise and flicker at the nearest homes

Work required	Potential difference	Public opinion	Effect on go-ahead
Low	Low–medium	Low	Low

When **When the final layout is filed (date unknown)** Who **Dan**

When triggered · date unknown

Why this opinion rating: Technical, and it protects particular households, whose homes stay out of public posts.

What you can do When the final turbine layout is filed, recheck noise and shadow flicker at the nearest homes and camps.

Why it might help

- **The limits bind at any permanent or seasonal home or camp:** flicker **30 minutes a day or 30 hours a year**; noise **40 dBA**.
- **Only one modelled home is within 2 km,** about 1.25 km from the nearest turbine.
  - Worst-case flicker there is **24 hours a year and 26 minutes a day**, all from turbines 5 and 6. The daily limit is the tighter one.
  - Noise is **39.4 dBA**: 37.4 modelled from the turbines and substation, plus an assumed 35.1 background. The Department's noise reviewer called it "just below" the limit, and said it could exceed 40 if the background is higher. Less than 1 dB more from the project would also cross 40.

Words on this page

Also on this page: ABO ABO Energy, the original project developer · **EARD** Environmental Assessment Registration Document · **LUB** land-use bylaw · **EA** environmental assessment · **RFP** request for proposals · **PPA** power purchase agreement · **GIP** Generator Interconnection Procedures · **dBA** A-weighted decibels · **Approval** a regulator's permission · **Condition** a rule attached to an approval or permit · **Shadow flicker** the flashing shadow of turning blades

- **What could push it over.** A desk screening check of the same worst-case geometry, made with a script Claude wrote for this research rather than ABO's software, matches ABO's result within a minute a day.
  - A bigger rotor within the registered 200 m tip barely moves it (about 24–25 hours, 26–27 minutes).
  - The tallest turbine in the alternative range (about 230 m; a design-change question, B4) reaches about **30 minutes a day**. So does moving turbine 5 about 150 m toward the home.
  - It's a screening check only; the final-layout update decides.
- **A desk check of other homes** (27 September): the provincial building layer and Microsoft's building footprints show no other building within 2 km, but both use older imagery (the provincial layer here uses 2004–05 air photos). The civic-address file, updated monthly, adds one point within 2 km, flagged as an approximate spot on its lot; neither building layer shows a building there. Homes along Highway 19 start about 2 km from the nearest turbine, just beyond the model's 1,788 m flicker cutoff.
- Turbines can be fitted with flicker shutdown and quieter operating modes (Nordex offers both). This protects that household; it is unlikely to change whether the project goes ahead.

How much it can do: low to medium.

How to do it

1. **Get the final-layout update** (D1) when it's filed, before road construction or upgrades. Check the final turbine, the positions, the list of homes and the cutoff, the flicker method, and whether background noise was measured at the nearest home (ABO's registration recommends it). Rerun the flicker check.
2. **Confirm** the address point within 2 km, and any camps or recent builds, from the road or with the county's civic addressing. **Keep individual homes out of public posts.**

Words on this page

Also on this page: ABO ABO Energy, the original project developer · **Shadow flicker** the flashing shadow of turning blades

3. If the nearest home is near a limit, ask the Department for monitoring and mitigation.
4. If the update shows a real gap, ask the Department for a third-party review at ABO's cost. Hire a qualified reviewer yourself only if it declines.

When When the final layout is filed; there's no date yet.

Who Dan.

Where this comes from Approval conditions 3.19, 4.1, 4.2, 7.1, 7.3, 7.4; EARD Appendices K–L, s.10.5.4–10.5.5, Table 6.5; Comments Part 1, item 8; NS building layer; Microsoft building footprints; NS civic address file; desk flicker script (27 Sept 2026).

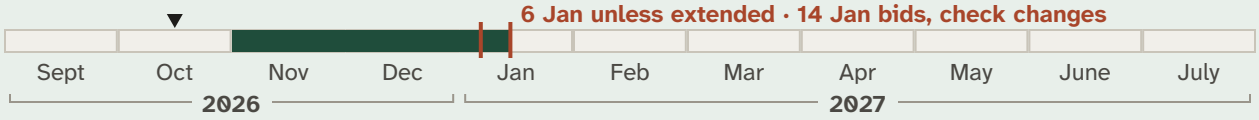
G4 Community

Suggested action: Optional

Tourism businesses: letters in their own words

Work required	Potential difference	Public opinion	Effect on go-ahead
Low	Low	Medium	Low

When **Nov–Dec, before 14 Jan** Who **Business owners themselves**



Why this opinion rating: Owners speaking about their own business carry weight locally; general claims of harm don't.

What you can do Tourism business owners can write, in their own name, about their own business, with a specific ask.

Why it might help

- Send letters to council (C4), the liaison committee (G1) and ABO; the environmental assessment was approved in January 2025. The scoring has no tourism criterion, but ABO can earn 2 points for a report showing how its proposal changed after local feedback. So **a specific ask to ABO before bids close** (14 January 2027), such as no hauling in peak season, has the best chance.

Words on this page

Also on this page: ABO ABO Energy, the original project developer · **EARD** Environmental Assessment Registration Document · **NS** Nova Scotia · **The Department** Nova Scotia Environment and Climate Change · **Approval** a regulator's permission · **Condition** a rule attached to an approval or permit · **Shadow flicker** the flashing shadow of turning blades

- The assessment says nearby communities "do not appear to be significant tourist destinations", but admits it had no local visitor data. Owners' booking and visitor records fill that gap.
- **Don't claim general harm.** The often-quoted US study (2024) found about an 11% drop in home values within 1 mile after an announcement, but it came from urban counties; in rural counties the effect was near zero. A 2008 Scottish study forecast small tourism losses.
- Their most direct say is whether to give a support letter, alone or through a business group, and on what written terms (**A1**). Whether one business's letter earns points is unclear.

How much it can do: low.

How to do it

1. Write about your own business: views you sell, bookings, construction access.
2. Attach evidence, such as booking and visitor records.
3. Make a specific ask, for example no hauling in peak season.
4. Don't name a business as opposed without its OK. The group should not write these letters for owners.

When

November to December, before 14 January.

Who

Business owners themselves.

Where this comes from

RFP II s.4.3(f); EARD s.8.4.3; *Energy Policy* (2024) home-value study; 2008 Scottish tourism study.

Words on this page

US United States: as in a US study of home values.

Also on this page: RFP request for proposals · **EARD** Environmental Assessment Registration Document

G5 Community

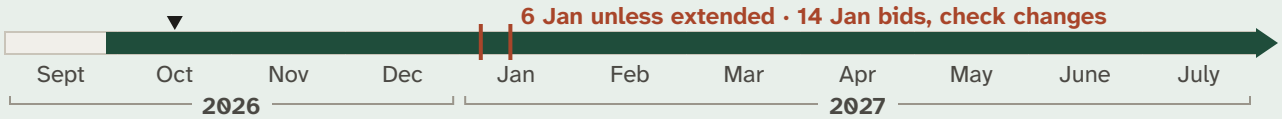
Suggested action

Use in messages

Offer constructive alternatives

Work required	Potential difference	Public opinion	Effect on go-ahead
Low	**Low**	**Medium–high**	**Low**
to propose	direct; high credibility		

When **In every few posts** Who **The group**



Why this opinion rating: The plan rates its credibility high; "yes to clean energy, done right" shows the concerns are about process, not renewables.

What you can do

Pair concerns with constructive alternatives: community solar, and specific ways to reduce Rhodena's impact.

Why it might help

- **Nova Scotia's Community Solar Program:** 0.5–10 MWac solar gardens owned by registered businesses (including co-ops and non-profits), community investment funds (CEDIFs), First Nations, municipalities, or universities and colleges; other groups can apply jointly with one. Rolling intake, up to a 100 MWac program cap. New Dawn's 555 kW garden in Sydney was the first (October 2024). Ask the program how much capacity is left before planning one.
- **Don't claim a solar garden replaces Rhodena.** A 10 MWac garden makes about 10.5–15.8 GWh a year (the program's 12–18% capacity factor); Rhodena's assessment expects 153 GWh.
- **Reduced-impact options,** each tied to its problem:
  - drop turbines 5 and 6, or move them away from the nearest home: they cause all its modelled flicker (G3). Natural

Words on this page

MWac megawatts of alternating current: how the solar program states capacity.

CEDIFs Community Economic Development Investment Funds. Nova Scotia's local investment funds.

GWh gigawatt-hour: a million kilowatt-hours; a measure of electricity produced over time.

Resources called bird-survey coverage near them “poor” (B3), so any move needs new surveys;

- bat curtailment (B6);
- a quieter turbine or operating mode for noise, not a taller turbine (G3, B4).

How much it can do: low directly, but high for credibility.

How to do it

1. Every few posts, say yes to clean energy done right (Message 4, below).
2. Point to the Community Solar Program.
3. Propose the reduced-impact options, each tied to its problem.

When In every few posts.

Who The group.

Where this comes from Nova Scotia Community Solar Program (novascotia.ca/programs/community-solar); EARD (153 GWh a year).

G6 Community

Suggested action: **Do, privately**

First Nations: respect, privately

Work required	Potential difference	Public opinion	Effect on go-ahead
Medium	Indirect	Not applicable	Very low

When Once, when there is new site evidence **Who** Not assigned; done privately

When triggered · date unknown

Why this opinion rating: Not a public-opinion tool: it's done privately, and the group never speaks for the Mi'kmaw partners.

What you can do Understand the difference between the Mi’kmaw partners and the Province’s duty to consult; offer new site evidence once, privately; never speak for the Mi’kmaq.

Words on this page

Also on this page: EARD Environmental Assessment Registration Document · **GWh** gigawatt-hour · **Curtailment** slowing or stopping turbines · **Mi'kmaq** the Indigenous people of this region

Why it might help

- **Partners and consultation are separate questions.** The duty to consult is the Province's; ABO carries only "procedural aspects".
- **Consultation.** The assessment branch wrote on 7 November 2024 to KMK, the Assembly of Nova Scotia Mi'kmaw Chiefs' consultation office. KMK's reply (3 December 2024) welcomed the partnership. It flagged Atlantic salmon and American eel, which ABO's 2022 surveys caught in brooks draining the study area, and said the Mi'kmaq hold commercial fishing licences within and around the project area. It recommended a Mi'kmaq fisheries communication plan and compensation plan, and asked for the Mi'kmaq Ecological Knowledge Study and the archaeology reports before commenting on heritage.
  - The approval requires a Mi'kmaq communication plan before work starts, available to the Department and the Mi'kmaq on request. No condition names the knowledge study or a fisheries compensation plan.
- **Partners.** We'koqma'q wrote on 18 November 2024 that it, Eskasoni, Potlotek and Wagmatcook were "the majority equity shareholder" in the round 1 bid, and it supported approval. The round 2 roster is unconfirmed.
- **The knowledge study (MEKS).** ABO's registration contradicts itself: "completed" with Membertou Geomatics, but also "currently underway", with site visits in 2023 and May 2024 and interviews ongoing. ABO promised to send it to reviewers "under separate cover" and to review "any recommendations" for mitigation, and the approval says the project must follow its registration documents. It isn't on the project page; that proves nothing either way. The knowledge is Mi'kmaw intellectual property.

How much it can do: indirect.

Words on this page

KMK Kwilmu'kw Maw-klusuaqn: the Mi'kmaq Rights Initiative: the Assembly of Nova Scotia Mi'kmaw Chiefs' consultation office.

MEKS Mi'kmaq Ecological Knowledge Study: a study of Mi'kmaw land and resource use for a project; the knowledge belongs to the Mi'kmaq.

Also on this page: ABO ABO Energy, the original project developer

How to do it

1. **Offer new site evidence once, privately, when there is some** (an ecology memo, verified species records). Lead with interests already on the record: streams and fish (**B7**), wetlands, bats (**B6**), turbines 5 and 6.
2. **Ask each community, or the Unama'ki Institute of Natural Resources** (it works for the five Cape Breton Mi'kmaw communities), how it wants to receive it.
3. **Don't ask anyone to oppose the project or the partnership, or describe their views in public.** Accept no reply. Keep Mi'kmaw matters out of the support-letter ask (**A1**) and the fact-check package (**A3**).
4. **Ask ABO in writing about the knowledge study:** which version covers the six-turbine layout; will it be updated for the final layout; when did it reach KMK and the assessment branch; did it make recommendations, and did they lead to mitigation? Ask for dates and yes or no, not content. Dan's request asks only for the date it reached the Department.

When

Once, when there is new site evidence.

Who

Not assigned; done privately.

Where this comes from

Office of L'nu Affairs, Proponents' Guide p.2; Comments Part 2 (PDF pp.23–25); EARD s.5.1–5.2 and s.7.3.2; approval conditions 2.2 and 10.1; MEK Protocol p.20; 2010 Mi'kmaq–Nova Scotia–Canada consultation Terms of Reference; **D1** #1 (request 1, part 6, date only).

Words on this page

MEK Mi'kmaq Ecological Knowledge: as in the MEK Protocol, which governs these studies.

Also on this page: ABO ABO Energy, the original project developer · **KMK** Kwilmu'kw Maw-klusuaqn · **PDF** Portable Document Format · **EARD** Environmental Assessment Registration Document

G7 Community

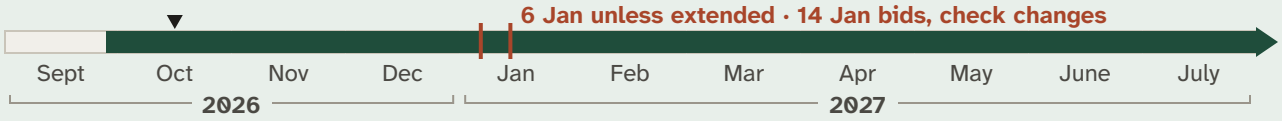
Suggested action

Messages and volunteer jobs

Use the corrected messages

Work required	Potential difference	Public opinion	Effect on go-ahead
Not rated	Not rated	High	Not rated

When **Now, once the fixes are made** Who **Dan (records); the group (legwork)**



Why this opinion rating: This is how the other messages reach people, once the kit's fixes are made.

What you can do

16 October update. Messages 1 and 2 now use the dated flyer evidence: a new owner and a 42–98 MW range. Ask for the design and consent records rather than infer them.

Use the four corrected messages below, follow the ground rules, pick a volunteer job, and post the recruitment message.

Why it might help

This is how the other ideas reach people. Dan keeps the records work; the group does the legwork. The messages here already include the corrections the fact-check required: for example, 18 turbines was the March 2022 plan, not the first; an extension is possible, not “common”; and the German parent company, not the approval holder, is restructuring.

Ground rules

Write everything as if it will be screenshotted and read by ABO, council and the Province.

- Say only what a document shows, and link it.
- Don’t call anyone corrupt, dishonest, insolvent or law-breaking unless a regulator or court has said so.
- Don’t speak for the Mi’kmaw partner communities.

Words on this page

Also on this page: MW megawatt · **ABO** ABO Energy, the original project developer · **Extension** extra time allowed under a particular rule · **Approval** a regulator's permission

- Don’t post exact locations of nests, dens, roosts, hibernation sites, lichens or cultural sites. Send them privately to the regulator.
- Write in your own words about your own concerns: one real paragraph is better than a form letter.
- Stay on public roads, or get the landowner’s permission. Never enter old mine openings.

Message 1 (lead)

Six is what’s approved: put it in writing (G2)

The core line: “Six turbines and 42 MW is what’s approved. The new flyer says 42–98 MW. Put the plan in writing.”

Facts we can stand behind:

- September 2021: up to 16 turbines, about 80 MW, mostly on Crown land. March 2022: about 18 turbines, 100 MW (ABO’s own mailout). Until February 2024: 15 turbines.
- 6 January 2025: approved for up to 6 turbines, 42 MW, up to 200 m to the blade tip.
- 16 October 2026: a flyer says ABO transferred its interest to Northland Power and gives a 42–98 MW range, with the final size and layout still to be planned.
- Added turbines could share the substation, the roughly 10 km line and the roads. That’s an inference: no document shows a plan or spare capacity.
- Expansion goes to the assessment branch, which “may require” a new environmental assessment.
- ABO declined to sign its 2025 contract, citing “external economic conditions and current market realities”. It never signed one.

Don’t say: “ABO plans 18 turbines”; “six turbines is phase one”; “three times bigger”; that 98 MW is approved or means a known number of turbines; or that expansion “would need” a new assessment (it “may require” one; asking council to press for one is fine).

Words on this page

Also on this page: **MW** megawatt · **ABO** ABO Energy, the original project developer · **Hibernaculum** a place where bats hibernate · **Crown land** land owned by the Province · **Northland Power** the company named in the new flyer · **Condition** a rule attached to an approval or permit

The asks: the project owner: say in writing what the 42–98 MW range means (alternative designs, phases or an expansion), how many turbines, and whether it holds or seeks land rights beyond the approved layout; record the answer word for word. Council: no support letter until the design and commitments are in writing, and put on record that any expansion should get a new environmental assessment. The Minister: any extension limited to the approved six-turbine project, with updated wildlife surveys first.

Draft post:

Six is what's approved. Let's get it in writing.

The Creignish ridge project is approved for up to 6 turbines. It was bigger before: up to 16 turbines in 2021, about 18 in ABO's March 2022 mailout (aboenergy.com/media/en/range-of-activities/canada/rhodena/Rhodena_Mailout_220316.pdf), and 15 until February 2024, when a provincial bidding rule took Crown land out.

A flyer received on 16 October says ABO has transferred its interest to Northland Power and gives a range of 42–98 MW, with the final size and layout still to be planned. That isn't an approval, and no document yet shows the design. We're asking the project to put it in writing.

If you email the project (rhodenawind.ca) or go to an open house, please ask: (1) What does the 42–98 MW range mean, and how many turbines? (2) Do you hold or seek land rights beyond the approved layout? Post the answer you get here, word for word.

Message 2

Who will own it? (A4)

Facts: A flyer received on 16 October says ABO transferred its interest to Northland Power. The legal entities, the date and the current approval holder are not yet confirmed in writing (A4). Background: ABO's German parent company reported a preliminary 2025 loss of about €170 million (15 January 2026) and is restructuring under a standstill with its lenders, extended to 30 November 2026. The project must still win the bidding.

Words on this page

Also on this page: MW megawatt · **ABO** ABO Energy, the original project developer · **Support letter** a letter backing the bid · **Extension** extra time allowed under a particular rule · **Crown land** land owned by the Province · **Northland Power** the company named in the new flyer · **Approval** a regulator's permission · **Standstill** a temporary agreement with financing partners

Don't say: "ABO is bankrupt" or "ABO is insolvent". Neither is established; ABO is still selling and developing projects.

Say: "The project has changed hands. Before anyone signs a 25-year contract, residents deserve to know in writing who owns, builds and is responsible for these turbines, and who pays to take them down."

The asks: the owner: confirm in writing the legal owner, the date of the transfer and who holds the approval. Council: a staff report, and a bylaw change requiring security for removal before a permit (C4, C5). Today the bylaw requires a decommissioning plan, not security.

Message 3

The start clock (B1)

Facts:

- The approval says work must start by about 6 January 2027, unless the Minister extends it in writing. ABO's own page estimates construction in 2028–2030.
- Natural Resources found bird coverage "poor, particularly near Turbine 5 and Turbine 6", asked for breeding-bird surveys before construction, and noted the bat surveys missed the first 2–3 weeks of May.
- Spring radar started on 13 April 2022 and 27 April 2023; the federal department's spring window opens on 15 March.
- The bird counts are from 2022 only.

Don't say: "The approval expires on 6 January." **Say:** "Work must start by about 6 January 2027 unless the Minister grants a written extension." An extension is possible; don't call it "common". Don't say the federal department "recommended two years of monitoring".

The ask: personal letters to the Minister: any extension should require updated wildlife surveys and be limited to the approved six-turbine layout.

Words on this page

Also on this page: ABO ABO Energy, the original project developer · **Approval** a regulator's permission · **Decommissioning** taking something out of service · **Extension** extra time allowed under a particular rule

Message 4

Yes to clean energy, done right (G5)

Use it every few posts, to make clear the concerns are about how this project is done, not about clean energy. Point to the Province's Community Solar Program (co-op and non-profit solar gardens, 0.5–10 MWac). Don't claim solar replaces 42 MW of wind; it doesn't, megawatt for megawatt.

Volunteer jobs

Each job has a "report back", so the results come to one place (a group post thread or the group's files).

#	Job	Who and effort	When	How	Report back
1	Mailbox log	Anyone within about 5 km; 5 minutes	Now to 9 Oct	Keep any flyer or letter from ABO and photograph it with the date it arrived. One empty mailbox proves nothing; log ABO's other channels too (**A2**)	Photo, date, community
2	Website watcher	One person; 5 minutes a week	Weekly to Jan	Save ABO's Rhodena page with the Wayback Machine ("Save Page Now") and screenshot it. ABO must post project details by 26 Oct	Dated screenshots
3	Open house recorders	Two people; one evening	When announced	Photograph every board and map. Note the turbine model, hub height, blade length and number of turbines. Ask the 42–98 MW and ownership questions	Photos, written answers
4	Liaison committee seat	One or two calm, detail-minded residents	Now	ABO's page already invites volunteers: volunteer now, take notes, ask for minutes (**G1**)	Minutes and notes
5	Letters to the Minister	Many; 20 minutes each	With Dan's letter; before about 6 Jan	Use Message 3's points in your own words. Say where you live and what you value about it	"Sent" and the date

Words on this page

Also on this page: **MWac** megawatts of alternating current · **MW** megawatt · **ABO** ABO Energy, the original project developer · **Wayback Machine** a free web archive · **Hub height** the height of the rotor's centre

#	Job	Who and effort	When	How	Report back
6	Council ask	Two or three people	Oct–Dec	Ask your councillor and the Warden: no support letter before written answers; a staff report on security for removal before a permit; on record that any expansion should get a new assessment. Consider presenting to council (**C4**)	Who, and what they said
7	Local groups	A few people	Oct–Dec	Politely ask community associations, the rec centre, fire departments, churches and tourism businesses to wait on any support letter until residents' questions are answered. Explain; don't pressure	Which groups, their answer
8	Site watch	Regular drivers of Hwy 105, Rhodena Road, General Line Road	Nov–Jan	Note or photograph any clearing, survey stakes, road work or heavy equipment near the site, from public roads only. Record the date, time and place	Photo, date, place
9	Wildlife records	Anyone	Ongoing	Send exact records privately to the conservation data centre and Natural Resources. iNaturalist and eBird are public, and privacy settings alone aren't enough: "Obscured" or "Private" can leak through photos, notes and nearby posts. On iNaturalist, obscure and keep landmarks out; on eBird, log a general location or wait until the birds have left (**B12**)	Exact locations only privately
10	Bat hibernation question	Someone with naturalist or biology contacts	Oct–Nov	The 8 candidate mine openings (Port Hood, Whiteside, Little River) come from the Province's mine-openings database. Ask whether they've been checked for bats since white-nose syndrome. Inquiries only: no site visits, no entry (**B11**)	Who was asked, the answer

Words on this page

Also on this page: **Support letter** a letter backing the bid · **White-nose syndrome** a fungal disease of hibernating bats

#	Job	Who and effort	When	How	Report back
11	Land registry	Someone with Property Online access, or near a land registration office	This fall	Look up leases, options or easements on the project lots (**D4**)	Lot list and documents
12	Company check	Anyone; 15 minutes	Monthly, and before 14 Jan	Free company-registry search for ABO Energy Canada and any Rhodena company (**D3**)	Screenshots
13	Tourism letters	Business owners themselves	Nov–Dec	Owners write about their own business (**G4**). The group should not write these for them	“Sent”
14	Night view	Someone comfortable with maps or photos	Nov	Day and night views showing top and mid-height red lights, labelled illustrative (**F3**)	Image and method

Recruitment post

Two deadlines, one ridge: small jobs, pick one

ABO has to start work on Rhodena by about Jan 6, 2027, or get a written extension from the Minister. Bids for the Province’s new wind contracts close Jan 14, 2027.

Petitions are done. What helps now is small, factual jobs. Comment with the number you’ll take:

1. Keep any ABO flyer that comes to your mailbox (with the date)
2. Screenshot ABO’s Rhodena web page once a week
3. Go to the next open house and photograph the boards
4. Join the community liaison committee (ABO is inviting volunteers now)
5. Write a short personal letter to the Environment Minister (points provided)
6. Talk to your councillor
7. Ask your community group to hold its support letter until our questions are answered in writing

Words on this page

Also on this page: ABO ABO Energy, the original project developer · **Easement** a right to use someone else's land · **Extension** extra time allowed under a particular rule · **Support letter** a letter backing the bid

8. If you drive Hwy 105 / Rhodena Rd / General Line Rd: photograph any clearing or equipment near the site, from the road
9. Report wildlife sightings (privately for exact spots)
10. Ask your naturalist contacts one bat question
11. Look up land records (Property Online access needed)
12. A 15-minute company registry search
13. Business owners: a letter about your own business
14. Help with a night-time view of the lights

Stick to facts we can link to. No name-calling, no guessing at motives. It makes us much harder to dismiss.

When

Now, once the corrections are made; messages every few posts.

Who

Dan keeps the records work; the group does the legwork.

Where this comes from

The research plan's comms and volunteer kit (27 Sept 2026), as corrected by the plan (messages 1–3, tasks 1, 4, 9 and 10); the plan's don't-claim list; ABO mailout (16 Mar 2022); ABO project page (Oct 2025); ABO ad hoc announcements (15 Jan and 31 July 2026); Comments Part 1 (PDF p.34) and Part 2 (PDF p.18); EARD s.7.4.4.4 and s.7.4.5.5.

Words on this page

Also on this page: **ABO** ABO Energy, the original project developer · **PDF** Portable Document Format · **EARD** Environmental Assessment Registration Document

Chapter H

H What won't work

Ideas that come up often but are closed, out of time, or not something residents can act on. Knowing them saves effort and credibility.

Aviation objections

NAV CANADA, National Defence, the federal weather radar and the RCMP did not object in 2024. NAV CANADA did so while noting impacts on an airway and on the approaches to Port Hawkesbury airport, about 12 km away. Keep the aviation ideas (F1–F3) for the letters, the lighting and the night views.

Bigger home setbacks

The county's 4× the turbine height (about 800 m) is the provincial cap. Only the distance needed to meet the 40 dBA noise and flicker limits can justify more. The closest identified home, 1.2 km away, models at 39.4 dBA against the 40 dBA limit. That margin is the live angle: watch the final-layout update (G3, C3).

A penalty for walking away in 2025

Closed. The administrator's published answers rejected a 5-point deduction for round 1 winners that refused to sign. Round 2's own penalties are for a round 2 winner's failures: missing the 20-business-day deadline to sign and deliver the contract, security and closing documents may cost its proposal security, and not signing may limit future eligibility.

Joining the Energy Board's contract case

Comments closed on 14 September. Late participation needs the Board to extend the time. It's about the standard contract, not Rhodena.

Words on this page

RCMP Royal Canadian Mounted Police: checked in 2024 for effects on its radio links; it has none of its own nearby.

Also on this page: NAV CANADA the company that runs Canada's civil air navigation · **dBA** A-weighted decibels

Challenging the 2025 approval

Out of time. The approval has no statutory appeal, and the court-review deadline passed by 6 July 2025. A judge can lengthen it, but more than a year late that's a long shot. Focus on fresh decisions (B14).

A Crown-land use application

An earlier application to change the use of Crown parcels west of General Line Road was reportedly rejected (not verified). Get the decision before trying anything similar. The live issue is ABO's easement: in the 2024 design, roads and lines are partly on Crown land, and easements are considered only after a contract is signed. New roads or lines on Crown land forgo 2 bid points; existing public roads don't (D1, E1).

More petitions

Done twice: on paper (almost 200 names) and online (started April 2022, now closed at 754). They cost ABO no points. Little is gained by another.

"Upgrade costs make it unbuildable"

NS Power is responsible for grid reliability equipment; ABO pays for its own connection. That's ABO's risk, not something residents can act on. The real tests are the new grid study and the deliverability assessment, including whether a configuration was actually assessed (A5). Watch A5.

Where this comes from

EARD Table 10.2 and s.10.5.4; Minimum Planning Requirements Regulations s.14(1); approval condition 7.1; FAQ v.02 items 24, 37 and 39; RFP II s.3.10(a)(iii)–(iv), Appendix G, s.4.5(f)(i), s.2.3(b)(v)(A), s.4.3(e)(v) and (f), s.2.8(a)(i), s.4.5; Board Regulatory Rules r.5(4); Renewable Electricity Regulations s.37(1); Environment Act s.138(2); Civil Procedure Rules 7.05(1) and 2.03(1)(c); FAQ v.02 item 35; filed PPA s.2.1(d).

Words on this page

Also on this page: ABO ABO Energy, the original project developer · **NS Power** Nova Scotia Power · **EARD** Environmental Assessment Registration Document · **FAQ** frequently asked questions · **RFP** request for proposals · **PPA** power purchase agreement · **Approval** a regulator's permission · **Easement** a right to use someone else's land · **Crown land** land owned by the Province · **Condition** a rule attached to an approval or permit

What not to say

Claims that sound right but aren't, and what to say instead. Stay with what documents show.

Don’t say	Say instead
“The approval expires on 6 January 2027.”	Work must start within two years (by about **6 January 2027**) unless the Minister extends in writing. Neither the rule nor the approval says it lapses. Extensions have been granted, and not always posted (Bear Head’s, to 2027, per CBC; it isn’t on its project page). Site preparation on any part counts as a start, but it needs **30 days’ written notice** (by about 7 December 2026) and the items due before work starts or before road work, unless the Department allows otherwise in writing (**B1**).
“Opposition letters cost ABO points.”	No criterion deducts points for opposition. Engagement points come only from what ABO’s proposal shows. What counts is *support letters* (0.5 each, up to 4), so it is fair to ask for written answers before giving one (**A1**). Documented errors in ABO’s claims can go to the administrator, which may verify with third parties (**A3**).
“ABO must hold a new open house.”	Not necessarily. An in-person open house or public meeting is mandatory, but the administrator’s published answers say earlier open houses, an approved assessment and no significant design change “appears to meet the requirement”. Those answers don’t amend the call for bids. Rhodena held five (2021, 2023, 2024), and ABO says it plans more in 2026.
“The 2025 walk-away counts against ABO.”	Not in the scoring. The call for bids has no such criterion, and requests for a 5-point deduction, or a 1-point bonus for projects that hadn’t failed to sign an awarded contract, were turned down.
“Council decides the permit.”	The **Development Officer** (at the planning commission) issues it. A permit that meets the bylaw must be issued; council has no approval vote. Council does hear variance appeals.
“The agency comments are secret.”	They’re posted on the Province’s project page (Comments Parts 1–2), with the Mi’kmaw and public comments. Ask how they were *resolved*.

Words on this page

Also on this page: CBC Canadian Broadcasting Corporation · **ABO** ABO Energy, the original project developer · **Approval** a regulator's permission · **Extension** extra time allowed under a particular rule · **The Department** Nova Scotia Environment and Climate Change · **Support letter** a letter backing the bid · **Bid administrator** the firm running the bidding · **Development Officer** the planning official · **Variance** a lawful, limited adjustment of a bylaw rule

Don't say	Say instead
"18 agencies opposed it."	The comment index lists **18 government entries** of mixed kinds: general guidance, "no concerns" notes and technical requests. It wasn't a vote.
"ABO is bankrupt or insolvent."	The German parent is restructuring under a creditor standstill to **30 November 2026**. That is historical background, not a finding about Northland or current project financing. The flyer says ABO transferred its interest; obtain the legal entities, date, control and financing evidence.
"A new investor forces a new assessment."	Not automatically. The change rule covers changes to the project, not its owner. But selling a controlling interest, or moving the approval to an affiliate, needs the **Minister's written consent**.
"The hoary, eastern red and silver-haired bats are legally endangered."	COSEWIC *assessed* them Endangered (May 2023). They are not on the federal legal list (as of 3 September 2026) or Nova Scotia's. The approval still requires the locations where field work found them to go to Natural Resources before work starts.
"The county's bigger setbacks apply."	Council adopted the greater of 1,500 m or 5× the height (May 2025). The Minister replaced it with **4× the height** and kept the coast setback at 100 m, not 2 km (July 2025). The bylaw allows more only to meet 40 dBA; the provincial cap would also allow a flicker test.
"The zone rule makes Rhodena ineligible."	The rule bars only connections in Zones 4–5. The line Rhodena would use is listed in Zones 1–2, so the rule doesn't exclude Rhodena if it still connects there.
"There's a UARB hearing on Rhodena's cost recovery."	There isn't one: Rhodena has no contract. The **Energy Board**'s case M13042 is the application to approve the standard contract; comments closed on 14 September 2026, and the administrator's reply is due on 28 September. The Board must let NS Power recover the costs of contracts awarded in the bidding.
"The approval can still be appealed."	The Minister's approval decision has no statutory appeal. The court-review deadline passed by July 2025. A judge can lengthen it, but that is a long shot this late. Fresh decisions (an extension, amendment or permit) start new short clocks; get legal advice fast (**B14**).

Words on this page

UARB Utility and Review Board: the regulator's former name. The standard contract is now before the Energy Board.

Also on this page: ABO ABO Energy, the original project developer · **COSEWIC** Committee on the Status of Endangered Wildlife in Canada · **dBA** A-weighted decibels · **NS Power** Nova Scotia Power

Don't say	Say instead
"ABO plans 18 turbines."	The flyer received 16 October gives a proposed 42–98 MW range. It does not establish turbine count or an approved larger layout. The posted assessment baseline is up to six and 42 MW. Earlier layouts had up to 16 (2021), about 18 (2022) and 15 (until February 2024) turbines, partly on Crown land.
Any "corrupt" or "bribe" talk	No supporting document has been found in the searches so far (**D2**). Donations or lobbying alone don't show wrongdoing. Act only on documents.

"98 MW is approved, or means a known turbine count." | The flyer gives a range with further planning. Obtain the alternatives and changed-layout review. Do not infer a footprint or Crown-land need. |
"The flyer proves the approval transferred, or that consent was missing." | It reports a transfer of interest. Obtain the transaction structure, current approval-holder confirmation and any written consent. An unpublished record is not an absent record. |

Where this comes from

The research plan's don't-claim list, with its sources: EA Regulations s.27 and s.2(2); approval conditions 3.2, 3.3, 3.5, 3.9, 3.12–3.13, 6.1; RFP II s.4.3(f), s.5.5, s.5.7(c), s.2.7(a)(iv), s.2.3(b)(iii), Appendix E; FAQ v.02 items 10, 24, 37, 39; wind LUB s.2.2, s.2.4, s.4.4(a), (f), (g); MGA s.236, s.246(1); Environment Act s.41B, s.138(2); Civil Procedure Rules 2.03, 7.05; Minimum Planning Requirements Regulations s.14(1); Electricity Act s.29(2); Energy Board matter M13042; SARA Schedule 1 (as of 3 Sept 2026); CBC (Bear Head extension).

Words on this page

SARA Species at Risk Act: the federal law for listed species. Its bans reach endangered or threatened migratory birds on any land, but listed land species on non-federal land only if Ottawa orders it.

Also on this page: ABO ABO Energy, the original project developer · **MW** megawatt · **EA** environmental assessment · **RFP** request for proposals · **FAQ** frequently asked questions · **LUB** land-use bylaw · **MGA** Municipal Government Act · **CBC** Canadian Broadcasting Corporation

Project facts

16 October update; older technical facts remain tied to the assessed layout.

Item	Fact
Approval	The posted **6 January 2025** conditional approval names **ABO Energy Canada Ltd.**, file 40100-30-350. The registered project is up to six turbines and 42 MW. It requires commencement within two years unless extended in writing, review of proposed changes, and written consent for a transfer. Current holder, transfer consent, commencement and any extension/change decision require confirmation. No automatic-expiry inference is made.
Design	**Approved baseline:** up to six turbines, 42 MW; registration notice up to 200 m tip and 7 MW each. **New flyer claim, received 16 October:** proposed 42–98 MW, with size/layout still being planned. Turbine count, heights, positions, footprint, phases and land needs are not established by that range. The existing model and desk findings describe the 2024 six-turbine layout.
History	September 2021: up to 16 turbines, about 80 MW (Community Wind with ABO). March 2022: 100 MW, about 18 turbines; May 2022: 15. Not shortlisted in the 2022 Rate Base Procurement (ABO, 15 July 2022). June 2023: 15 turbines, 105 MW. February 2024: cut to 6 turbines, 42 MW (ABO cited Green Choice's private-land rule). Selected in Green Choice round 1 (27 January 2025); ABO declined to sign the contract, citing economic and market conditions (public by 25 September 2025).
Turbine positions, 2024 baseline (latitude, longitude, rounded)	T1 45.7670, −61.4418 · T2 45.7696, −61.4367 · T3 45.7713, −61.4293 · T4 45.7706, −61.4222 · T5 45.7583, −61.4235 · T6 45.7596, −61.4178 (ABO's 2024 layout).

Words on this page

T1–T6 the six turbine positions: numbered as in ABO's 2024 layout; T1 is the westernmost, nearest Route 19.

Also on this page: ABO ABO Energy, the original project developer · **MW** megawatt

Item	Fact
Zoning	On an unofficial desk fit of the county's wind zoning map, all six plot in the general rural wind zone (GR-1), where large turbines need a development permit. Turbine 1 plots about **300 m** from the coastal zone (UTE-1), where only small domestic turbines are allowed (well-fitting variants gave 250–320 m). Only the planning commission can confirm the boundary (**C2**).
Homes, 2024 layout	The closest home is **about 1.2 km** away (modelled receptor A); ABO says it used a 1,000 m minimum. The county minimum from existing homes on other lots is 4× the tip height (about **800 m**), more if needed to keep noise at 40 dBA. The civic-address file has one more address point within 2 km, placed approximately on its lot. It isn't among ABO's modelled homes, and its use is unknown (**G3**).
Noise and flicker, 2024 layout	Worst-case flicker at the nearest home: **24 hours a year and 26 minutes a day** (from turbines 5 and 6); none at the other six modelled homes. Modelled noise there: **39.4 dBA**, including 35.1 dBA background. The approval's binding limits at permanent or seasonal homes: 30 hours a year and 30 minutes a day, and 40 dBA.
Grid, 2024 baseline	A new 138 kV line of about 10 km to line **L-6537** (ABO: 10.2 km; NS Power: 9.3 km). The line is in grid Zones 1–2, so Rhodena passes the zone rule. NS Power's 2024 study of "Rhodena Wind" (IR713, 42 MW) found thermal overloads on four lines and the Port Hastings transformer. Round 2 allows only as-available service. The study's non-binding estimate was **$20.1 million** (with a 25% contingency; about $9.3 million of it network upgrades eligible for refund), assuming changes to existing protection schemes are approved. It doesn't replace the transformer, and in one stressed outage case the study limited output to 1.7 MW. If line upgrades are needed instead, add **$37.8 million** (no contingency). Round 2 needs a new request (due 30 September). The latest posted queue (15 June 2026) has no Inverness wind request and nothing on L-6537.
Wetlands, assessed layout	**36 wetlands, including 3 potential wetlands of special significance:** one in a proposed turbine pad, one along an existing road, one along the collector line. ABO says all three can be avoided in detailed design. Up to 14 would be altered, about **1.22 ha** (a conservative estimate).

Words on this page

Also on this page: **GR-1** the general rural wind zone · **UTE-1** the coastal wind zone · **ABO** ABO Energy, the original project developer · **dBA** A-weighted decibels · **kV** kilovolt · **NS Power** Nova Scotia Power · **IR713** interconnection request 713 · **MW** megawatt · **Development permit** the county's planning permit for a large turbine · **Receptor** a home or camp where the noise and flicker limits apply · **Tip height** the height to the top of a blade · **Shadow flicker** the flashing shadow of turning blades · **Approval** a regulator's permission · **Baseline** a dated record of how things are now · **Queue** a list of items waiting their turn · **Wetland of special significance** a wetland with extra protection

Item	Fact
Access, assessed layout	From Highway 105 by General Line Road and/or Rhodena Road: two new roads off General Line Road, one off Rhodena Road. About 4.75 km of new road and 5 km of existing road. Turbine 1 is about 2 km from Route 19.
Aviation	Port Hawkesbury airport is about **12 km** from turbines 5 and 6 (ABO says about 13 km from the assessment area). 2024 replies: NAV CANADA, no objection but a higher airway minimum altitude and a new approach obstacle (7 October 2024; valid 18 months, so **lapsed about 7 April 2026** unless renewed). National Defence, no objection; valid 24 months from its date, which the filed copy doesn't show; ABO logs it as received **11 September 2024**, so it ran out no later than **11 September 2026**; resubmit if the layout changes. Federal weather radar, no objection, but no longer valid if the number, height or placement of turbines changes. RCMP: no towers or links of its own nearby. Renewals are unconfirmed.
Liaison committee	Historical meetings were recorded in February–May 2024. The flyer received 16 October promotes fall community meetings, a liaison committee and a survey. Actual meeting dates, convenor, membership, terms, prior issues and use of survey responses require confirmation.
Partners (2025)	The 2025 provincial announcement named Eskasoni, Potlotek, We'koqma'q L'nue'kati and Wagmatcook. This is a historical roster, not a verified current ownership statement. The new flyer names Northland Power; the transaction structure and current Mi'kmaw partners remain unconfirmed.
ABO's timeline	**Current dated forecasts, not approvals:** ABO's website table checked 16 October gives engineering/construction 2028–2030 and targeted operation in 2030. The flyer received that day says construction could begin in 2028 and service in late 2030, subject to approvals and engagement. The website's October 2025 news estimate of 2027/2028 construction and 2029/2030 operation is historical.
ABO's parent company	The September guide's German restructuring and standstill account is historical background. It does not establish Northland's finances, the current project owner or the bidder's financing. Verify the handover and current financing evidence (**A4**).

Words on this page

Also on this page: **ABO** ABO Energy, the original project developer · **NAV CANADA** the company that runs Canada's civil air navigation · **RCMP** Royal Canadian Mounted Police · **Northland Power** the company named in the new flyer · **Standstill** a temporary agreement with financing partners

Item	Fact
Bidding round 2	Rhodena Wind Inc. is the intended bidder in ABO's October notice. The posted timeline checked 16 October retains **14 January 2027, 3 pm Atlantic** for bids (time from the call for bids) and **6 May** for award notices. Addendum 2 does not change them; later changes remain possible. The resident factual-material cutoff remains unconfirmed. Intention is not registration, selection or a contract.
Scoring, call for bids as amended 15 October (100 points)	Price 50 · Risk and maturity 24 (environmental risk 7, through an approval wholly covering the primary design, roads and connection, or a 4.0 questionnaire; site 6, including 2 for as-of-right zoning confirmation or an executed development agreement; experience 4; financing 4; wind data 3) · Engagement 10 (feedback report 2, liaison committee 1, support letters 0.5 each to a maximum of 4, Mi'kmaq engagement 3) · Benefits 16 (Mi'kmaw ownership over 50% = 6, social programs 5, economic benefits 5).

Flyer contact | Darren Carl, Director of Project Development, darren.carl@northlandpower.com, 1-416-988-9198, as printed in the flyer received 16 October. Publication and transaction dates are unknown. rhodenawind.ca still redirects to ABO's page, which names Heidi Kirby. Confirm responsibilities before redirecting outstanding matters. |

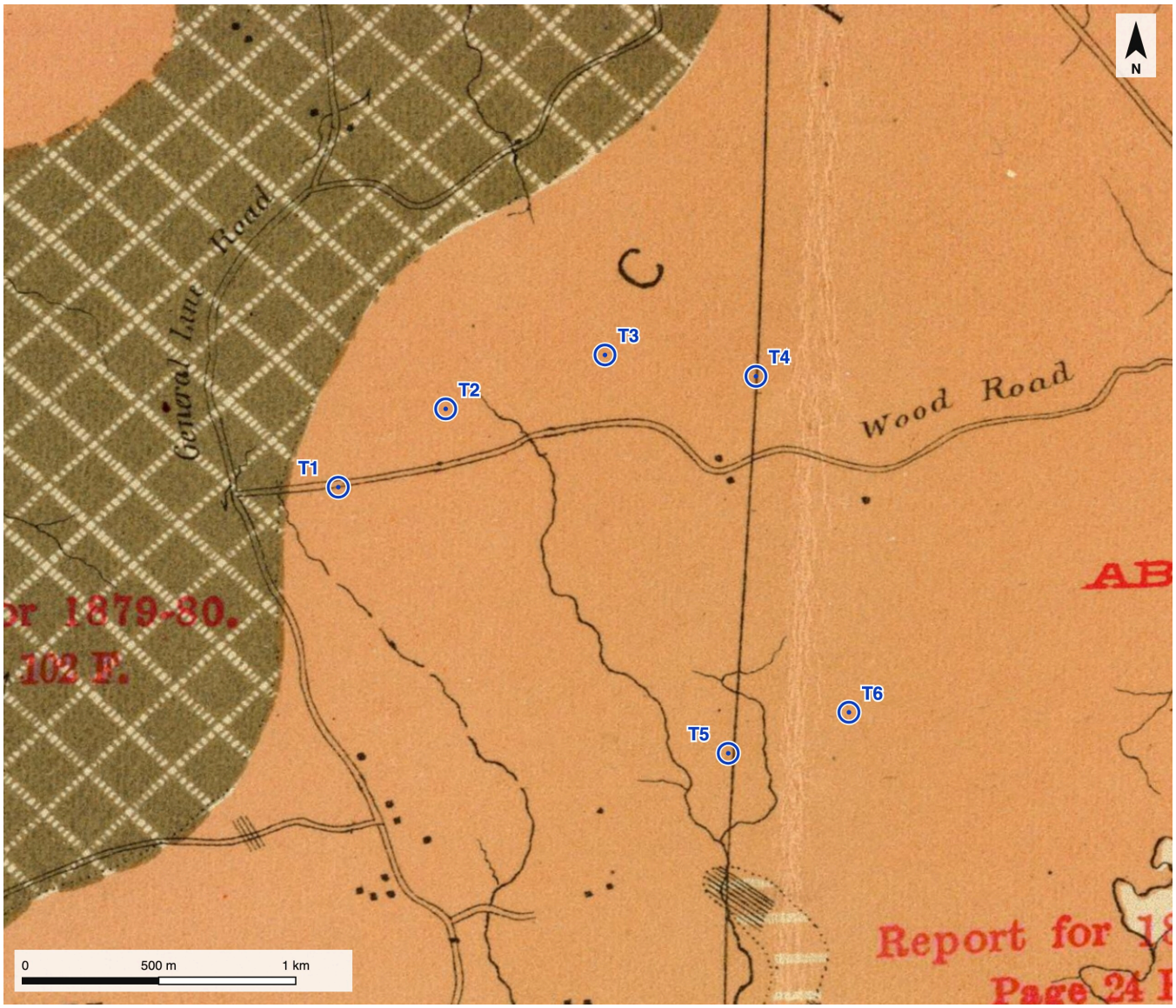
Where this comes from

The research plan's project facts, with their sources: approval and decision letter; EA registry page; EA Regulations s.27; registration notice; EARD s.2.1, s.3.2.1–3.2.2, Table 3.4, s.6.5, s.7.3.3.5–7.3.3.6, s.8.3.2, s.10.5.4, Tables 6.1, 6.3–6.5, Appendices A, J–L; ABO mailouts and project page; Province release (27 Jan 2025); CBC; county wind zoning map (Sept 2025) and bylaw s.4.2(b), s.4.4(a), (g), s.5.2; NS civic address file; RFP II v1.4 s.1.2, s.2.3(b)(iii), s.2.4(a), s.2.8(b), s.3.3, s.3.5(c), s.3.6, s.4.3, Appendix E; IR713 feasibility study (31 May 2024) s.6 and s.11; IESO-NS queue (15 June 2026); ABO ad hoc announcements and reports page.

Words on this page

Also on this page: **ABO** ABO Energy, the original project developer · **EA** environmental assessment · **EARD** Environmental Assessment Registration Document · **CBC** Canadian Broadcasting Corporation · **NS** Nova Scotia · **RFP** request for proposals · **IR713** interconnection request 713 · **IESO-NS** Independent Energy System Operator (Nova Scotia) · **Addendum** a formal change · **Approval** a regulator's permission · **As-of-right** allowed under the zoning rules · **Support letter** a letter backing the bid · **Queue** a list of items waiting their turn

The turbines on the 1884 map



ABO's six turbine positions (T1 to T6, the 2024 layout; the final layout may differ) on Hugh Fletcher's Geological Survey of Canada map of Cape Breton, sheet 19 (1884), which shows roads, streams and buildings as they were then, not what remains today. The fit of the old map is provisional and approximate (tens to a few hundred metres); the scale bar is approximate. Map image: David Rumsey Map Collection, David Rumsey Map Center, Stanford University Libraries; CC BY-NC-SA 3.0; overlay added. This map may be shared with that credit. Detailed comparisons of individual map marks go privately to the heritage department (**B10**).

Words on this page

CC BY-NC-SA Creative Commons Attribution-NonCommercial-ShareAlike: the 3.0 licence of the 1884 map image: credit the source, no commercial use, and share adaptations under the same licence (creativecommons.org/licenses/by-nc-sa/3.0).

Also on this page: ABO ABO Energy, the original project developer · **T1–T6** the six turbine positions

Glossary and index of abbreviations

Every word the footers explain, with the page where it is first defined. Abbreviations are spelled out in full.

A2022NS129 heritage research permit (2022): the permit for ABO's earlier archaeology work. 69

A2024NS150 heritage research permit (2024): the permit for ABO's 2024 archaeology fieldwork. 69

ABO ABO Energy, the original project developer. Its Canadian company is named on the posted January 2025 approval. The October flyer reports a transfer of interest to Northland Power; confirm the current legal roles and approval holder. 2

AC advisory circular: a Transport Canada guidance note (AC 601-006 covers aircraft-detection lighting). 128

ACAP Atlantic Coastal Action Program: ACAP Cape Breton; a 2018 federal recovery strategy says it has monitored known and potential bat hibernation sites since 2013. 72

Addendum a formal change: to the call for bids, issued by the administrator. 4

Aircraft detection lighting that stays off until an aircraft is near. If the sensor or its link fails, the lights come on. Transport Canada must accept it; acceptance isn't guaranteed. 127

Approval a regulator's permission. In this book “the approval” means Rhodena's environmental approval of 6 Jan 2025; other approvals, such as for a wetland, are named. 2

As-of-right allowed under the zoning rules: by permit, without a separate discretionary planning decision. 4

ATIP access to information and privacy: the federal version of an information request, made to a federal department. 52

Baseline a dated record of how things are now: so later changes can be shown. 3

Bid administrator the firm running the bidding. Power Advisory LLC for round 2. It checks and scores bids, and may verify claims with third parties. 5

Business days days banks are open: under the filed contract, so weekends and holidays don't count. 26

CARs Canadian Aviation Regulations: the federal aviation rules; a structure over 150 m is an obstacle to air navigation. 128

CBC Canadian Broadcasting Corporation: CBC News, the public broadcaster. 61

CC BY-NC-SA Creative Commons Attribution-NonCommercial-ShareAlike: the 3.0 licence of the 1884 map image: credit the source, no commercial use, and share adaptations under the same licence (creativecommons.org/licenses/by-nc-sa/3.0). 160

CEDIFs Community Economic Development Investment Funds. Nova Scotia's local investment funds. 139

CLC community liaison committee: a committee of local residents required by the approval; advisory only. Confirm the current convenor, terms and membership. 30

Other abbreviations on this page

Also on this page: LLC limited liability company

Clean-up bond proposed financial security for removal: that the county could call if an owner fails to take the turbines down. The current bylaw requires a plan, not a bond. 6

Commencement starting work. Site preparation on any part of the project counts. It needs 30 days' written notice, unless the Department varies the timing in writing. 3

Concordance table the approval holder's yearly status report: on each approval condition, due each 31 January until released in writing. Confirm who currently holds the approval. 17

Condition a rule attached to an approval or permit. Breaking a condition of Rhodena's environmental approval is an offence. 3

Core habitat the areas a recovery plan says a species needs most. Identified, not legally designated, for lynx in 2025. 16

COSEWIC Committee on the Status of Endangered Wildlife in Canada: the national scientific committee that assesses species. Its assessment alone doesn't make a species legally protected. 45

Crown land land owned by the Province: managed by Natural Resources. Round 2 bars turbines on it. 12

CSA Canadian Standards Association: CSA Group, which certifies equipment. 90

Curtailment slowing or stopping turbines: at set times, for example on nights in the bat season. 13

Cut-in speed the wind speed at which a turbine starts producing power. Below it, the blades can be feathered so they barely turn. 50

dBA A-weighted decibels: the usual measure of sound as the human ear hears it. The approval's limit at homes is 40 dBA. 47

Decommissioning taking something out of service. Here, usually taking the turbines down and restoring the site at the end of the project's life; for roads, closing and restoring them. 63

Development Officer the planning official: at the planning commission who issues development permits. A permit that meets the bylaw must be issued; council has no vote. 84

Development permit the county's planning permit for a large turbine: issued by the Development Officer. It lapses if work doesn't start within 12 months. 9

DFO Fisheries and Oceans Canada: the federal fisheries department; it decides whether work near fish habitat needs a federal authorization. 46

DNRR Department of Natural Resources and Renewables: the provincial department's name on its 2021 file. 105

EA environmental assessment: the Province's review of a project's likely effects before it can go ahead. Rhodena's was approved with conditions on 6 Jan 2025. 30

EARD Environmental Assessment Registration Document: ABO's 2024 filing that registered Rhodena for assessment: the project description, studies and appendices. 24

Easement a right to use someone else's land: for a road or power line, or to allow a smaller setback. Roads and lines on Crown land need one from Natural Resources. 12

ECCC Environment and Climate Change Canada: the federal environment department. Its Canadian Wildlife Service advises on birds and species at risk. 46

Other abbreviations on this page

Also on this page: ABO ABO Energy, the original project developer

EDPC Eastern District Planning Commission: the regional planning office that does Inverness County's planning; its Development Officer issues development permits. 87

Extension extra time allowed under a particular rule. For the project start, the Minister may grant a written extension on request. Confirm the actual decision and timing. Information-request deadlines have separate rules (**D1**). 3

FAQ frequently asked questions: the administrator's published answers (FAQ v.02, 16 Sept 2026); it doesn't change the RFP. 24

Feathering turning the blades edge-on: so they barely spin in low wind. 50

FOIPOP Freedom of Information and Protection of Privacy. Nova Scotia's access-to-information law. A FOIPOP request asks a public body for records it holds: a $5 application fee, and processing fees may follow. 6

GIP Generator Interconnection Procedures: the published rules for connecting generators to the grid. 36

GIS geographic information system: mapping software and data. 87

GPS Global Positioning System: satellite positioning, as in a phone's location. 74

GR-1 the general rural wind zone: the county wind zone where large turbines are allowed with a development permit. All six 2024 positions plot in it on an unofficial desk overlay; the planning commission must confirm. 87

Green Choice the Province's renewable-power bidding program. Round 1 selected Rhodena in Jan 2025, but ABO declined to sign; round 2 opened on 10 Sept 2026. 9

GWh gigawatt-hour: a million kilowatt-hours; a measure of electricity produced over time. 139

Hibernaculum a place where bats hibernate: often a cave or old mine (plural: hibernacula). Disturbing one occupied or habitually occupied by endangered bats is an offence. 16

Hub height the height of the rotor's centre: 118 m for the modelled turbine. 54

Hugh Fletcher the Geological Survey of Canada geologist: whose 1884 Cape Breton map sheets show roads, streams and buildings. 68

Ice throw ice shed from turning blades. The assessment estimates up to 421.5 m for its modelled turbine. 6

IESO-NS Independent Energy System Operator (Nova Scotia): the province's independent grid operator. It keeps the connection queue and tests whether bids' power can be delivered. 36

Information request a request for a public body's records: under the access law (FOIPOP in Nova Scotia): a $5 application fee, and processing fees may follow. 6

Interconnection request an application to connect to the grid. Each gets a study of what the grid needs and what it costs. 18

IR644 interconnection request 644: an older 2022 study of 102.6 MW on L-6537; it names no developer. 36

IR713 interconnection request 713: NS Power's 31 May 2024 study of connecting “Rhodena Wind” (42 MW) to line L-6537. 17

Other abbreviations on this page

Also on this page: RFP request for proposals · **ABO** ABO Energy, the original project developer · **MW** megawatt · **NS Power** Nova Scotia Power

Judicial review asking a judge to review a decision: for reasonableness. The deadline is the earlier of 25 days after you're told (weekends and court-closed days don't count) and 6 months after the decision. 6

kV kilovolt: a thousand volts. The 2024 Rhodena design proposed a new 138 kV line; recheck any changed design. 55

LLC limited liability company: as in Power Advisory LLC, the bid administrator. 5

MEK Mi'kmaq Ecological Knowledge: as in the MEK Protocol, which governs these studies. 142

MGA Municipal Government Act: the provincial law that governs councils, planning, permits and municipal records. 80

Migratory bats hoary, eastern red and silver-haired bats: COSEWIC assessed them Endangered in May 2023. As of Sept 2026 they are not on the federal or Nova Scotia legal lists. 45

MLA member of the Legislative Assembly: your provincial representative. 15

MPS municipal planning strategy: a council's planning policy; bylaws must carry it out. 91

MWac megawatts of alternating current: how the solar program states capacity. 139

Neighbourhood Mail Canada Post's unaddressed flyer service: not delivered to homes with a “no flyers” sign. 26

NRCan Natural Resources Canada: the federal natural resources department. 39

KMK Kwilmu'kw Maw-klusuaqn: the Mi'kmaq Rights Initiative: the Assembly of Nova Scotia Mi'kmaw Chiefs' consultation office. 141

Leaf-off when the leaves are down: and nests are easiest to see (the plan's nest search is Nov–Jan). 17

LUB land-use bylaw: a county's zoning rules. Inverness has a separate wind-turbine LUB (2012, amended Sept 2025). 62

MEKS Mi'kmaq Ecological Knowledge Study: a study of Mi'kmaw land and resource use for a project; the knowledge belongs to the Mi'kmaq. 141

Mid-mast lights red lights halfway up the tower: required on lit turbines over 150 m, as well as the lights on top. 126

Mi'kmaq the Indigenous people of this region: “Mi'kmaw” is the singular and adjective form. 130

MP member of Parliament: your federal representative. 15

MW megawatt: a measure of generating capacity. The assessed baseline is 42 MW; the new flyer proposes a 42–98 MW range. Megawatts alone do not establish turbine count. 2

NAV CANADA the company that runs Canada's civil air navigation. It reviews tall structures for effects on flight routes and airport approaches. 18

Northland Power the company named in the new flyer. The flyer received 16 October reports a transfer of interest to it. Legal entities, date, control and current approval holder remain unconfirmed. 2

NS Nova Scotia: the province. 72

Other abbreviations on this page

Also on this page: COSEWIC Committee on the Status of Endangered Wildlife in Canada

N.S. Nova Scotia: used in regulation and case citations (N.S. Reg. 51/2025 is a Nova Scotia regulation). 97

NSECC Nova Scotia Environment and Climate Change: the provincial department that issued Rhodena's approval and enforces its conditions. 52

NSRAB Nova Scotia Regulatory and Appeals Board: the provincial board that hears planning appeals (cases are cited as NSRAB). 97

OIPC Office of the Information and Privacy Commissioner: the office that reviews information-request decisions in Nova Scotia; under the law in force on 27 Sept 2026 it recommends, it can't order. 105

PDF Portable Document Format: the file format; a "PDF page" is the page number in the file, not the printed one. 52

Proposal security financial security posted with a bid: $35,000 per MW, about $1.47M at 42 MW; it can be drawn if a winner doesn't sign. 37

Queue a list of items waiting their turn. In this book, usually the grid operator's posted list of connection requests (as of 27 Sept 2026, dated 15 June 2026). **D1**'s queue is the list of planned information requests. 5

Receptor a home or camp where the noise and flicker limits apply: permanent or seasonal. ABO modelled a list of them; the nearest, receptor A, is about 1.2 km away. The limits apply at any such place, not only those on the list. 54

RJSC Registry of Joint Stock Companies. Nova Scotia's company registry; a free search shows status, directors and dated filings. 33

Setback a minimum distance: between a turbine and something else: a home, a property line, a road or a stream. 6

NSCA Nova Scotia Court of Appeal: used in case citations. 80

NS Power Nova Scotia Power: the province's electric utility (legally Nova Scotia Power Inc.). Winning bidders sign 25-year contracts with it. 9

NSSC Supreme Court of Nova Scotia: the province's main trial court; used in case citations. 80

Old growth old forest: stands that have grown for a long time without major disturbance. 5

PPA power purchase agreement: the 25-year contract under which a winning bidder sells electricity to NS Power. 38

Q&A questions and answers: the question-and-answer section on ABO's page. 26

RCMP Royal Canadian Mounted Police: checked in 2024 for effects on its radio links; it has none of its own nearby. 151

RFP request for proposals: the Province's call for bids; here, Green Choice round 2 (RFP II, 10 Sept 2026). 24

SARA Species at Risk Act: the federal law for listed species. Its bans reach endangered or threatened migratory birds on any land, but listed land species on non-federal land only if Ottawa orders it. 155

Shadow flicker the flashing shadow of turning blades. The approval's limits: 30 hours a year and 30 minutes a day at any home or camp. 4

Other abbreviations on this page

Also on this page: MW megawatt · **ABO** ABO Energy, the original project developer

SREPs Smart Renewables and Electrification Pathways Program. Natural Resources Canada funding for clean-power projects. 39

Standstill a temporary agreement with financing partners: during a restructuring. The September guide reported an ABO parent-company date of 30 Nov 2026; it does not establish current Northland or project financing. 19

Support letter a letter backing the bid: from a local government, group or community. Each is worth half a point, up to 4 of 100. 4

TC Transport Canada: the federal transport department; it sets the lighting and marking rules for tall structures. 127

Tip height the height to the top of a blade: when it points straight up; up to 200 m registered. 54

US United States: as in a US study of home values. 138

Variance a lawful, limited adjustment of a bylaw rule: such as a setback, allowed under the bylaw. Owners nearby get notice and can appeal a granted variance to council. 12

Wayback Machine a free web archive: (web.archive.org) that saves dated copies of web pages. 26

White-nose syndrome a fungal disease of hibernating bats. Bat records from before it may be out of date. 70

Standing the right to bring a case: A genuine local group can get public-interest standing. 79

Stay a court order pausing a decision: while a case is heard. Filing a case doesn't stop work by itself. 79

T1–T6 the six turbine positions: numbered as in ABO's 2024 layout; T1 is the westernmost, nearest Route 19. 156

The Department Nova Scotia Environment and Climate Change: which issued the approval. Its environmental assessment branch handles changes. 19

UARB Utility and Review Board: the regulator's former name. The standard contract is now before the Energy Board. 154

UTE-1 the coastal wind zone: the county wind zone along the coast where only small domestic turbines are allowed. 87

Waiver giving up or excusing a requirement. For setbacks, a neighbour's written agreement to a smaller setback (a wind lease of 19 years or more, or, at the county's discretion, a binding easement). For information requests, a fee waiver excuses processing fees. 12

Wetland of special significance a wetland with extra protection. Use by a threatened or endangered species can support that classification; the Department decides. Altering one is harder, not impossible. 55

Other abbreviations on this page

Also on this page: ABO ABO Energy, the original project developer

Sources

The original source list was checked on 27 September 2026. This edition adds the checks below, dated 16 October. It does not certify that every older link or rule is current. No private correspondence is reproduced in this guide.

Green Choice, round 2

- The call for bids (RFP II v1.4, 10 September 2026): nova-scotia-gcp.com/wp-content/uploads/2026/09/green-choice-program-procurement-rfp-ii_v1.4_september-10-2026.pdf
- Addendum 1 (15 September 2026; it only changes the registration-fee address): nova-scotia-gcp.com/wp-content/uploads/2026/09/green-choice-program-procurement-rfp-ii_addendum-no.1_september-15-2026.pdf
- The administrator's answers, FAQ v.02 (16 September 2026; it says it does not amend or interpret the call for bids): nova-scotia-gcp.com/wp-content/uploads/2026/09/gcp-rfp-faq_v.02.pdf
- Where new documents appear: Program Updates, nova-scotia-gcp.com/program-updates/; addenda on Proponent Resources, nova-scotia-gcp.com/stakeholder-resources/; answers, nova-scotia-gcp.com/faqs/. Addenda are scheduled to end on 29 October 2026, but later ones are allowed. The administrator also emails updates to a mailing list.

The environmental assessment (the Province's project page): novascotia.ca/nse/ea/rhodena-wind-project/. Nothing was posted after the January 2025 decision, as of 27 September 2026. The page links the approval and conditions, the decision letter, ABO's registration document in parts (Part 1: the main text; Part 5: wetlands, plants and bat monitoring; Part 8: radio and aviation letters, shadow flicker with the turbine coordinates, and sound), and the agency and public comments (Comments Parts 1–2).

Regulations

- Environmental Assessment Regulations (what counts as starting work; the start deadline and extensions): novascotia.ca/just/regulations/regs/envassmt.htm

Words on this page

Also on this page: **RFP** request for proposals · **FAQ** frequently asked questions · **ABO** ABO Energy, the original project developer · **Green Choice** the Province's renewable-power bidding program · **Addendum** a formal change · **Approval** a regulator's permission · **Condition** a rule attached to an approval or permit · **Shadow flicker** the flashing shadow of turning blades

- Minimum Planning Requirements Regulations (the 2025 wind rules): novascotia.ca/just/regulations/regs/mgaminimum.htm
- Renewable Electricity Regulations (the administrator's final report): novascotia.ca/just/regulations/regs/elecrenew.htm
- Green Choice Program Regulations (reports and terminations): novascotia.ca/just/regulations/regs/greenchoice.htm

Inverness County's wind rules (2012, amended September 2025; the planning commission lists them at edpc.ca/plan-documents-and-maps/ under "Wind Turbine Development"):

- the bylaw: edpc.ca/plandocs/inwind/IN_Wind_LUB.pdf
- the zoning map: edpc.ca/plandocs/inwind/IN_Wind_Zoning.pdf
- the planning strategy: edpc.ca/plandocs/inwind/IN_Wind_MPS.pdf
- the Municipal Affairs letter approving them with amendments (30 July 2025): invernesscounty.ca/wp-content/uploads/2025/09/Municpal-Affairs_Wind_Turbine_Bylaw_2025-07-30.pdf

ABO

- Rhodena page (rhodenawind.ca redirects here): aboenergy.com/ca/company/projects/rhodena-wind/index.php
- Ad hoc announcements (latest, 31 July 2026: the standstill extended to 30 November 2026): aboenergy.com/en/company/ad-hoc-announcements.html
- Press releases (asset sales, including the April 2026 New Brunswick sale): aboenergy.com/en/media-center/press/index.php
- March 2022 mailout (100 MW, about 18 turbines, with Community Wind): aboenergy.com/media/en/range-of-activities/canada/rhodena/Rhodena_Mailout_220316.pdf

The Province

- Round 1 (27 January 2025): news.novascotia.ca/en/2025/01/27/green-choice-program-greening-grid-creating-jobs-improving-energy-independence
- Round 2 (11 September 2026): news.novascotia.ca/en/2026/09/11/second-call-affordable-clean-energy-through-green-choice-program

Words on this page

Also on this page: **ABO** ABO Energy, the original project developer · **MW** megawatt · **Bid administrator** the firm running the bidding · **Green Choice** the Province's renewable-power bidding program · **Standstill** a temporary agreement with financing partners

The grid

- The grid-connection queue (published 15 June 2026, still current on 27 September): nspower.ca/docs/default-source/pdf-to-upload/ieso-ns-oasis-active-transmission-interconnection-requests-transmission-q.pdf, linked from nspower.ca/oasis/generation-interconnection-procedures
- NS Power's 2024 study of "Rhodena Wind" (IR713, 31 May 2024): nspower.ca/docs/default-source/pdf-to-upload/ir713-feas.pdf. Study-report index: nspower.ca/oasis/generation-interconnection-procedures/generator-interconnection-study-reports

Other

- The provincial board's 2026 decision ordering West Hants to approve a wind development agreement (26 May 2026): nserbt.ca/sites/default/files/NSRAB%20Board%20Decision%20-%20Bear%20Lake%20Wind%20Ltd%20M12505.pdf
- Transport Canada Standard 621 (obstacle marking and lighting; wind turbines chapter 12, aircraft detection chapter 15): tc.canada.ca/en/corporate-services/acts-regulations/list-regulations/canadian-aviation-regulations-sor-96-433/standards/standard-621-obstacle-marking-lighting-canadian-aviation-regulations-cars
- Transport Canada advisory circular on aircraft-detection viewsheds (2021): tc.canada.ca/en/aviation/reference-centre/advisory-circulars/advisory-circular-ac-no-601-006
- Community Solar Program: novascotia.ca/programs/community-solar/
- The Province's abandoned mine openings search: gesner.novascotia.ca/amosearch/searchpage.aspx; download page: novascotia.ca/natr/meb/download/dp010.asp
- Hugh Fletcher's 1884 Cape Breton sheets, David Rumsey Map Collection: Rhodena is on sheet 19 (davidrumsey.com/maps4562.html) and sheet 22 (davidrumsey.com/maps4559.html). Licence: creativecommons.org/licenses/by-nc-sa/3.0/

Words on this page

Also on this page: **NS Power** Nova Scotia Power · **IR713** interconnection request 713 · **Queue** a list of items waiting their turn · **Aircraft detection** lighting that stays off until an aircraft is near · **Hugh Fletcher** the Geological Survey of Canada geologist

16 October 2026 review sources and gaps

- Owner-supplied flyer, “Proposed Rhodena Wind Project: Update”, received 16 October 2026. Two owner-supplied photos were visually read in the source conversation. Receipt is not publication or transaction date. Only the flyer content was used, not postal forms in the backgrounds. The photos are not embedded here; check the final wording against the preserved flyer before publication.
- ABO Rhodena project page, checked 16 October: October 2026 intention-to-bid notice naming Rhodena Wind Inc.; development schedule 2028–2030/2030; six-turbine/42 MW description and Heidi Kirby contact. https://www.aboenergy.com/ca/company/projects/rhodena-wind/index.php
- Posted Rhodena approval, 6 January 2025, checked 16 October. Conditions 3.2–3.3 concern commencement/notice, 3.5 proposed changes, 3.9 transfers and controlling interests, 3.12–3.13 written timing/phasing, and 4.1 final design/modelling. https://novascotia.ca/nse/ea/rhodena-wind-project/EA_Approval_RhodenaWind.pdf
- Green Choice Program Updates, checked 16 October, announces Addendum No.2 and final-RFP answers on 15 October. https://nova-scotia-gcp.com/program-updates/
- Addendum No.2, dated 15 October 2026, downloaded and checked 16 October. Item 1 amends zoning scoring and the site form; item 2 amends deliverability terminology, sequence and deemed outcomes; item 3 changes the security beneficiary address; item 4 changes document permissions. It does not move the schedule. https://nova-scotia-gcp.com/wp-content/uploads/2026/10/green-choice-program-procurement-rfp-ii_addendum-no.2_october-15-2026.pdf
- Administrator answers, FAQ v.03, checked 16 October: disclaimer (PDF p.1), environmental-design coverage and approved addenda (items 1–4, pp.2–3), no extension of the question/comment deadline (item 17, p.6), executed-development-agreement option (item 19, p.7). These answers are informational and do not amend, interpret or replace the call for bids or contract; those documents prevail on conflict. https://nova-scotia-gcp.com/wp-content/uploads/2026/10/gcp-rfp-faq_v.03.pdf
- Posted procurement timeline, checked 16 October, labelled updated 10 September: October 8 questions/comments, October 29 addenda, January 14 bids, May 6 award-notice target. The call for bids supplies the 3 pm Atlantic bid time and allows later

Words on this page

Also on this page: **ABO** ABO Energy, the original project developer · **MW** megawatt · **RFP** request for proposals · **FAQ** frequently asked questions · **PDF** Portable Document Format · **Approval** a regulator's permission · **Condition** a rule attached to an approval or permit · **Commencement** starting work · **Green Choice** the Province's renewable-power bidding program · **Addendum** a formal change · **Extension** extra time allowed under a particular rule

changes. These are procurement dates, not a confirmed resident evidence cutoff. https://nova-scotia-gcp.com/green-choice-program-timeline/

Personal records requests, case numbers, fee estimates and email exchanges are not included in this guide. No legal conclusion about a transfer, expansion, expiry or non-compliance is made from the flyer.

Words on this page

Earlier words: **CC BY-NC-SA** Creative Commons Attribution-NonCommercial-ShareAlike · **T1–T6** the six turbine positions · **SARA** Species at Risk Act